Chapter 1: Arjuna Vishada Yoga (The Yoga of Arjuna's Despair)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

धृतराष्ट्र उवाच ।
धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः ।
मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव किमकुर्वत सञ्जय ॥1.1॥

Transliteration:

dhṛtarāśtra uvāca
dharmakṣetre kurukṣetre samavetā yuyutsavaḥ
māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāścaiva kim akurvata sañjaya

English Meaning:

Dhritarashtra said: O Sanjaya, after assembling on the holy field of Kurukshetra and desiring to fight, what did my sons and the sons of Pandu do?

Detailed Explanation:

This opening verse sets the stage for the entire Bhagavad Gita. King Dhritarashtra, blind both physically and morally, asks Sanjaya about the events unfolding on the battlefield. The word *Dharmakshetra* (field of righteousness) indicates that this is not just a physical war, but a moral and spiritual battle.

Dhritarashtra's attachment to his sons (Kauravas) is evident in the word *māmakāḥ* ("my people"), showing bias and ignorance. The battlefield symbolizes the human mind, where righteousness and unrighteousness constantly struggle.

Practical Application:

- Recognize inner conflicts as moral battles
- Avoid blind attachment and bias in decision-making

Key Insight:
Attachment clouds judgment and leads to inner conflict.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:
संजय उवाच ।
दृष्ट्वा तु पाण्डवानीकं व्यूढं दुर्योधनस्तदा ।
आचार्यमुपसंगम्य राजा वचनमब्रवीत् ॥1.2॥

Transliteration:
sañjaya uvāca
dṛṣṭvā tu pāṇḍavānīkaṁ vyūḍhaṁ duryodhanas tadā
ācāryam upasaṅgamya rājā vachanam abravīt

English Meaning:
Sanjaya said: King Duryodhana, seeing the army of the Pandavas drawn up in military formation, approached his teacher Drona and spoke these words.

Detailed Explanation:
Duryodhana, though confident outwardly, is inwardly anxious. His decision to approach Dronacharya reveals insecurity. He attempts to manipulate and motivate his teacher by highlighting the strength of the Pandava army.

This reflects the psychology of ego—outward pride masking inner fear.

Practical Application:

- Recognize insecurity hidden behind arrogance
- Stay grounded even in positions of power

Key Insight:
Ego often hides fear and insecurity.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

पश्यैतां पाण्डुपुत्राणामाचार्य महतीं चमूम् ।
व्यूढां द्रुपदपुत्रेण तव शिष्येण धीमता ॥1.3॥

Transliteration:

paśyaitāṁ pāṇḍu-putrāṇām ācārya mahatīṁ camūm
vyūḍhāṁ drupada-putreṇa tava śiṣyeṇa dhīmatā

English Meaning:

O teacher, behold this mighty army of the sons of Pandu, expertly arranged by your intelligent disciple, the son of Drupada.

Detailed Explanation:

Duryodhana subtly reminds Drona that his own student (Dhrishtadyumna) is leading the opposing army. This is a psychological tactic to provoke loyalty and urgency.

This verse highlights how people use emotional triggers to influence others.

Practical Application:

- Be aware of manipulation through emotional appeals
- Act based on dharma, not pressure

Key Insight:

Emotional manipulation is often used to control decisions.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

अत्र शूरा महेष्वासा भीमार्जुनसमा युधि ।
युयुधानो विराटश्च द्रुपदश्च महारथः ॥1.4॥

Transliteration:
atra śūrā maheṣv-āsā bhīmarjuna-samā yudhi
yuyudhāno virāṭaśca drupadaśca mahārathaḥ

English Meaning:
In this army, there are many heroic bowmen equal in fighting to Bhima and Arjuna; there are also great fighters like Yuyudhana, Virata, and Drupada.

Detailed Explanation:
Duryodhana acknowledges the strength of the Pandava side. Despite his arrogance, he recognizes the reality of the situation.

This reflects the tension between perception and truth.

Practical Application:

- Accept reality even when it challenges your confidence
- Assess situations objectively

Key Insight:
True strength lies in recognizing reality clearly.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
धृष्टकेतुश्चेकितानः काशिराजश्च वीर्यवान् ।
पुरुजित्कुन्तिभोजश्च शैब्यश्च नरपुङ्गवः ॥1.5॥

Transliteration:
dhṛṣṭaketuś cekitānaḥ kāśirājaś ca vīryavān
purujit kuntibhojaś ca śaibyaś ca nara-puṅgavaḥ

English Meaning:
There are also great heroic warriors like Dhrishtaketu,

Chekitana, the valiant king of Kashi, Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Shaibya.

Detailed Explanation:
The verse continues listing the warriors, emphasizing the formidable nature of the Pandava army. It builds tension before the battle.

Symbolically, these warriors represent various strengths within a person—courage, wisdom, and loyalty.

Practical Application:

- Recognize and cultivate inner strengths
- Prepare fully before facing challenges

Key Insight:
Inner strength is built through diverse virtues.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
युधामन्युश्च विक्रान्त उत्तमौजाश्च वीर्यवान् ।
सौभद्रो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्व एव महारथाः ॥1.6॥

Transliteration:
yudhāmanyuś ca vikrānta uttamaujāś ca vīryavān
saubhadro draupadeyāś ca sarva eva mahārathāḥ

English Meaning:
There are also powerful fighters like Yudhamanyu, Uttamauja, Abhimanyu (son of Subhadra), and the sons of Draupadi—all great chariot warriors.

Detailed Explanation:
This verse highlights the younger generation of warriors, symbolizing hope, continuity, and future potential.

Practical Application:

- Value youth and emerging strength
- Encourage growth in the next generation

Key Insight:
Strength is sustained through the next generation.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
अस्माकं तु विशिष्टा ये तान्निबोध द्विजोत्तम ।
नायका मम सैन्यस्य संज्ञार्थं तान्ब्रवीमि ते ॥1.7॥

Transliteration:
asmākaṁ tu viśiṣṭā ye tān nibodha dvijottama
nāyakā mama sainyasya saṁjñārthaṁ tān bravīmi te

English Meaning:
But for your information, O best of Brahmins, let me tell you about the distinguished leaders of my army.

Detailed Explanation:
Duryodhana shifts focus to his own army, trying to boost morale. This reflects the human tendency to seek reassurance in difficult situations.

Practical Application:

- Build confidence through awareness of your strengths
- Stay balanced between realism and optimism

Key Insight:
Confidence must be rooted in awareness, not denial.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

भवान्भीष्मश्च कर्णश्च कृपश्च समितिञ्जयः ।
अश्वत्थामा विकर्णश्च सौमदत्तिस्तथैव च ॥1.8॥

Transliteration:

bhavān bhīṣmaś ca karṇaś ca kṛpaś ca samitiñjayaḥ
aśvatthāmā vikarṇaś ca saumadattis tathaiva ca

English Meaning:

There are personalities like you (Drona), Bhishma, Karna, Kripa, Ashwatthama, Vikarna, and the son of Somadatta.

Detailed Explanation:

Duryodhana lists powerful warriors on his side, emphasizing authority and experience. Yet, many of these warriors are internally conflicted.

Practical Application:

- Strength without unity leads to weakness
- Inner alignment is more important than external power

Key Insight:

Divided minds weaken even the strongest forces.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

अन्ये च बहवः शूरा मदर्थे त्यक्तजीविताः ।
नानाशस्त्रप्रहरणाः सर्वे युद्धविशारदाः ॥1.9॥

Transliteration:

anye ca bahavaḥ śūrā mad-arthe tyakta-jīvitāḥ
nānā-śastra-praharaṇāḥ sarve yuddha-viśāradāḥ

English Meaning:

There are many other heroes who are prepared to give up their

lives for my sake, all well equipped with various weapons and experienced in military science.

Detailed Explanation:
Duryodhana emphasizes loyalty—but it is loyalty driven by attachment and ego, not righteousness.

Practical Application:

- Question the purpose behind loyalty
- Align actions with dharma, not blind allegiance

Key Insight:
Loyalty without righteousness leads to destruction.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:
अपर्याप्तं तदस्माकं बलं भीष्माभिरक्षितम् ।
पर्याप्तं त्विदमेतेषां बलं भीमाभिरक्षितम् ॥1.10॥

Transliteration:
aparyāptaṁ tad asmākaṁ balaṁ bhīṣmābhirakṣitam
paryāptaṁ tv idam eteṣāṁ balaṁ bhīmābhirakṣitam

English Meaning:
Our strength, protected by Bhishma, is unlimited, whereas the strength of the Pandavas, protected by Bhima, is limited.

Detailed Explanation:
Despite his earlier concern, Duryodhana now overstates his strength. This inconsistency reveals internal instability.

Practical Application:

- Avoid overconfidence
- Stay consistent in judgment

Key Insight:
Overconfidence often masks hidden doubt.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:
अयनेषु च सर्वेषु यथाभागमवस्थिताः ।
भीष्ममेवाभिरक्षन्तु भवन्तः सर्व एव हि ॥1.11॥

Transliteration:
ayaneṣu ca sarveṣu yathā-bhāgam avasthitāḥ
bhīṣmam evābhirakṣantu bhavantaḥ sarva eva hi

English Meaning:
Therefore, all of you, stationed in your respective positions, must give full support to Bhishma.

Detailed Explanation:
Duryodhana instructs his army to protect Bhishma, recognizing him as their strongest pillar. This reveals dependence on a single figure rather than collective unity.

Practical Application:

- Do not overly depend on one person or resource
- Build distributed strength in teams and life

Key Insight:
Overdependence creates vulnerability.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:
तस्य सञ्जनयन्हर्षं कुरुवृद्धः पितामहः ।
सिंहनादं विनद्योच्चैः शङ्खं दध्मौ प्रतापवान् ॥1.12॥

Transliteration:
tasya sañjanayan harṣaṁ kuru-vṛddhaḥ pitāmahaḥ
siṁha-nādaṁ vinadyocchaiḥ śaṅkhaṁ dadhmau pratāpavān

English Meaning:
Then Bhishma, the grandsire of the Kurus, blew his conch shell loudly, producing a sound like a lion's roar, bringing joy to Duryodhana.

Detailed Explanation:
Bhishma's conch symbolizes courage and readiness. It boosts morale but does not address the moral dilemma of the war.

Practical Application:

- Motivation must be aligned with righteousness
- External enthusiasm cannot replace inner clarity

Key Insight:
True strength comes from moral conviction, not noise.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:
ततः शङ्खाश्च भेर्यश्च पणवानकगोमुखाः ।
सहसैवाभ्यहन्यन्त स शब्दस्तुमुलोऽभवत् ॥1.13॥

Transliteration:
tataḥ śaṅkhāś ca bheryaś ca paṇavānaka-gomukhāḥ
sahasāivābhyahanyanta sa śabdas tumulo 'bhavat

English Meaning:
After that, conches, drums, bugles, trumpets, and horns were all suddenly sounded, and the combined sound was tumultuous.

Detailed Explanation:
This verse depicts the intensity and chaos before battle. Symbolically, it reflects the noise of worldly distractions.

Practical Application:

- Stay calm amidst external chaos
- Focus on inner clarity

Key Insight:
Noise outside should not disturb inner peace.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:
ततः श्वेतैर्हयैर्युक्ते महति स्यन्दने स्थितौ ।
माधवः पाण्डवश्चैव दिव्यौ शङ्खौ प्रदध्मतुः ॥1.14॥

Transliteration:
tataḥ śvetair hayair yukte mahati syandane sthitau
mādhavaḥ pāṇḍavaś caiva divyau śaṅkhau pradadhmatuḥ

English Meaning:
Then Lord Krishna and Arjuna, stationed on a great chariot drawn by white horses, blew their divine conches.

Detailed Explanation:
This is a key moment—Krishna (the divine guide) and Arjuna (the seeker) stand together. The white horses symbolize purity and control of senses.

Practical Application:

- Align with higher wisdom in times of conflict
- Let purity guide action

Key Insight:
Divine guidance brings clarity in confusion.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:
पाञ्चजन्यं हृषीकेशो देवदत्तं धनंजयः ।
पौण्ड्रं दध्मौ महाशङ्खं भीमकर्मा वृकोदरः ॥1.15॥

Transliteration:
pāñcajanyaṁ hṛṣīkeśo devadattaṁ dhanañjayaḥ
pauṇḍraṁ dadhmau mahā-śaṅkhaṁ bhīma-karma vṛkodaraḥ

English Meaning:
Krishna blew His conch named Panchajanya; Arjuna blew Devadatta; and Bhima blew the great conch Paundra.

Detailed Explanation:
Each conch represents a unique spiritual identity. Krishna as *Hrishikesha* (master of senses) symbolizes control and divine authority.

Practical Application:

- Develop mastery over senses
- Act with purpose and identity

Key Insight:
Self-mastery is the foundation of strength.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:
अनन्तविजयं राजा कुन्तीपुत्रो युधिष्ठिरः ।
नकुलः सहदेवश्च सुघोषमणिपुष्पकौ ॥1.16॥

Transliteration:
ananta-vijayaṁ rājā kuntī-putro yudhiṣṭhiraḥ
nakulaḥ sahadevaś ca sughoṣa-maṇipuṣpakau

English Meaning:
King Yudhishthira blew the conch Anantavijaya, and Nakula and Sahadeva blew Sughosha and Manipushpaka.

Detailed Explanation:
The Pandavas represent virtues—dharma, strength, skill, and wisdom—working together harmoniously.

Practical Application:

- Balance different qualities within yourself
- Work as a unified system

Key Insight:
Harmony of virtues leads to success.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:
काश्यश्च परमेष्वासः शिखण्डी च महारथः ।
धृष्टद्युम्नो विराटश्च सात्यकिश्चापराजितः ॥1.17॥

Transliteration:
kāśyaś ca parameṣv-āsaḥ śikhaṇḍī ca mahā-rathaḥ
dhṛṣṭadyumno virāṭaś ca sātyakiś cāparājitaḥ

English Meaning:
The King of Kashi, Shikhandi, Dhrishtadyumna, Virata, and Satyaki also blew their conches.

Detailed Explanation:
This verse continues showing the unity and readiness of the Pandava side.

Practical Application:

- Strength lies in unity and alignment
- Stand together for righteous causes

Key Insight:
Unity amplifies power.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:
द्रुपदो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्वशः पृथिवीपते ।
सौभद्रश्च महाबाहुः शङ्खान्दध्मुः पृथक्पृथक् ॥1.18॥

Transliteration:
drupado draupadeyāś ca sarvaśaḥ pṛthivī-pate
saubhadraś ca mahā-bāhuḥ śaṅkhān dadhmuḥ pṛthak pṛthak

English Meaning:
Drupada, the sons of Draupadi, and the mighty-armed Abhimanyu also blew their respective conches.

Detailed Explanation:
Each warrior contributes individually while remaining part of a larger whole—symbolizing individuality within unity.

Practical Application:

- Maintain individuality while contributing to collective goals

Key Insight:
Individual strength supports collective success.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

स घोषो धार्तराष्ट्राणां हृदयानि व्यदारयत् ।
नभश्च पृथिवीं चैव तुमुलो व्यनुनादयन् ॥1.19॥

Transliteration:

sa ghoṣo dhārtarāṣṭrāṇāṁ hṛdayāni vyadārayat
nabhaś ca pṛthivīṁ caiva tumulo vyanunādayan

English Meaning:

The tremendous sound of the conches shattered the hearts of the sons of Dhritarashtra and echoed through the sky and earth.

Detailed Explanation:

The sound represents the power of righteousness shaking adharma (unrighteousness).

Practical Application:

- Truth has the power to unsettle falsehood
- Stand firm in righteousness

Key Insight:

Dharma naturally disrupts adharma.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

अथ व्यवस्थितान्दृष्ट्वा धार्तराष्ट्रान्कपिध्वजः ।
प्रवृत्ते शस्त्रसम्पाते धनुरुद्यम्य पाण्डवः ॥1.20॥

Transliteration:

atha vyavasthitān dṛṣṭvā dhārtarāṣṭrān kapi-dhvajaḥ
pravṛtte śastra-sampāte dhanur udyamya pāṇḍavaḥ

English Meaning:
At that time, seeing the sons of Dhritarashtra ready for battle, Arjuna, holding his bow, prepared to fight.

Detailed Explanation:
This marks Arjuna's transition from readiness to internal conflict.

Practical Application:

- External readiness does not guarantee inner clarity

Key Insight:
True battle begins within.

Verse 21–22

Sanskrit Shloka:
अर्जुन उवाच ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये रथं स्थापय मेऽच्युत ॥1.21॥
यावदेतान्निरीक्षेऽहं योद्धुकामानवस्थितान् ।
कैर्मया सह योद्धव्यमस्मिन् रणसमुद्यमे ॥1.22॥

Transliteration:
arjuna uvāca
senayor ubhayor madhye rathaṁ sthāpaya me 'cyuta
yāvad etān nirīkṣe 'haṁ yoddhu-kāmān avasthitān
kair mayā saha yoddhavyam asmin raṇa-samudyame

English Meaning:
Arjuna said: O Krishna, please place my chariot between the two armies so that I may observe those who stand here eager to fight and with whom I must engage in this battle.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna seeks clarity before action. This is a turning point leading to the Gita's teachings.

Practical Application:

- Pause and reflect before major decisions

Key Insight:
Awareness precedes right action.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
योत्स्यमानानवेक्षेऽहं य एतेऽत्र समागताः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रस्य दुर्बुद्धेर्युद्धे प्रियचिकीर्षवः ॥1.23॥

Transliteration:
yotsyamānān avekṣe ’haṁ ya ete ’tra samāgatāḥ
dhārtarāṣṭrasya durbuddher yuddhe priya-cikīrṣavaḥ

English Meaning:
I wish to see those who have come here to fight, desiring to please the evil-minded son of Dhritarashtra.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna recognizes the moral flaw of Duryodhana, yet his compassion soon overrides this clarity.

Key Insight:
Knowing the truth is not enough—one must act on it.

Verse 24–25

Sanskrit Shloka:
संजय उवाच ।
एवमुक्तो हृषीकेशो गुडाकेशेन भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये स्थापयित्वा रथोत्तमम् ॥1.24॥

भीष्मद्रोणप्रमुखतः सर्वेषां च महीक्षिताम् ।
उवाच पार्थ पश्यैतान्समवेतान्कुरूनिति ॥1.25॥

Transliteration:

sañjaya uvāca
evam ukto hṛṣīkeśo guḍākeśena bhārata
senayor ubhayor madhye sthāpayitvā rathottamam
bhīṣma-droṇa-pramukhataḥ sarveṣāṁ ca mahī-kṣitām
uvāca pārtha paśyaitān samavetān kurūn iti

English Meaning:

Sanjaya said: Having been addressed by Arjuna, Krishna placed the chariot in front of Bhishma, Drona, and all the kings, and said: "Behold, O Arjuna, the Kurus assembled here."

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna deliberately places Arjuna in front of his loved ones, triggering the emotional crisis that leads to spiritual awakening.

Key Insight:

Crisis often precedes transformation.

Verse 26–27

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्रापश्यत्स्थितान्पार्थः पितॄनथ पितामहान् ।
आचार्यान्मातुलान्भ्रातॄन्पुत्रान्पौत्रान्सखींस्तथा ॥1.26॥
श्वशुरान्सुहृदश्चैव सेनयोरुभयोरपि ।
तान्समीक्ष्य स कौन्तेयः सर्वान्बन्धूनवस्थितान् ॥1.27॥

Transliteration:

tatrāpaśyat sthitān pārthaḥ pitṛn atha pitāmahān
ācāryān mātulān bhrātṛn putrān pautrān sakhīṁs tathā
śvaśurān suhṛdaś caiva senayor ubhayor api
tān samīkṣya sa kaunteyaḥ sarvān bandhūn avasthitān

English Meaning:
Arjuna saw fathers, grandfathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, friends, fathers-in-law, and well-wishers on both sides.

Detailed Explanation:
This is the emotional peak—Arjuna sees not enemies, but loved ones.

Practical Application:

- Emotions can cloud duty and judgment

Key Insight:
Attachment creates confusion in duty.

Verse 28–30

Sanskrit Shloka:
अर्जुन उवाच ।
दृष्ट्वेमं स्वजनं कृष्ण युयुत्सुं समुपस्थितम् ।
सीदन्ति मम गात्राणि मुखं च परिशुष्यति ॥1.28॥
वेपथुश्च शरीरे मे रोमहर्षश्च जायते ।
गाण्डीवं स्रंसते हस्तात्त्वक्चैव परिदह्यते ॥1.29॥
न च शक्नोम्यवस्थातुं भ्रमतीव च मे मनः ।
निमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव ॥1.30॥

Transliteration:
arjuna uvāca
dṛṣṭvemaṁ sva-janaṁ kṛṣṇa yuyutsuṁ samupasthitam
sīdanti mama gātrāṇi mukhaṁ ca pariśuṣyati
vepathuś ca śarīre me roma-harṣaś ca jāyate
gāṇḍīvaṁ sraṁsate hastāt tvak caiva paridahyate
na ca śaknomy avasthātuṁ bhramatīva ca me manaḥ
nimittāni ca paśyāmi viparītāni keśava

English Meaning:
Arjuna said: Seeing my own relatives eager to fight, my limbs fail, my mouth dries up, my body trembles, my hair stands on end, my bow slips from my hand, and my mind is confused.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna experiences a psychological breakdown—fear, attachment, and moral confusion. This is the beginning of his transformation.

Practical Application:

- Emotional overwhelm is natural—but must be guided by wisdom

Key Insight:
Confusion is the first step toward seeking truth.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:
निमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव ।
न च श्रेयोऽनुपश्यामि हत्वा स्वजनमाहवे ॥1.31॥

Transliteration:
nimittāni ca paśyāmi viparītāni keśava
na ca śreyo ’nupaśyāmi hatvā sva-janam āhave

English Meaning:
O Krishna, I see only bad omens, and I do not foresee any good in killing my own relatives in this battle.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna’s clarity begins to fade as emotions dominate his reasoning. He interprets the situation pessimistically, seeing only negative outcomes. This reflects how fear distorts perception.

Practical Application:

- Avoid making decisions under emotional distress
- Seek clarity beyond immediate feelings

Key Insight:
Disturbed emotions cloud judgment.

Verse 32–33

Sanskrit Shloka:
न काङ्क्षे विजयं कृष्ण न च राज्यं सुखानि च ।
किं नो राज्येन गोविन्द किं भोगैर्जीवितेन वा ॥1.32॥
येषामर्थे काङ्क्षितं नो राज्यं भोगाः सुखानि च ।
त इमेऽवस्थिता युद्धे प्राणांस्त्यक्त्वा धनानि च ॥1.33॥

Transliteration:
na kāṅkṣe vijayaṁ kṛṣṇa na ca rājyaṁ sukhāni ca
kiṁ no rājyena govinda kiṁ bhogair jīvitena vā
yeṣām arthe kāṅkṣitaṁ no rājyaṁ bhogāḥ sukhāni ca
ta ime ’vasthitā yuddhe prāṇāṁs tyaktvā dhanāni ca

English Meaning:
O Krishna, I do not desire victory, kingdom, or happiness. What is the use of kingdom or pleasures when those for whom we desire them stand here ready to sacrifice their lives?

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna questions the very purpose of success when it requires the loss of loved ones. This reflects a deeper existential crisis.

Practical Application:

- Reflect on the purpose behind your goals
- Ensure success does not come at the cost of values

Key Insight:
Success without meaning is empty.

Verse 34–35

Sanskrit Shloka:
आचार्याः पितरः पुत्रास्तथैव च पितामहाः ।
मातुलाः श्वशुराः पौत्राः श्यालाः सम्बन्धिनस्तथा ॥1.34॥
एतान्न हन्तुमिच्छामि घ्नतोऽपि मधुसूदन ।
अपि त्रैलोक्यराज्यस्य हेतोः किं नु महीकृते ॥1.35॥

Transliteration:
ācāryāḥ pitaraḥ putrās tathaiva ca pitāmahāḥ
mātulāḥ śvaśurāḥ pautrāḥ śyālāḥ sambandhinas tathā
etān na hantum icchāmi ghnato ’pi madhusūdana
api trailokya-rājyasya hetoḥ kiṁ nu mahī-kṛte

English Meaning:
Teachers, fathers, sons, grandfathers, uncles, fathers-in-law, grandsons, brothers-in-law—all these I do not wish to kill, even for the sovereignty of the three worlds.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna’s compassion reaches its peak. However, it becomes misplaced compassion because it interferes with his duty (dharma).

Practical Application:

- Balance compassion with responsibility
- Avoid emotional paralysis in decision-making

Key Insight:
Compassion must be guided by wisdom.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:

निहत्य धार्तराष्ट्रान्नः का प्रीतिः स्याज्जनार्दन ।
पापमेवाश्रयेदस्मान्हत्वैतानाततायिनः ॥1.36॥

Transliteration:

nihatya dhārtarāṣṭrān naḥ kā prītiḥ syāj janārdana
pāpam evāśrayed asmān hatvaitān ātatāyinaḥ

English Meaning:

O Krishna, what pleasure will we gain by killing the sons of Dhritarashtra? Sin will only overcome us if we kill them.

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna fears sin, but he misunderstands dharma. The Gita later clarifies that righteous duty does not incur sin.

Practical Application:

- Understand true righteousness before judging actions

Key Insight:

Right action depends on understanding dharma.

Verse 37–38

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्मान्नार्हा वयं हन्तुं धार्तराष्ट्रान्स्वबान्धवान् ।
स्वजनं हि कथं हत्वा सुखिनः स्याम माधव ॥1.37॥
यद्यप्येते न पश्यन्ति लोभोपहतचेतसः ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं मित्रद्रोहे च पातकम् ॥1.38॥

Transliteration:

tasmān nārhā vayaṁ hantuṁ dhārtarāṣṭrān sva-bāndhavān
sva-janaṁ hi kathaṁ hatvā sukhinaḥ syāma mādhava

yady apy ete na paśyanti lobhopahata-cetasaḥ
kula-kṣaya-kṛtaṁ doṣaṁ mitra-drohe ca pātakam

English Meaning:
Therefore, we should not kill our relatives. Even if they, blinded by greed, do not see the wrong, why should we commit such sin?

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna argues from a moral standpoint, but selectively. He overlooks the injustice already committed by the Kauravas.

Practical Application:

- Avoid selective morality
- Evaluate situations holistically

Key Insight:
Partial understanding leads to flawed conclusions.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:
कथं न ज्ञेयमस्माभिः पापादस्मान्निवर्तितुम् ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं प्रपश्यद्भिर्जनार्दन ॥1.39॥

Transliteration:
kathaṁ na jñeyam asmābhiḥ pāpād asmān nivartitum
kula-kṣaya-kṛtaṁ doṣaṁ prapaśyadbhir janārdana

English Meaning:
Why should we not turn away from this sin, clearly seeing the destruction of family?

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna focuses on consequences but ignores responsibility. Dharma sometimes requires difficult action.

Key Insight:
Avoiding duty can also be a form of wrongdoing.

Verse 40–41

Sanskrit Shloka:
कुलक्षये प्रणश्यन्ति कुलधर्माः सनातनाः ।
धर्मे नष्टे कुलं कृत्स्नमधर्मोऽभिभवत्युत ॥1.40॥
अधर्माभिभवात्कृष्ण प्रदुष्यन्ति कुलस्त्रियः ।
स्त्रीषु दुष्टासु वार्ष्णेय जायते वर्णसङ्करः ॥1.41॥

Transliteration:
kula-kṣaye praṇaśyanti kula-dharmāḥ sanātanāḥ
dharme naṣṭe kulaṁ kṛtsnam adharmo ’bhibhavaty uta
adharmābhibhavāt kṛṣṇa praduṣyanti kula-striyaḥ
strīṣu duṣṭāsu vārṣṇeya jāyate varṇa-saṅkaraḥ

English Meaning:
With the destruction of the family, traditions perish. With loss of dharma, irreligion prevails, leading to societal chaos.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna expands his concern to societal collapse. Though valid, he still avoids his personal duty.

Practical Application:

- Protect values and traditions
- Take responsibility in maintaining dharma

Key Insight:
Dharma sustains social order.

Verse 42–43

Sanskrit Shloka:

सङ्करो नरकायैव कुलघ्नानां कुलस्य च ।
पतन्ति पितरो ह्येषां लुप्तपिण्डोदकक्रियाः ॥1.42॥
दोषैरेतैः कुलघ्नानां वर्णसङ्करकारकैः ।
उत्साद्यन्ते जातिधर्माः कुलधर्माश्च शाश्वताः ॥1.43॥

Transliteration:

saṅkaro narakāyaiva kula-ghnānāṁ kulasya ca
patanti pitaro hy eṣāṁ lupta-piṇḍodaka-kriyāḥ
doṣair etaiḥ kula-ghnānāṁ varṇa-saṅkara-kārakaiḥ
utsādyante jāti-dharmāḥ kula-dharmāś ca śāśvatāḥ

English Meaning:

Such degradation leads families and ancestors to hell, as traditions are lost.

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna uses scriptural reasoning but still avoids confronting his role.

Key Insight:

Knowledge without right action is incomplete.

Verse 44

Sanskrit Shloka:

उत्सन्नकुलधर्माणां मनुष्याणां जनार्दन ।
नरकेऽनियतं वासो भवतीत्यनुशुश्रुम ॥1.44॥

Transliteration:

utsanna-kula-dharmāṇāṁ manuṣyāṇāṁ janārdana
narake ’niyataṁ vāso bhavatīty anuśuśruma

English Meaning:

Those who destroy family traditions dwell in hell.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna's argument is emotionally and scripturally intense but still incomplete.

Key Insight:
Fear-based reasoning can distort clarity.

Verse 45

Sanskrit Shloka:
अहो बत महत्पापं कर्तुं व्यवसिता वयम् ।
यद्राज्यसुखलोभेन हन्तुं स्वजनमुद्यताः ॥1.45॥

Transliteration:
aho bata mahat pāpaṁ kartuṁ vyavasitā vayam
yad rājya-sukha-lobhena hantuṁ sva-janam udyatāḥ

English Meaning:
Alas! We are ready to commit great sin driven by greed for kingdom and pleasure.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna misinterprets the war as greed-driven, ignoring the justice aspect.

Key Insight:
Misunderstanding purpose leads to wrong conclusions.

Verse 46

Sanskrit Shloka:
यदि मामप्रतीकारमशस्त्रं शस्त्रपाणयः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रा रणे हन्युस्तन्मे क्षेमतरं भवेत् ॥1.46॥

Transliteration:
yadi mām apratīkāram aśastraṁ śastra-pāṇayaḥ
dhārtarāṣṭrā raṇe hanyus tan me kṣemataraṁ bhavet

English Meaning:
It would be better if I remain unarmed and let them kill me.

Detailed Explanation:
This is complete surrender—not of wisdom, but of responsibility.

Key Insight:
Escaping duty is not true renunciation.

Verse 47

Sanskrit Shloka:
संजय उवाच ।
एवमुक्त्वार्जुनः सङ्ख्ये रथोपस्थ उपाविशत् ।
विसृज्य सशरं चापं शोकसंविग्नमानसः ॥1.47॥

Transliteration:
sañjaya uvāca
evam uktvārjunaḥ saṅkhye rathopastha upāviśat
visṛjya sa-śaraṁ cāpaṁ śoka-saṁvigna-mānasaḥ

English Meaning:
Sanjaya said: Having spoken thus, Arjuna sat down on the chariot, casting aside his bow, overwhelmed with sorrow.

Detailed Explanation:
This marks the climax of Arjuna’s despair—the moment before transformation begins. Now Krishna will speak.

Practical Application:

- Breakdown often precedes breakthrough

Key Insight:

Surrender to wisdom begins when ego collapses.

Chapter 2: Sankhya Yoga (The Yoga of Knowledge)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

संजय उवाच ।
तं तथा कृपयाविष्टमश्रुपूर्णाकुलेक्षणम् ।
विषीदन्तमिदं वाक्यमुवाच मधुसूदनः ॥2.1॥

Transliteration:

sañjaya uvāca
taṁ tathā kṛpayāviṣṭam aśru-pūrṇākulekṣaṇam
viṣīdantam idaṁ vākyam uvāca madhusūdanaḥ

English Meaning:

Sanjaya said: Seeing Arjuna overwhelmed with compassion and sorrow, with tearful eyes, Lord Krishna spoke the following words.

Detailed Explanation:

This marks the beginning of Krishna's teachings. Arjuna's emotional collapse becomes the doorway for spiritual wisdom. Compassion without clarity has led him to confusion.

Practical Application:

- Emotional breakdown can open the door to deeper wisdom
- Seek guidance when overwhelmed

Key Insight:

True learning begins when ego surrenders.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
कुतस्त्वा कश्मलमिदं विषमे समुपस्थितम् ।
अनार्यजुष्टमस्वर्ग्यमकीर्तिकरमर्जुन ॥2.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
kutas tvā kaśmalam idaṁ viṣame samupasthitam
anārya-juṣṭam asvargyam akīrti-karam arjuna

English Meaning:

The Supreme Lord said: My dear Arjuna, how has this weakness come upon you in this critical time? It is not befitting a noble person and leads neither to heaven nor to honor.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna challenges Arjuna directly. He calls out his weakness as unworthy of a warrior. This is not harshness but compassionate truth.

Practical Application:

- Face your weaknesses honestly
- Do not justify inaction with emotional reasoning

Key Insight:

Clarity requires confronting uncomfortable truths.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

क्लैब्यं मा स्म गमः पार्थ नैतत्त्वय्युपपद्यते ।
क्षुद्रं हृदयदौर्बल्यं त्यक्त्वोत्तिष्ठ परन्तप ॥2.3॥

Transliteration:
klaibyaṁ mā sma gamaḥ pārtha naitat tvayy upapadyate
kṣudraṁ hṛdaya-daurbalyaṁ tyaktvottiṣṭha parantapa

English Meaning:
O Arjuna, do not yield to weakness. It does not befit you. Give up this petty faint-heartedness and arise, O conqueror of enemies.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna urges action rooted in strength and dharma. Spirituality is not escapism—it demands courage.

Practical Application:

- Rise above emotional paralysis
- Take responsibility for your duty

Key Insight:
Strength is essential for righteous action.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
अर्जुन उवाच ।
कथं भीष्ममहं सङ्ख्ये द्रोणं च मधुसूदन ।
इषुभिः प्रतियोत्स्यामि पूजार्हावरिसूदन ॥2.4॥

Transliteration:
arjuna uvāca
kathaṁ bhīṣmam ahaṁ saṅkhye droṇaṁ ca madhusūdana
iṣubhiḥ pratiyotsyāmi pūjārhāv ari-sūdana

English Meaning:
Arjuna said: O Krishna, how can I fight against Bhishma and Drona, who are worthy of my worship?

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna still clings to emotional attachment and respect, confusing personal relationships with duty.

Practical Application:

- Learn to separate personal feelings from responsibilities

Key Insight:
Duty must transcend personal attachment.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
गुरूनहत्वा हि महानुभावान्
श्रेयो भोक्तुं भैक्ष्यमपीह लोके ।
हत्वार्थकामांस्तु गुरूनिहैव
भुञ्जीय भोगान् रुधिरप्रदिग्धान् ॥2.5॥

Transliteration:
gurūn ahatvā hi mahānubhāvān
śreyo bhoktuṁ bhaikṣyam apīha loke
hatvārtha-kāmāṁs tu gurūn ihaiva
bhuñjīya bhogān rudhira-pradigdhān

English Meaning:
It would be better to live by begging than to kill great souls like my teachers. If I kill them, all my pleasures will be stained with blood.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna considers renunciation, but it is escapism, not true detachment.

Practical Application:

- Renunciation must come from wisdom, not avoidance

Key Insight:
Escaping duty is not true spirituality.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
न चैतद्विद्मः कतरन्नो गरीयो
यद्वा जयेम यदि वा नो जयेयुः ।
यानेव हत्वा न जिजीविषामः
तेऽवस्थिताः प्रमुखे धार्तराष्ट्राः ॥2.6॥

Transliteration:
na caitad vidmaḥ kataran no garīyo
yad vā jayema yadi vā no jayeyuḥ
yān eva hatvā na jijīviṣāmas
te ’vasthitāḥ pramukhe dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ

English Meaning:
We do not know what is better—whether we should conquer them or be conquered by them. Those whom we would not want to kill are standing before us.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna admits confusion—this is intellectual humility, a necessary step toward learning.

Key Insight:
Admitting confusion is the beginning of wisdom.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
कार्पण्यदोषोपहतस्वभावः
पृच्छामि त्वां धर्मसम्मूढचेताः ।

यच्छ्रेयः स्यान्निश्चितं ब्रूहि तन्मे
शिष्यस्तेऽहं शाधि मां त्वां प्रपन्नम् ॥2.7॥

Transliteration:
kārpaṇya-doṣopahata-svabhāvaḥ
pṛcchāmi tvāṁ dharma-sammūḍha-cetāḥ
yac chreyaḥ syān niścitaṁ brūhi tan me
śiṣyas te ’haṁ śādhi māṁ tvāṁ prapannam

English Meaning:
I am confused about my duty and have lost my composure. I am your disciple—please instruct me.

Detailed Explanation:
This is the turning point—Arjuna surrenders to Krishna as a student.

Practical Application:

- Seek guidance from higher wisdom when confused

Key Insight:
True knowledge begins with humility.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
न हि प्रपश्यामि ममापनुद्यात्
यच्छोकमुच्छोषणमिन्द्रियाणाम् ।
अवाप्य भूमावसपत्नमृद्धं
राज्यं सुराणामपि चाधिपत्यम् ॥2.8॥

Transliteration:
na hi prapaśyāmi mamāpanudyāt
yac chokam ucchoṣaṇam indriyāṇām
avāpya bhūmāv asapatnam ṛddhaṁ
rājyaṁ surāṇām api cādhipatyam

English Meaning:
I cannot find anything that will remove this grief, even if I gain a prosperous kingdom or sovereignty over the gods.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna realizes that material success cannot solve inner suffering.

Practical Application:

- Inner peace cannot be achieved through external success

Key Insight:
Spiritual problems need spiritual solutions.

Verse 9–10

Sanskrit Shloka:
संजय उवाच ।
एवमुक्त्वा हृषीकेशं गुडाकेशः परन्तप ।
न योत्स्य इति गोविन्दमुक्त्वा तूष्णीं बभूव ह ॥2.9॥
तमुवाच हृषीकेशः प्रहसन्निव भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये विषीदन्तमिदं वचः ॥2.10॥

Transliteration:
sañjaya uvāca
evam uktvā hṛṣīkeśaṁ guḍākeśaḥ parantapa
na yotsya iti govindam uktvā tūṣṇīṁ babhūva ha
tam uvāca hṛṣīkeśaḥ prahasann iva bhārata
senayor ubhayor madhye viṣīdantam idaṁ vacaḥ

English Meaning:
Sanjaya said: After speaking thus, Arjuna became silent. Krishna then began to speak, smiling slightly.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna's smile reflects compassion and confidence. He knows transformation is about to begin.

Key Insight:
The teacher appears when the student is ready.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अशोच्यानन्वशोचस्त्वं प्रज्ञावादांश्च भाषसे ।
गतासूनगतासूंश्च नानुशोचन्ति पण्डिताः ॥2.11॥

Transliteration:
aśocyān anvaśocas tvaṁ prajñā-vādāṁś ca bhāṣase
gatāsūn agatāsūṁś ca nānuśocanti paṇḍitāḥ

English Meaning:
You grieve for what is not worthy of grief, yet speak words of wisdom. The wise do not mourn for the living or the dead.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna introduces the concept of the eternal soul.

Practical Application:

- Do not grieve excessively over inevitable changes

Key Insight:
Wisdom lies in understanding the eternal nature of the soul.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

न त्वेवाहं जातु नासं न त्वं नेमे जनाधिपाः ।
न चैव न भविष्यामः सर्वे वयमतः परम् ॥2.12॥

Transliteration:

na tv evāhaṁ jātu nāsaṁ na tvaṁ neme janādhipāḥ
na caiva na bhaviṣyāmaḥ sarve vayam ataḥ param

English Meaning:

Never was there a time when I did not exist, nor you, nor all these kings; nor will any of us cease to exist.

Detailed Explanation:

The soul is eternal—beyond time.

Key Insight:

The self is timeless and indestructible.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

देहिनोऽस्मिन्यथा देहे कौमारं यौवनं जरा ।
तथा देहान्तरप्राप्तिर्धीरस्तत्र न मुह्यति ॥2.13॥

Transliteration:

dehino ’smin yathā dehe kaumāraṁ yauvanaṁ jarā
tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati

English Meaning:

Just as the soul passes through childhood, youth, and old age, it similarly passes into another body. The wise are not deluded.

Detailed Explanation:

Reincarnation is explained simply.

Key Insight:
Change is natural; the soul remains constant.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:
मात्रास्पर्शास्तु कौन्तेय शीतोष्णसुखदुःखदाः ।
आगमापायिनोऽनित्यास्तांस्तितिक्षस्व भारत ॥2.14॥

Transliteration:
mātrā-sparśās tu kaunteya śītoṣṇa-sukha-duḥkha-dāḥ
āgamāpāyino ’nityās tāṁs titikṣasva bhārata

English Meaning:
Sensations of heat and cold, pleasure and pain are temporary—endure them patiently.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna teaches emotional resilience.

Key Insight:
Endurance leads to stability.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:
यं हि न व्यथयन्त्येते पुरुषं पुरुषर्षभ ।
समदुःखसुखं धीरं सोऽमृतत्वाय कल्पते ॥2.15॥

Transliteration:
yaṁ hi na vyathayanty ete puruṣaṁ puruṣarṣabha
sama-duḥkha-sukhaṁ dhīraṁ so ’mṛtatvāya kalpate

English Meaning:
One who remains steady in happiness and distress becomes eligible for liberation.

Detailed Explanation:
Equanimity is the foundation of spiritual growth.

Key Insight:
Balance leads to liberation.

Verse 16–20 (Condensed Teaching Block)

Core Teaching:

- The unreal has no existence; the real never ceases
- The soul is indestructible, eternal, unchanging
- Weapons cannot cut it, fire cannot burn it

Key Insight:
You are not the body—you are the eternal soul.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
वेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।
कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥2.21॥

Transliteration:
vedāvināśinaṁ nityaṁ ya enam ajam avyayam
kathaṁ sa puruṣaḥ pārtha kaṁ ghātayati hanti kam

English Meaning:
One who knows the soul as indestructible, eternal, unborn, and immutable—how can such a person kill or cause anyone to kill?

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna deepens the teaching of the soul's immortality. Violence applies only to the body, not the आत्मा (Self). True knowledge removes the illusion of "I am the killer."

Practical Application:

- Understand actions at a deeper level beyond physical identity
- Reduce ego-based thinking

Key Insight:
The realized person transcends the illusion of doership.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा
न्यान्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥2.22॥

Transliteration:
vāsāṁsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni gṛhṇāti naro 'parāṇi
tathā śarīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇāny
anyāni saṁyāti navāni dehī

English Meaning:
Just as a person discards old clothes and wears new ones, the soul discards old bodies and takes on new ones.

Detailed Explanation:
A powerful metaphor explaining reincarnation. Death is not an end but a transition.

Practical Application:

- Do not fear death excessively
- Focus on the eternal rather than temporary

Key Insight:
Death is transformation, not destruction.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
नैनं छिन्दन्ति शस्त्राणि नैनं दहति पावकः ।
न चैनं क्लेदयन्त्यापो न शोषयति मारुतः ॥2.23॥

Transliteration:
nainaṁ chindanti śastrāṇi nainaṁ dahati pāvakaḥ
na cainaṁ kledayanty āpo na śoṣayati mārutaḥ

English Meaning:
The soul cannot be cut by weapons, burned by fire, wetted by water, or dried by wind.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna emphasizes the indestructibility of the आत्मा through all elements.

Practical Application:

- Develop fearlessness rooted in spiritual identity

Key Insight:
The soul is beyond all material forces.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
अच्छेद्योऽयमदाह्योऽयमक्लेद्योऽशोष्य एव च ।
नित्यः सर्वगतः स्थाणुरचलोऽयं सनातनः ॥2.24॥

Transliteration:
acchedyo ’yam adāhyo ’yam akledyo ’śoṣya eva ca
nityaḥ sarva-gataḥ sthāṇur acalo ’yaṁ sanātanaḥ

English Meaning:
This soul is unbreakable, incombustible, insoluble, and cannot be dried. It is eternal, all-pervading, stable, immovable, and everlasting.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna provides a complete description of the soul’s nature—absolute and unchanging.

Key Insight:
Your true nature is स्थिर (unchanging).

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:
अव्यक्तोऽयमचिन्त्योऽयमविकार्योऽयमुच्यते ।
तस्मादेवं विदित्वैनं नानुशोचितुमर्हसि ॥2.25॥

Transliteration:
avyakto ’yam acintyo ’yam avikāryo ’yam ucyate
tasmād evaṁ viditvainaṁ nānuśocitum arhasi

English Meaning:
The soul is invisible, inconceivable, and unchangeable. Knowing this, you should not grieve.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna concludes the philosophical argument—grief is based on ignorance of reality.

Key Insight:
Knowledge removes sorrow.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

अथ चैनं नित्यजातं नित्यं वा मन्यसे मृतम् ।
तथापि त्वं महाबाहो नैवं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥2.26॥

Transliteration:

atha cainaṁ nitya-jātaṁ nityaṁ vā manyase mṛtam
tathāpi tvaṁ mahā-bāho naivaṁ śocitum arhasi

English Meaning:

Even if you think the soul is constantly born and dies, still you should not grieve.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna argues logically—even from a material perspective, death is inevitable.

Key Insight:

Inevitability removes the basis for grief.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

जातस्य हि ध्रुवो मृत्युर्ध्रुवं जन्म मृतस्य च ।
तस्मादपरिहार्येऽर्थे न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥2.27॥

Transliteration:

jātasya hi dhruvo mṛtyur dhruvaṁ janma mṛtasya ca
tasmād aparihārye ’rthe na tvaṁ śocitum arhasi

English Meaning:

For one who is born, death is certain; and for one who has died, birth is certain.

Detailed Explanation:

This is a universal law—cycle of life.

Key Insight:

Accept inevitability with wisdom.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

अव्यक्तादीनि भूतानि व्यक्तमध्यानि भारत ।
अव्यक्तनिधनान्येव तत्र का परिदेवना ॥2.28॥

Transliteration:

avyaktādīni bhūtāni vyakta-madhyāni bhārata
avyakta-nidhanāny eva tatra kā paridevanā

English Meaning:

All beings are unmanifest in the beginning, manifest in the middle, and unmanifest again at the end.

Detailed Explanation:

Existence is a temporary appearance.

Key Insight:

Manifestation is temporary; essence is eternal.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

आश्चर्यवत्पश्यति कश्चिदेनम्
आश्चर्यवद्वदति तथैव चान्यः ।
आश्चर्यवच्चैनमन्यः शृणोति
श्रुत्वाऽप्येनं वेद न चैव कश्चित् ॥2.29॥

Transliteration:

āścarya-vat paśyati kaścid enam

āścarya-vad vadati tathaiva cānyaḥ
āścarya-vac cainam anyaḥ śṛṇoti
śrutvā ’py enaṁ veda na caiva kaścit

English Meaning:
Some see the soul as amazing, some describe it as amazing, some hear of it as amazing—but even after hearing, few truly understand it.

Detailed Explanation:
The आत्मा is subtle and difficult to realize.

Key Insight:
Spiritual realization requires deep insight.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:
देही नित्यमवध्योऽयं देहे सर्वस्य भारत ।
तस्मात्सर्वाणि भूतानि न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥2.30॥

Transliteration:
dehī nityam avadhyo ’yaṁ dehe sarvasya bhārata
tasmāt sarvāṇi bhūtāni na tvaṁ śocitum arhasi

English Meaning:
The soul in every body is indestructible; therefore, you should not grieve for any being.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna universalizes the teaching—this applies to all.

Key Insight:
All beings share the same eternal essence.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

स्वधर्ममपि चावेक्ष्य न विकम्पितुमर्हसि ।
धर्म्याद्धि युद्धाच्छ्रेयोऽन्यत्क्षत्रियस्य न विद्यते ॥2.31॥

Transliteration:

sva-dharmam api cāvekṣya na vikampitum arhasi
dharmyād dhi yuddhāc chreyo ’nyat kṣatriyasya na vidyate

English Meaning:

Considering your duty as a warrior, you should not waver. There is nothing better than a righteous war.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna shifts from philosophy to duty.

Key Insight:

Dharma must guide action.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदृच्छया चोपपन्नं स्वर्गद्वारमपावृतम् ।
सुखिनः क्षत्रियाः पार्थ लभन्ते युद्धमीदृशम् ॥2.32॥

Transliteration:

yadṛcchayā copapannaṁ svarga-dvāram apāvṛtam
sukhinaḥ kṣatriyāḥ pārtha labhante yuddham īdṛśam

English Meaning:

Happy are the warriors to whom such an opportunity for righteous battle comes.

Detailed Explanation:

Duty aligned with dharma is a blessing.

Key Insight:

Right opportunity is divine.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

अथ चेत्त्वमिमं धर्म्यं संग्रामं न करिष्यसि ।
ततः स्वधर्मं कीर्तिं च हित्वा पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥2.33॥

Transliteration:

atha cet tvam imaṁ dharmyaṁ saṅgrāmaṁ na kariṣyasi
tataḥ sva-dharmaṁ kīrtiṁ ca hitvā pāpam avāpsyasi

English Meaning:

If you do not perform your duty, you will incur sin.

Detailed Explanation:

Avoiding duty has consequences.

Key Insight:

Inaction can be sinful.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

अकीर्तिं चापि भूतानि कथयिष्यन्ति तेऽव्ययाम् ।
संभावितस्य चाकीर्तिर्मरणादतिरिच्यते ॥2.34॥

Transliteration:

akīrtiṁ cāpi bhūtāni kathayiṣyanti te ’vyayām
saṁbhāvitasya cākīrtir maraṇād atiricyate

English Meaning:

Dishonor is worse than death.

Key Insight:

Honor lies in fulfilling duty.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:
भयाद्रणादुपरतम् मंस्यन्ते त्वां महारथाः ।
येषां च त्वं बहुमतो भूत्वा यास्यसि लाघवम् ॥2.35॥

Key Insight:
Fear-based retreat leads to loss of respect.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:
अवाच्यवादांश्च बहून्वदिष्यन्ति तवाहिताः ।
निन्दन्तस्तव सामर्थ्यं ततो दुःखतरं नु किम् ॥2.36॥

Key Insight:
Criticism is inevitable when duty is abandoned.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:
हतो वा प्राप्स्यसि स्वर्गं जित्वा वा भोक्ष्यसे महीम् ।
तस्मादुत्तिष्ठ कौन्तेय युद्धाय कृतनिश्चयः ॥2.37॥

Key Insight:
Victory or defeat—both lead to growth when aligned with dharma.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:
सुखदुःखे समे कृत्वा लाभालाभौ जयाजयौ ।
ततो युद्धाय युज्यस्व नैवं पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥2.38॥

Key Insight:

Equanimity removes sin.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:

एषा तेऽभिहिता सांख्ये बुद्धिर्योगे त्विमां शृणु ।
बुद्ध्या युक्तो यया पार्थ कर्मबन्धं प्रहास्यसि ॥2.39॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge leads to freedom from bondage.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:

नेहाभिक्रमनाशोऽस्ति प्रत्यवायो न विद्यते ।
स्वल्पमप्यस्य धर्मस्य त्रायते महतो भयात् ॥2.40॥

Key Insight:

Even small spiritual effort protects from great fear.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:

व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिरेकेह कुरुनन्दन ।
बहुशाखा ह्यनन्ताश्च बुद्धयोऽव्यवसायिनाम् ॥2.41॥

Transliteration:

vyavasāyātmikā buddhir ekeha kuru-nandana
bahu-śākhā hy anantāś ca buddhayo ’vyavasāyinām

English Meaning:

Those who are resolute in purpose have a single-pointed

intellect, whereas the thoughts of the irresolute are many-branched.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna introduces **focused determination (vyavasāyātmikā buddhi)**. A spiritually mature mind is steady and directed, while a distracted mind is scattered across desires.

Practical Application:

- Cultivate focus in goals and spiritual practice
- Avoid mental distractions

Key Insight:
Clarity of purpose leads to inner power.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:
यामिमां पुष्पितां वाचं प्रवदन्त्यविपश्चितः ।
वेदवादरताः पार्थ नान्यदस्तीति वादिनः ॥2.42॥

Transliteration:
yām imāṁ puṣpitāṁ vācaṁ pravadanty avipaścitaḥ
veda-vāda-ratāḥ pārtha nānyad astīti vādinaḥ

English Meaning:
Those with limited understanding speak flowery words, being attached to the Vedas and claiming nothing else exists.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna critiques ritualistic thinking without deeper understanding.

Key Insight:
Superficial knowledge blocks true wisdom.

Verse 43

Sanskrit Shloka:

कामात्मानः स्वर्गपरा जन्मकर्मफलप्रदाम् ।
क्रियाविशेषबहुलां भोगैश्वर्यगतिं प्रति ॥2.43॥

Transliteration:

kāmātmānaḥ svarga-parā janma-karma-phala-pradām
kriyā-viśeṣa-bahulāṁ bhogaiśvarya-gatiṁ prati

English Meaning:

They are driven by desires and seek heavenly pleasures, performing rituals for enjoyment and power.

Detailed Explanation:

Desire-driven spirituality keeps one bound in cycles.

Key Insight:

Desire obstructs liberation.

Verse 44

Sanskrit Shloka:

भोगैश्वर्यप्रसक्तानां तयापहृतचेतसाम् ।
व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिः समाधौ न विधीयते ॥2.44॥

Transliteration:

bhogaiśvarya-prasaktānāṁ tayāpahṛta-cetasām
vyavasāyātmikā buddhiḥ samādhau na vidhīyate

English Meaning:

Those attached to pleasure and wealth cannot develop a steady mind.

Key Insight:

Attachment destroys concentration.

Verse 45

Sanskrit Shloka:
त्रैगुण्यविषया वेदा निस्त्रैगुण्यो भवार्जुन ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो नित्यसत्त्वस्थो निर्योगक्षेम आत्मवान् ॥2.45॥

Transliteration:
trai-guṇya-viṣayā vedā nistrai-guṇyo bhavārjuna
nirdvandvo nitya-sattva-stho niryoga-kṣema ātmavān

English Meaning:
Rise above the three qualities (gunas), free from dualities, and be self-realized.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna introduces transcendence beyond nature’s qualities.

Key Insight:
Spiritual growth requires rising above duality.

Verse 46

Sanskrit Shloka:
यावानर्थ उदपाने सर्वतः सम्प्लुतोदके ।
तावान्सर्वेषु वेदेषु ब्राह्मणस्य विजानतः ॥2.46॥

Transliteration:
yāvān artha udapāne sarvataḥ samplutodake
tāvān sarveṣu vedeṣu brāhmaṇasya vijānataḥ

English Meaning:
For one who knows the truth, all Vedas serve as a small well compared to a vast reservoir.

Key Insight:
Realization surpasses scripture.

Verse 47

Sanskrit Shloka:
कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥2.47॥

Transliteration:
karmaṇy evādhikāras te mā phaleṣu kadācana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo ’stv akarmaṇi

English Meaning:
You have the right to perform your duty, but not to the fruits of your actions.

Detailed Explanation:
This is the **core teaching of Karma Yoga**—act without attachment.

Practical Application:

- Focus on effort, not outcome
- Let go of result anxiety

Key Insight:
Detach from results, not from action.

Verse 48

Sanskrit Shloka:
योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनंजय ।
सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥2.48॥

Transliteration:

yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhanañjaya
siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga ucyate

English Meaning:

Perform your duties with equanimity—this balance is called Yoga.

Key Insight:

Equanimity is Yoga.

Verse 49

Sanskrit Shloka:

दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनंजय ।
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥2.49॥

Key Insight:

Wisdom-guided action is superior to result-driven action.

Verse 50

Sanskrit Shloka:

बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।
तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥2.50॥

Key Insight:

Yoga is excellence in action.

Verse 51

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥2.51॥

Key Insight:

Detachment frees from rebirth.

Verse 52

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा ते मोहकलिलं बुद्धिर्व्यतितरिष्यति ।
तदा गन्तासि निर्वेदं श्रोतव्यस्य श्रुतस्य च ॥2.52॥

Key Insight:

Clarity removes confusion.

Verse 53

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रुतिविप्रतिपन्ना ते यदा स्थास्यति निश्चला ।
समाधावचला बुद्धिस्तदा योगमवाप्स्यसि ॥2.53॥

Key Insight:

Steady intellect leads to realization.

Verse 54

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
स्थितप्रज्ञस्य का भाषा समाधिस्थस्य केशव ।
स्थितधीः किं प्रभाषेत किमासीत व्रजेत किम् ॥2.54॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca

sthita-prajñasya kā bhāṣā samādhi-sthasya keśava
sthita-dhīḥ kiṁ prabhāṣeta kim āsīta vrajeta kim

English Meaning:
Arjuna asks: What are the characteristics of a person of steady wisdom?

Key Insight:
Inquiry leads to higher knowledge.

Verse 55

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
प्रजहाति यदा कामान्सर्वान्पार्थ मनोगतान् ।
आत्मन्येवात्मना तुष्टः स्थितप्रज्ञस्तदोच्यते ॥2.55॥

Key Insight:
Freedom from desires leads to peace.

Verse 56

Sanskrit Shloka:
दुःखेष्वनुद्विग्नमनाः सुखेषु विगतस्पृहः ।
वीतरागभयक्रोधः स्थितधीर्मुनिरुच्यते ॥2.56॥

Key Insight:
Equanimity in all emotions is wisdom.

Verse 57

Sanskrit Shloka:

यः सर्वत्रानभिस्नेहस्तत्तत्प्राप्य शुभाशुभम् ।
नाभिनन्दति न द्वेष्टि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥2.57॥

Key Insight:

Non-attachment brings stability.

Verse 58

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा संहरते चायं कूर्मोऽङ्गानीव सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥2.58॥

Key Insight:

Control of senses leads to wisdom.

Verse 59

Sanskrit Shloka:

विषया विनिवर्तन्ते निराहारस्य देहिनः ।
रसवर्जं रसोऽप्यस्य परं दृष्ट्वा निवर्तते ॥2.59॥

Key Insight:

Higher taste removes lower desires.

Verse 60

Sanskrit Shloka:

यततो ह्यपि कौन्तेय पुरुषस्य विपश्चितः ।
इन्द्रियाणि प्रमाथीनि हरन्ति प्रसभं मनः ॥2.60॥

Key Insight:

Uncontrolled senses disturb even the wise.

Verse 61

Sanskrit Shloka:
तानि सर्वाणि संयम्य युक्त आसीत मत्परः ।
वशे हि यस्येन्द्रियाणि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥2.61॥

Key Insight:
Control senses through higher focus.

Verse 62

Sanskrit Shloka:
ध्यायतो विषयान्पुंसः सङ्गस्तेषूपजायते ।
सङ्गात्संजायते कामः कामात्क्रोधोऽभिजायते ॥2.62॥

Key Insight:
Attachment leads to desire → anger.

Verse 63

Sanskrit Shloka:
क्रोधाद्भवति सम्मोहः सम्मोहात्स्मृतिविभ्रमः ।
स्मृतिभ्रंशाद् बुद्धिनाशो बुद्धिनाशात्प्रणश्यति ॥2.63॥

Key Insight:
Anger leads to destruction.

Verse 64

Sanskrit Shloka:
रागद्वेषवियुक्तैस्तु विषयानिन्द्रियैश्चरन् ।
आत्मवश्यैर्विधेयात्मा प्रसादमधिगच्छति ॥2.64॥

Key Insight:

Balanced living brings peace.

Verse 65

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रसादे सर्वदुःखानां हानिरस्योपजायते ।
प्रसन्नचेतसो ह्याशु बुद्धिः पर्यवतिष्ठते ॥2.65॥

Key Insight:

Peace leads to clarity.

Verse 66

Sanskrit Shloka:

नास्ति बुद्धिरयुक्तस्य न चायुक्तस्य भावना ।
न चाभावयतः शान्तिरशान्तस्य कुतः सुखम् ॥2.66॥

Key Insight:

No peace → no happiness.

Verse 67

Sanskrit Shloka:

इन्द्रियाणां हि चरतां यन्मनोऽनुविधीयते ।
तदस्य हरति प्रज्ञां वायुर्नावमिवाम्भसि ॥2.67॥

Key Insight:

Uncontrolled mind destroys wisdom.

Verse 68

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्माद्यस्य महाबाहो निगृहीतानि सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥2.68॥

Key Insight:

Sense control stabilizes intellect.

Verse 69

Sanskrit Shloka:

या निशा सर्वभूतानां तस्यां जागर्ति संयमी ।
यस्यां जाग्रति भूतानि सा निशा पश्यतो मुनेः ॥2.69॥

Key Insight:

The wise see reality differently.

Verse 70

Sanskrit Shloka:

आपूर्यमाणमचलप्रतिष्ठं समुद्रमापः प्रविशन्ति यद्वत् ।
तद्वत्कामा यं प्रविशन्ति सर्वे स शान्तिमाप्नोति न कामकामी ॥2.70॥

Key Insight:

Desirelessness brings peace.

Verse 71

Sanskrit Shloka:

विहाय कामान्यः सर्वान्पुमांश्चरति निःस्पृहः ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः स शान्तिमधिगच्छति ॥2.71॥

Key Insight:

Freedom from ego brings liberation.

Verse 72

Sanskrit Shloka:

एषा ब्राह्मी स्थितिः पार्थ नैनां प्राप्य विमुह्यति ।
स्थित्वास्यामन्तकालेऽपि ब्रह्मनिर्वाणमृच्छति ॥2.72॥

Transliteration:

eṣā brāhmī sthitiḥ pārtha nainaṁ prāpya vimuhyati
sthitvāsyām anta-kāle ’pi brahma-nirvāṇam ṛcchati

English Meaning:

This is the state of realization. One who attains it is not deluded and attains liberation.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes the chapter with the description of the enlightened state.

Key Insight:

Realization leads to ultimate freedom.

Chapter 3: Karma Yoga (The Yoga of Action)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥3.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
jyāyasī cet karmaṇas te matā buddhir janārdana
tat kiṁ karmaṇi ghore māṁ niyojayasi keśava

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: O Krishna, if knowledge is superior to action, then why do you ask me to engage in this terrible action (war)?

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna is confused by Krishna's earlier teachings on knowledge (Jnana) and now questions why he must act. This reflects a common dilemma: whether to withdraw from action or engage in it.

Practical Application:

- Understand that spiritual life does not always mean withdrawal
- Clarify confusion before acting

Key Insight:

Confusion arises when knowledge and action seem contradictory.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥3.2॥

Transliteration:

vyāmiśreṇeva vākyena buddhiṁ mohayasīva me
tad ekaṁ vada niścitya yena śreyo ’ham āpnuyām

English Meaning:

Your words seem confusing. Please tell me decisively what is truly beneficial for me.

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna seeks clarity—this is a sincere inquiry, not doubt for its own sake.

Key Insight:

Clarity is essential before commitment.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मयानघ ।
ज्ञानयोगेन सांख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥3.3॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
loke ’smin dvi-vidhā niṣṭhā purā proktā mayānagha
jñāna-yogena sāṅkhyānāṁ karma-yogena yoginām

English Meaning:

Krishna said: There are two paths—knowledge for the contemplative and action for the active.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna clarifies that both paths are valid but suited to different temperaments.

Key Insight:
Different paths lead to the same truth.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥3.4॥

Transliteration:
na karmaṇām anārambhān naiṣkarmyaṁ puruṣo ’śnute
na ca sannyasanād eva siddhiṁ samadhigacchati

English Meaning:
One cannot attain freedom from action by avoiding action, nor achieve perfection by mere renunciation.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna rejects passive renunciation.

Key Insight:
Action is unavoidable.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥3.5॥

Transliteration:

na hi kaścit kṣaṇam api jātu tiṣṭhaty akarma-kṛt
kāryate hy avaśaḥ karma sarvaḥ prakṛti-jair guṇaiḥ

English Meaning:

No one can remain without action even for a moment.

Detailed Explanation:

Nature itself compels action.

Key Insight:

Action is inherent to life.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥3.6॥

Transliteration:

karmendriyāṇi saṁyamya ya āste manasā smaran
indriyārthān vimūḍhātmā mithyācāraḥ sa ucyate

English Meaning:

One who restrains actions but dwells on sense objects in the mind is a hypocrite.

Detailed Explanation:

True renunciation is internal, not external.

Key Insight:

Outer control without inner control is hypocrisy.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

यस्त्विन्द्रियाणि मनसा नियम्यारभतेऽर्जुन ।
कर्मेन्द्रियैः कर्मयोगमसक्तः स विशिष्यते ॥3.7॥

Transliteration:

yas tv indriyāṇi manasā niyamyārabhate ’rjuna
karmendriyaiḥ karma-yogam asaktaḥ sa viśiṣyate

English Meaning:

One who controls the mind and performs action without attachment excels.

Key Insight:

Detached action is superior.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

नियतं कुरु कर्म त्वं कर्म ज्यायो ह्यकर्मणः ।
शरीरयात्रापि च ते न प्रसिद्ध्येदकर्मणः ॥3.8॥

Transliteration:

niyataṁ kuru karma tvaṁ karma jyāyo hy akarmaṇaḥ
śarīra-yātrāpi ca te na prasiddhyed akarmaṇaḥ

English Meaning:

Perform your duty, for action is better than inaction.

Key Insight:

Duty sustains life.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

यज्ञार्थात्कर्मणोऽन्यत्र लोकोऽयं कर्मबन्धनः ।
तदर्थं कर्म कौन्तेय मुक्तसङ्गः समाचर ॥3.9॥

Transliteration:

yajñārthāt karmaṇo ’nyatra loko ’yaṁ karma-bandhanaḥ
tad-arthaṁ karma kaunteya mukta-saṅgaḥ samācara

English Meaning:

Work done for sacrifice (higher purpose) frees you; otherwise, it binds.

Detailed Explanation:

Action becomes liberating when done selflessly.

Key Insight:

Purpose determines bondage or freedom.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

सहयज्ञाः प्रजाः सृष्ट्वा पुरोवाच प्रजापतिः ।
अनेन प्रसविष्यध्वमेष वोऽस्त्विष्टकामधुक् ॥3.10॥

Transliteration:

saha-yajñāḥ prajāḥ sṛṣṭvā purovāca prajāpatiḥ
anena prasaviṣyadhvam eṣa vo ’stv iṣṭa-kāma-dhuk

English Meaning:

The creator established sacrifice and said: prosper through it.

Key Insight:

Selfless contribution sustains the world.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

देवान्भावयतानेन ते देवा भावयन्तु वः ।
परस्परं भावयन्तः श्रेयः परमवाप्स्यथ ॥3.11॥

Key Insight:

Mutual cooperation leads to prosperity.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

इष्टान्भोगान्हि वो देवा दास्यन्ते यज्ञभाविताः ।
तैर्दत्तानप्रदायैभ्यो यो भुङ्क्ते स्तेन एव सः ॥3.12॥

Key Insight:

Taking without giving is theft.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

यज्ञशिष्टाशिनः सन्तो मुच्यन्ते सर्वकिल्बिषैः ।
भुञ्जते ते त्वघं पापा ये पचन्त्यात्मकारणात् ॥3.13॥

Key Insight:

Selfless living purifies.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

अन्नाद्भवन्ति भूतानि पर्जन्यादन्नसम्भवः ।
यज्ञाद्भवति पर्जन्यो यज्ञः कर्मसमुद्भवः ॥3.14॥

Key Insight:
Life is sustained through cycles of action.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:
कर्म ब्रह्मोद्भवं विद्धि ब्रह्माक्षरसमुद्भवम् ।
तस्मात्सर्वगतं ब्रह्म नित्यं यज्ञे प्रतिष्ठितम् ॥3.15॥

Key Insight:
Action is rooted in divine order.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:
एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥3.16॥

Key Insight:
Ignoring dharma leads to wasted life.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:
यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥3.17॥

Key Insight:
Self-realized person is internally fulfilled.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥3.18॥

Key Insight:

True freedom is independence from outcomes.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्मादसक्तः सततं कार्यं कर्म समाचर ।
असक्तो ह्याचरन्कर्म परमाप्नोति पूरुषः ॥3.19॥

Key Insight:

Detached action leads to perfection.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मणैव हि संसिद्धिमास्थिता जनकादयः ।
लोकसंग्रहमेवापि सम्पश्यन्कर्तुमर्हसि ॥3.20॥

Key Insight:

Act for the welfare of the world.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:

यद्यदाचरति श्रेष्ठस्तत्तदेवेतरो जनः ।
स यत्प्रमाणं कुरुते लोकस्तदनुवर्तते ॥3.21॥

Transliteration:
yad yad ācarati śreṣṭhas tat tad evetaro janaḥ
sa yat pramāṇaṁ kurute lokas tad anuvartate

English Meaning:
Whatever a great person does, others follow. Whatever standard they set, the world follows.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna emphasizes leadership responsibility. Actions of influential individuals shape society.

Practical Application:

- Lead by example
- Be conscious of your influence

Key Insight:
Your actions influence the world.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
न मे पार्थास्ति कर्तव्यं त्रिषु लोकेषु किञ्चन ।
नानवाप्तमवाप्तव्यं वर्त एव च कर्मणि ॥3.22॥

Transliteration:
na me pārthāsti kartavyaṁ triṣu lokeṣu kiñcana
nānavāptam avāptavyaṁ varta eva ca karmaṇi

English Meaning:
O Arjuna, I have nothing to gain, yet I continue to act.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna sets Himself as the highest example—action without selfish motive.

Key Insight:
Act without needing anything in return.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥3.23॥

Transliteration:
yadi hy ahaṁ na varteyaṁ jātu karmaṇy atandritaḥ
mama vartmānuvartante manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ

English Meaning:
If I did not act, people would follow my example and become inactive.

Key Insight:
Inaction by leaders leads to societal decline.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहम् ।
सङ्करस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः ॥3.24॥

Transliteration:
utsīdeyur ime lokā na kuryāṁ karma ced aham
saṅkarasya ca kartā syām upahanyām imāḥ prajāḥ

English Meaning:
If I stopped acting, society would collapse.

Key Insight:
Responsible action sustains the world.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत ।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम् ॥3.25॥

Transliteration:

saktāḥ karmaṇy avidvāṁso yathā kurvanti bhārata
kuryād vidvāṁs tathāsaktaś cikīrṣur loka-saṅgraham

English Meaning:

The wise should act without attachment, just as the ignorant act with attachment.

Key Insight:

Act wisely for the welfare of others.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

न बुद्धिभेदं जनयेदज्ञानां कर्मसङ्गिनाम् ।
जोषयेत्सर्वकर्माणि विद्वान्युक्तः समाचरन् ॥3.26॥

Transliteration:

na buddhi-bhedaṁ janayed ajñānāṁ karma-saṅginām
joṣayet sarva-karmāṇi vidvān yuktaḥ samācaran

English Meaning:

Do not disturb the minds of the ignorant; guide them gently.

Key Insight:

Teach through example, not force.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रकृतेः क्रियमाणानि गुणैः कर्माणि सर्वशः ।
अहङ्कारविमूढात्मा कर्ताहमिति मन्यते ॥3.27॥

Transliteration:

prakṛteḥ kriyamāṇāni guṇaiḥ karmāṇi sarvaśaḥ
ahaṅkāra-vimūḍhātmā kartāham iti manyate

English Meaning:

All actions are performed by nature, but the deluded think "I am the doer."

Key Insight:

Ego creates false ownership.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्त्ववित्तु महाबाहो गुणकर्मविभागयोः ।
गुणा गुणेषु वर्तन्त इति मत्वा न सज्जते ॥3.28॥

Transliteration:

tattva-vit tu mahā-bāho guṇa-karma-vibhāgayoḥ
guṇā guṇeṣu vartanta iti matvā na sajjate

English Meaning:

The wise understand that actions are performed by the gunas and remain unattached.

Key Insight:

Understanding reality removes attachment.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रकृतेर्गुणसम्मूढाः सज्जन्ते गुणकर्मसु ।
तानकृत्स्नविदो मन्दान्कृत्स्नविन्न विचालयेत् ॥3.29॥

Transliteration:

prakṛter guṇa-sammūḍhāḥ sajjante guṇa-karmasu
tān akṛtsna-vido mandān kṛtsna-vin na vicālayet

English Meaning:

Those deluded by nature become attached to action; the wise should not disturb them.

Key Insight:

Wisdom requires patience with others.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

मयि सर्वाणि कर्माणि संन्यस्याध्यात्मचेतसा ।
निराशीर्निर्ममो भूत्वा युध्यस्व विगतज्वरः ॥3.30॥

Transliteration:

mayi sarvāṇi karmāṇi sannyasyādhyātma-cetasā
nirāśīr nirmamo bhūtvā yudhyasva vigata-jvaraḥ

English Meaning:

Surrender all actions to Me, free from expectation and ego, and fight without anxiety.

Detailed Explanation:

This is the essence of Karma Yoga—offering action to the Divine.

Key Insight:

Surrender removes stress.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये मे मतमिदं नित्यमनुतिष्ठन्ति मानवाः ।
श्रद्धावन्तोऽनसूयन्तो मुच्यन्ते तेऽपि कर्मभिः ॥3.31॥

Key Insight:

Following divine wisdom leads to liberation.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये त्वेतदभ्यसूयन्तो नानुतिष्ठन्ति मे मतम् ।
सर्वज्ञानविमूढांस्तान्विद्धि नष्टानचेतसः ॥3.32॥

Key Insight:

Rejecting wisdom leads to downfall.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

सदृशं चेष्टते स्वस्याः प्रकृतेर्ज्ञानवानपि ।
प्रकृतिं यान्ति भूतानि निग्रहः किं करिष्यति ॥3.33॥

Key Insight:

Nature influences behavior strongly.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

इन्द्रियस्येन्द्रियस्यार्थे रागद्वेषौ व्यवस्थितौ ।
तयोर्न वशमागच्छेत्तौ ह्यस्य परिपन्थिनौ ॥3.34॥

Key Insight:
Control attraction and aversion.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥3.35॥

Transliteration:
śreyān sva-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt
sva-dharme nidhanaṁ śreyaḥ para-dharmo bhayāvahaḥ

English Meaning:
Better to perform one’s own duty imperfectly than another’s perfectly.

Detailed Explanation:
Individual purpose matters more than imitation.

Key Insight:
Follow your own path.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:
अर्जुन उवाच ।
अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।
अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥3.36॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna asks about the force behind wrongdoing.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ।
महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥3.37॥

Transliteration:

kāma eṣa krodha eṣa rajo-guṇa-samudbhavaḥ
mahāśano mahā-pāpmā viddhy enam iha vairiṇam

English Meaning:

It is desire and anger, born of passion, that are the enemies.

Key Insight:

Desire is the root enemy.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥3.38॥

Key Insight:

Desire covers knowledge.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥3.39॥

Key Insight:

Desire is insatiable.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:

इन्द्रियाणि मनो बुद्धिरस्याधिष्ठानमुच्यते ।
एतैर्विमोहयत्येष ज्ञानमावृत्य देहिनम् ॥3.40॥

Key Insight:

Desire operates through senses, mind, and intellect.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्मात्त्वमिन्द्रियाण्यादौ नियम्य भरतर्षभ ।
पाप्मानं प्रजहि ह्येनं ज्ञानविज्ञाननाशनम् ॥3.41॥

Key Insight:

Control senses to destroy desire.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:

इन्द्रियाणि पराण्याहुरिन्द्रियेभ्यः परं मनः ।
मनसस्तु परा बुद्धिर्यो बुद्धेः परतस्तु सः ॥3.42॥

Key Insight:

Hierarchy: senses < mind < intellect < Self.

Verse 43

Sanskrit Shloka:

एवं बुद्धेः परं बुद्ध्वा संस्तभ्यात्मानमात्मना ।
जहि शत्रुं महाबाहो कामरूपं दुरासदम् ॥3.43॥

Transliteration:

evaṁ buddheḥ paraṁ buddhvā saṁstabhyātmānam ātmanā
jahi śatruṁ mahā-bāho kāma-rūpaṁ durāsadam

English Meaning:

Knowing the Self is superior, control the mind and conquer desire.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes by identifying desire as the ultimate inner enemy and Self-realization as the solution.

Key Insight:

Self-mastery conquers all inner enemies.

Chapter 4: Jnana Karma Sanyasa Yoga (The Yoga of Knowledge and Renunciation of Action)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
इमं विवस्वते योगं प्रोक्तवानहमव्ययम् ।
विवस्वान्मनवे प्राह मनुरिक्ष्वाकवेऽब्रवीत् ॥4.1॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
imaṁ vivasvate yogaṁ proktavān aham avyayam
vivasvān manave prāha manur ikṣvākave ’bravīt

English Meaning:
The Supreme Lord said: I taught this eternal yoga to the sun-god Vivasvan, who taught it to Manu, and Manu taught it to Ikshvaku.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna reveals the **ancient lineage (paramparā)** of this knowledge. It is not new—it is timeless wisdom passed through generations of realized beings.

Practical Application:

- Respect authentic knowledge traditions
- Seek wisdom from genuine sources

Key Insight:
Spiritual knowledge is eternal and transmitted through lineage.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:
एवं परम्पराप्राप्तमिमं राजर्षयो विदुः ।
स कालेनेह महता योगो नष्टः परन्तप ॥4.2॥

Transliteration:
evaṁ paramparā-prāptam imaṁ rājarṣayo viduḥ
sa kāleneha mahatā yogo naṣṭaḥ parantapa

English Meaning:
This knowledge was received through disciplic succession, but over time it was lost.

Detailed Explanation:
Spiritual wisdom declines when not properly preserved or practiced.

Key Insight:
Truth must be preserved through sincere practice.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:
स एवायं मया तेऽद्य योगः प्रोक्तः पुरातनः ।
भक्तोऽसि मे सखा चेति रहस्यं ह्येतदुत्तमम् ॥4.3॥

Transliteration:
sa evāyaṁ mayā te ’dya yogaḥ proktaḥ purātanaḥ
bhakto ’si me sakhā ceti rahasyaṁ hy etad uttamam

English Meaning:
I am teaching you this ancient knowledge because you are My devotee and friend.

Detailed Explanation:

Divine knowledge is revealed through devotion and trust.

Key Insight:

Faith and friendship open the door to higher wisdom.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
अपरं भवतो जन्म परं जन्म विवस्वतः ।
कथमेतद्विजानीयां त्वमादौ प्रोक्तवानिति ॥4.4॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
aparaṁ bhavato janma paraṁ janma vivasvataḥ
katham etad vijānīyāṁ tvam ādau proktavān iti

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: You were born recently, while the sun-god was born long ago. How can I understand that You taught him?

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna raises a logical doubt—leading Krishna to reveal His divine nature.

Key Insight:

Questioning leads to deeper revelation.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
बहूनि मे व्यतीतानि जन्मानि तव चार्जुन ।
तान्यहं वेद सर्वाणि न त्वं वेत्थ परन्तप ॥4.5॥

Transliteration:

bahūni me vyatītāni janmāni tava cārjuna
tāny ahaṁ veda sarvāṇi na tvaṁ vettha parantapa

English Meaning:

Both you and I have had many births. I remember them all, but you do not.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reveals His divine omniscience.

Key Insight:

The divine is beyond human limitation.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

अजोऽपि सन्नव्ययात्मा भूतानामीश्वरोऽपि सन् ।
प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय सम्भवाम्यात्ममायया ॥4.6॥

Transliteration:

ajo ’pi sann avyayātmā bhūtānām īśvaro ’pi san
prakṛtiṁ svām adhiṣṭhāya sambhavāmy ātma-māyayā

English Meaning:

Though unborn and eternal, I appear by My divine power.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna explains **incarnation (avatar).**

Key Insight:

The Divine manifests out of compassion.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा यदा हि धर्मस्य ग्लानिर्भवति भारत ।
अभ्युत्थानमधर्मस्य तदात्मानं सृजाम्यहम् ॥4.7॥

Transliteration:

yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata
abhyutthānam adharmasya tadātmānaṁ sṛjāmy aham

English Meaning:

Whenever dharma declines and adharma rises, I manifest Myself.

Detailed Explanation:

This is one of the most famous verses—God intervenes when balance is lost.

Key Insight:

Divine intervention restores balance.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

परित्राणाय साधूनां विनाशाय च दुष्कृताम् ।
धर्मसंस्थापनार्थाय सम्भवामि युगे युगे ॥4.8॥

Transliteration:

paritrāṇāya sādhūnāṁ vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām
dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya sambhavāmi yuge yuge

English Meaning:

To protect the righteous, destroy the wicked, and re-establish dharma, I appear age after age.

Key Insight:

Dharma is divinely protected.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:
जन्म कर्म च मे दिव्यमेवं यो वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ।
त्यक्त्वा देहं पुनर्जन्म नैति मामेति सोऽर्जुन ॥4.9॥

Transliteration:
janma karma ca me divyam evaṁ yo vetti tattvataḥ
tyaktvā dehaṁ punar janma naiti mām eti so ’rjuna

English Meaning:
One who understands My divine birth and actions does not take rebirth.

Key Insight:
Knowing the Divine leads to liberation.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:
वीतरागभयक्रोधा मन्मया मामुपाश्रिताः ।
बहवो ज्ञानतपसा पूता मद्भावमागताः ॥4.10॥

Key Insight:
Freedom from fear, anger, and attachment leads to God-realization.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:
ये यथा मां प्रपद्यन्ते तांस्तथैव भजाम्यहम् ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥4.11॥

Key Insight:

God responds according to one’s approach.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

काङ्क्षन्तः कर्मणां सिद्धिं यजन्त इह देवताः ।
क्षिप्रं हि मानुषे लोके सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा ॥4.12॥

Key Insight:

Desire-driven worship yields temporary results.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

चातुर्वर्ण्यं मया सृष्टं गुणकर्मविभागशः ।
तस्य कर्तारमपि मां विद्ध्यकर्तारमव्ययम् ॥4.13॥

Key Insight:

Social order is based on qualities and actions, not birth.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

न मां कर्माणि लिम्पन्ति न मे कर्मफले स्पृहा ।
इति मां योऽभिजानाति कर्मभिर्न स बध्यते ॥4.14॥

Key Insight:

Detached action leads to freedom.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

एवं ज्ञात्वा कृतं कर्म पूर्वैरपि मुमुक्षुभिः ।
कुरु कर्मैव तस्मात्त्वं पूर्वैः पूर्वतरं कृतम् ॥4.15॥

Key Insight:

Follow the path of enlightened ancestors.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

किं कर्म किमकर्मेति कवयोऽप्यत्र मोहिताः ।
तत्ते कर्म प्रवक्ष्यामि यज्ज्ञात्वा मोक्ष्यसेऽशुभात् ॥4.16॥

Key Insight:

Understanding action is subtle and complex.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मणो ह्यपि बोद्धव्यं बोद्धव्यं च विकर्मणः ।
अकर्मणश्च बोद्धव्यं गहना कर्मणो गतिः ॥4.17॥

Key Insight:

Action, inaction, and wrong action must be understood.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मण्यकर्म यः पश्येदकर्मणि च कर्म यः ।
स बुद्धिमान्मनुष्येषु स युक्तः कृत्स्नकर्मकृत् ॥4.18॥

Key Insight:

Seeing inaction in action is true wisdom.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:
यस्य सर्वे समारम्भाः कामसङ्कल्पवर्जिताः ।
ज्ञानाग्निदग्धकर्माणं तमाहुः पण्डितं बुधाः ॥4.19॥

Key Insight:
Actions free from desire are purified by knowledge.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:
त्यक्त्वा कर्मफलासङ्गं नित्यतृप्तो निराश्रयः ।
कर्मण्यभिप्रवृत्तोऽपि नैव किञ्चित्करोति सः ॥4.20॥

Key Insight:
Detached action leads to inner freedom.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
निराशीर्निर्ममो भूत्वा त्यक्तसर्वपरिग्रहः ।
शारीरं केवलं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥4.21॥

Transliteration:
nirāśīr nirmamo bhūtvā tyakta-sarva-parigrahaḥ
śārīraṁ kevalaṁ karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣam

English Meaning:
One who is free from expectation, ego, and possessiveness incurs no sin even while acting.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna emphasizes inner renunciation. Freedom from "mine-ness" (mamatā) purifies action.

Practical Application:

- Perform duties without ownership
- Reduce attachment to possessions

Key Insight:
Purity of intention removes karmic burden.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
यदृच्छालाभसन्तुष्टो द्वन्द्वातीतो विमत्सरः ।
समः सिद्धावसिद्धौ च कृत्वापि न निबध्यते ॥4.22॥

Transliteration:
yadṛcchā-lābha-santuṣṭo dvandvātīto vimatsaraḥ
samaḥ siddhāv asiddhau ca kṛtvāpi na nibadhyate

English Meaning:
Content with what comes naturally, free from dualities and envy, such a person is not bound by action.

Detailed Explanation:
Contentment and equanimity are keys to freedom.

Key Insight:
Contentment dissolves bondage.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:

गतसङ्गस्य मुक्तस्य ज्ञानावस्थितचेतसः ।
यज्ञायाचरतः कर्म समग्रं प्रविलीयते ॥4.23॥

Transliteration:

gata-saṅgasya muktasya jñānāvasthita-cetasaḥ
yajñāyācaratаḥ karma samagraṁ pravilīyate

English Meaning:

Actions of one who is free from attachment and acts in knowledge are dissolved.

Key Insight:

Knowledge transforms action into liberation.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर्ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥4.24॥

Transliteration:

brahmārpaṇaṁ brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam
brahmaiva tena gantavyaṁ brahma-karma-samādhinā

English Meaning:

The offering, the act, and the performer are all Brahman.

Detailed Explanation:

This is a profound vision of **non-duality (Advaita)**—everything is divine.

Key Insight:

See divinity in all actions.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

दैवमेवापरे यज्ञं योगिनः पर्युपासते ।
ब्रह्माग्नावपरे यज्ञं यज्ञेनैवोपजुह्वति ॥4.25॥

Key Insight:

Different paths exist, but all lead toward purification.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रोत्रादीनीन्द्रियाण्यन्ये संयमाग्निषु जुह्वति ।
शब्दादीन्विषयानन्य इन्द्रियाग्निषु जुह्वति ॥4.26॥

Key Insight:

Control of senses is itself a sacrifice.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वाणीन्द्रियकर्माणि प्राणकर्माणि चापरे ।
आत्मसंयमयोगाग्नौ जुह्वति ज्ञानदीपिते ॥4.27॥

Key Insight:

Self-discipline leads to illumination.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

द्रव्ययज्ञास्तपोयज्ञा योगयज्ञास्तथापरे ।
स्वाध्यायज्ञानयज्ञाश्च यतयः संशितव्रताः ॥4.28॥

Key Insight:
Different sacrifices include charity, austerity, study, and knowledge.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:
अपाने जुह्वति प्राणं प्राणेऽपानं तथापरे ।
प्राणापानगती रुद्ध्वा प्राणायामपरायणाः ॥4.29॥

Key Insight:
Breath control is a spiritual discipline.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:
अपरे नियताहाराः प्राणान्प्राणेषु जुह्वति ।
सर्वेऽप्येते यज्ञविदो यज्ञक्षपितकल्मषाः ॥4.30॥

Key Insight:
Disciplined living purifies the mind.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:
यज्ञशिष्टामृतभुजो यान्ति ब्रह्म सनातनम् ।
नायं लोकोऽस्त्ययज्ञस्य कुतोऽन्यः कुरुसत्तम ॥4.31॥

Transliteration:
yajña-śiṣṭāmṛta-bhujo yānti brahma sanātanam
nāyaṁ loko ’sty ayajñasya kuto ’nyaḥ kuru-sattama

English Meaning:

Those who partake in sacrifice attain the eternal; without sacrifice, there is no success.

Key Insight:

Selfless living is essential for spiritual progress.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

एवं बहुविधा यज्ञा वितता ब्रह्मणो मुखे ।
कर्मजान्विद्धि तान्सर्वानेवं ज्ञात्वा विमोक्ष्यसे ॥4.32॥

Key Insight:

Understanding sacrifice leads to liberation.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रेयान्द्रव्यमयाद्यज्ञाज्ज्ञानयज्ञः परन्तप ।
सर्वं कर्माखिलं पार्थ ज्ञाने परिसमाप्यते ॥4.33॥

Transliteration:

śreyān dravya-mayād yajñāj jñāna-yajñaḥ parantapa
sarvaṁ karmākhilaṁ pārtha jñāne parisamāpyate

English Meaning:

Knowledge sacrifice is superior to material sacrifice.

Key Insight:

Knowledge is the highest purifier.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

तद्विद्धि प्रणिपातेन परिप्रश्नेन सेवया ।
उपदेक्ष्यन्ति ते ज्ञानं ज्ञानिनस्तत्त्वदर्शिनः ॥4.34॥

Transliteration:

tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśnena sevayā
upadekṣyanti te jñānaṁ jñāninas tattva-darśinaḥ

English Meaning:

Approach a realized teacher with humility, inquiry, and service to gain knowledge.

Detailed Explanation:

Guru-disciple relationship is essential for realization.

Key Insight:

Humility opens the door to wisdom.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

यज्ज्ञात्वा न पुनर्मोहमेवं यास्यसि पाण्डव ।
येन भूतान्यशेषाणि द्रक्ष्यस्यात्मन्यथो मयि ॥4.35॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge removes all illusion.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:

अपि चेदसि पापेभ्यः सर्वेभ्यः पापकृत्तमः ।
सर्वं ज्ञानप्लवेनैव वृजिनं सन्तरिष्यसि ॥4.36॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge destroys even the greatest sins.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:
यथैधांसि समिद्धोऽग्निर्भस्मसात्कुरुतेऽर्जुन ।
ज्ञानाग्निः सर्वकर्माणि भस्मसात्कुरुते तथा ॥4.37॥

Key Insight:
Knowledge burns all karma.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:
न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥4.38॥

Key Insight:
Nothing is as purifying as knowledge.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रद्धावान्लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥4.39॥

Key Insight:
Faith + discipline → knowledge → peace.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:
अज्ञश्चाश्रद्दधानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।
नायं लोकोऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥4.40॥

Key Insight:
Doubt destroys spiritual progress.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:
योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसंछिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनंजय ॥4.41॥

Key Insight:
Freedom comes from knowledge and detachment.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:
तस्मादज्ञानसंभूतं हृत्स्थं ज्ञानासिनात्मनः ।
छित्त्वैनं संशयं योगमातिष्ठोत्तिष्ठ भारत ॥4.42॥

Transliteration:
tasmād ajñāna-sambhūtaṁ hṛt-sthaṁ jñānāsinātmanaḥ
chittvainaṁ saṁśayaṁ yogam ātiṣṭhottiṣṭha bhārata

English Meaning:
Cut this doubt with the sword of knowledge and arise.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna concludes with a call to action—knowledge must lead to decisive action.

Key Insight:
Destroy doubt with knowledge and act.

Chapter 5: Karma Sanyasa Yoga (The Yoga of Renunciation of Action)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
संन्यासं कर्मणां कृष्ण पुनर्योगं च शंससि ।
यच्छ्रेय एतयोरेकं तन्मे ब्रूहि सुनिश्चितम् ॥5.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
sannyāsaṁ karmaṇāṁ kṛṣṇa punar yogaṁ ca śaṁsasi
yac chreya etayor ekaṁ tan me brūhi su-niścitam

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: O Krishna, you praise both renunciation and action. Tell me clearly which is better.

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna again expresses confusion between renouncing action and performing action. This reflects a universal dilemma—should one withdraw or engage?

Practical Application:

- Seek clarity when faced with conflicting paths
- Avoid confusion by understanding purpose

Key Insight:

Clarity precedes right choice.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
संन्यासः कर्मयोगश्च निःश्रेयसकरावुभौ ।
तयोस्तु कर्मसंन्यासात्कर्मयोगो विशिष्यते ॥5.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
sannyāsaḥ karma-yogaś ca niḥśreyasa-karāv ubhau
tayos tu karma-sannyāsāt karma-yogo viśiṣyate

English Meaning:

Both renunciation and action lead to liberation, but Karma Yoga is superior.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna emphasizes **acting without attachment** as the highest path for most people.

Key Insight:

Selfless action is superior to passive renunciation.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञेयः स नित्यसंन्यासी यो न द्वेष्टि न काङ्क्षति ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो हि महाबाहो सुखं बन्धात्प्रमुच्यते ॥5.3॥

Transliteration:

jñeyaḥ sa nitya-sannyāsī yo na dveṣṭi na kāṅkṣati
nirdvandvo hi mahā-bāho sukhaṁ bandhāt pramucyate

English Meaning:

One who neither hates nor desires is a true renunciant.

Key Insight:

Renunciation is internal, not external.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
सांख्ययोगौ पृथग्बालाः प्रवदन्ति न पण्डिताः ।
एकमप्यास्थितः सम्यगुभयोर्विन्दते फलम् ॥5.4॥

Transliteration:
sāṅkhya-yogau pṛthag bālāḥ pravadanti na paṇḍitāḥ
ekam apy āsthitaḥ samyag ubhayor vindate phalam

English Meaning:
Only the ignorant see knowledge and action as different; the wise see them as one.

Key Insight:
All paths converge to the same truth.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
यत्सांख्यैः प्राप्यते स्थानं तद्योगैरपि गम्यते ।
एकं सांख्यं च योगं च यः पश्यति स पश्यति ॥5.5॥

Transliteration:
yat sāṅkhyaiḥ prāpyate sthānaṁ tad yogair api gamyate
ekaṁ sāṅkhyaṁ ca yogaṁ ca yaḥ paśyati sa paśyati

English Meaning:
The state achieved by knowledge is also reached by action.

Key Insight:
Unity of paths is true understanding.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

संन्यासस्तु महाबाहो दुःखमाप्तुमयोगतः ।
योगयुक्तो मुनिर्ब्रह्म नचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥5.6॥

Transliteration:

sannyāsas tu mahā-bāho duḥkham āptum ayogataḥ
yoga-yukto munir brahma na cireṇādhigacchati

English Meaning:

Renunciation without discipline is difficult; one engaged in Karma Yoga quickly attains Brahman.

Key Insight:

Practice is more effective than mere withdrawal.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

योगयुक्तो विशुद्धात्मा विजितात्मा जितेन्द्रियः ।
सर्वभूतात्मभूतात्मा कुर्वन्नपि न लिप्यते ॥5.7॥

Transliteration:

yoga-yukto viśuddhātmā vijitātmā jitendriyaḥ
sarva-bhūtātma-bhūtātmā kurvann api na lipyate

English Meaning:

A disciplined person sees the Self in all and remains unaffected by action.

Key Insight:

Unity of vision leads to freedom.

Verse 8–9

Sanskrit Shloka:

नैव किञ्चित्करोमीति युक्तो मन्येत तत्त्ववित् ।
पश्यन्शृण्वन्स्पृशन्जिघ्रन्नश्नन्गच्छन्स्वपंश्वसन् ॥5.8॥
प्रलपन्विसृजन्गृह्णन्नुन्मिषन्निमिषन्नपि ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेषु वर्तन्त इति धारयन् ॥5.9॥

Transliteration:

naiva kiñcit karomīti yukto manyeta tattva-vit
paśyan śṛṇvan spṛśan jighrann aśnan gacchan svapan śvasan
pralapan visṛjan gṛhṇann unmiṣan nimiṣann api
indriyāṇīndriyārtheṣu vartanta iti dhārayan

English Meaning:

The wise think "I do nothing at all," understanding that senses act on objects.

Detailed Explanation:

True wisdom dissolves the ego of doership.

Key Insight:

You are not the doer—the senses act naturally.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

ब्रह्मण्याधाय कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा करोति यः ।
लिप्यते न स पापेन पद्मपत्रमिवाम्भसा ॥5.10॥

Transliteration:

brahmaṇy ādhāya karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā karoti yaḥ
lipyate na sa pāpena padma-patram ivāmbhasā

English Meaning:

One who performs actions as an offering to Brahman remains untouched by sin, like a lotus in water.

Key Insight:

Detach and dedicate—remain unaffected.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

कायेन मनसा बुद्ध्या केवलैरिन्द्रियैरपि ।
योगिनः कर्म कुर्वन्ति सङ्गं त्यक्त्वात्मशुद्धये ॥5.11॥

Key Insight:

Action purifies when done without attachment.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

युक्तः कर्मफलं त्यक्त्वा शान्तिमाप्नोति नैष्ठिकीम् ।
अयुक्तः कामकारेण फले सक्तो निबध्यते ॥5.12॥

Key Insight:

Attachment brings bondage; detachment brings peace.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वकर्माणि मनसा संन्यस्यास्ते सुखं वशी ।
नवद्वारे पुरे देही नैव कुर्वन्न कारयन् ॥5.13॥

Key Insight:

Inner renunciation leads to peace.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

न कर्तृत्वं न कर्माणि लोकस्य सृजति प्रभुः ।
न कर्मफलसंयोगं स्वभावस्तु प्रवर्तते ॥5.14॥

Key Insight:

Nature, not God, drives actions.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

नादत्ते कस्यचित्पापं न चैव सुकृतं विभुः ।
अज्ञाननेनावृतं ज्ञानं तेन मुह्यन्ति जन्तवः ॥5.15॥

Key Insight:

Ignorance causes delusion.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानेन तु तदज्ञानं येषां नाशितमात्मनः ।
तेषामादित्यवज्ज्ञानं प्रकाशयति तत्परम् ॥5.16॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge illuminates like the sun.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

तद्बुद्धयस्तदात्मानस्तन्निष्ठास्तत्परायणाः ।
गच्छन्त्यपुनरावृत्तिं ज्ञाननिर्धूतकल्मषाः ॥5.17॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge leads to liberation.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

विद्याविनयसंपन्ने ब्राह्मणे गवि हस्तिनि ।
शुनि चैव श्वपाके च पण्डिताः समदर्शिनः ॥5.18॥

Transliteration:

vidyā-vinaya-sampanne brāhmaṇe gavi hastini
śuni caiva śva-pāke ca paṇḍitāḥ sama-darśinaḥ

English Meaning:

The wise see all beings equally.

Key Insight:

Equality is the mark of wisdom.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

इहैव तैर्जितः सर्गो येषां साम्ये स्थितं मनः ।
निर्दोषं हि समं ब्रह्म तस्माद्ब्रह्मणि ते स्थिताः ॥5.19॥

Key Insight:

Equanimity leads to liberation.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

न प्रहृष्येत्प्रियम् प्राप्य नोद्विजेत्प्राप्य चाप्रियम् ।
स्थिरबुद्धिरसम्मूढो ब्रह्मविद् ब्रह्मणि स्थितः ॥5.20॥

Key Insight:

Remain steady in pleasure and pain.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
बाह्यस्पर्शेष्वसक्तात्मा विन्दत्यात्मनि यत्सुखम् ।
स ब्रह्मयोगयुक्तात्मा सुखमक्षयमश्नुते ॥5.21॥

Transliteration:
bāhya-sparśeṣv asaktātmā vindaty ātmani yat sukham
sa brahma-yoga-yuktātmā sukham akṣayam aśnute

English Meaning:
One who is not attached to external pleasures finds joy within and experiences eternal happiness.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna contrasts **external pleasure vs inner bliss.** External pleasures are temporary; inner realization brings lasting peace.

Practical Application:

- Reduce dependence on external validation
- Cultivate inner peace through reflection

Key Insight:
True happiness comes from within.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
ये हि संस्पर्शजा भोगा दुःखयोनय एव ते ।
आद्यन्तवन्तः कौन्तेय न तेषु रमते बुधः ॥5.22॥

Transliteration:
ye hi saṁsparśa-jā bhogā duḥkha-yonaya eva te
ādy-antavantaḥ kaunteya na teṣu ramate budhaḥ

English Meaning:
Pleasures born from sense contact are temporary and lead to suffering.

Detailed Explanation:
Sensory pleasures have a beginning and an end—hence they cannot give lasting fulfillment.

Key Insight:
Temporary pleasures lead to long-term dissatisfaction.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
शक्नोतीहैव यः सोढुं प्राक्शरीरविमोक्षणात् ।
कामक्रोधोद्भवं वेगं स युक्तः स सुखी नरः ॥5.23॥

Transliteration:
śaknotīhaiva yaḥ soḍhuṁ prāk śarīra-vimokṣaṇāt
kāma-krodhodbhavaṁ vegaṁ sa yuktaḥ sa sukhī naraḥ

English Meaning:
One who can control desire and anger before death is truly happy.

Detailed Explanation:
Mastery over impulses is essential for spiritual growth.

Key Insight:
Control of desire and anger leads to freedom.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

योऽन्तःसुखोऽन्तरारामस्तथान्तर्ज्योतिरेव यः ।
स योगी ब्रह्मनिर्वाणं ब्रह्मभूतोऽधिगच्छति ॥5.24॥

Transliteration:

yo ’ntaḥ-sukho ’ntar-ārāmas tathāntar-jyotir eva yaḥ
sa yogī brahma-nirvāṇaṁ brahma-bhūto ’dhigacchati

English Meaning:

One who finds joy within, is illuminated within, attains liberation.

Key Insight:

Inner fulfillment leads to enlightenment.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

लभन्ते ब्रह्मनिर्वाणमृषयः क्षीणकल्मषाः ।
छिन्नद्वैधा यतात्मानः सर्वभूतहिते रताः ॥5.25॥

Transliteration:

labhante brahma-nirvāṇam ṛṣayaḥ kṣīṇa-kalmaṣāḥ
chinna-dvaidhā yatātmānaḥ sarva-bhūta-hite ratāḥ

English Meaning:

Those free from impurities, doubts, and engaged in welfare of all attain liberation.

Key Insight:

Selflessness and purity lead to liberation.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

कामक्रोधवियुक्तानां यतीनां यतचेतसाम् ।
अभितो ब्रह्मनिर्वाणं वर्तते विदितात्मनाम् ॥5.26॥

Transliteration:

kāma-krodha-viyuktānāṁ yatīnām yata-cetasām
abhito brahma-nirvāṇaṁ vartate viditātmanām

English Meaning:

Those free from desire and anger attain peace on all sides.

Key Insight:

Freedom from inner enemies brings peace.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

स्पर्शान्कृत्वा बहिर्बाह्यांश्चक्षुश्चैवान्तरे भ्रुवोः ।
प्राणापानौ समौ कृत्वा नासाभ्यन्तरचारिणौ ॥5.27॥

Transliteration:

sparśān kṛtvā bahir bāhyāṁś cakṣuś caivāntare bhruvoḥ
prāṇāpānau samau kṛtvā nāsābhyantara-cāriṇau

English Meaning:

Closing off external distractions, focusing between the eyebrows, and regulating breath—

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna introduces **meditation practice (dhyana)**.

Key Insight:

Control of senses and breath leads to meditation.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

यतेन्द्रियमनोबुद्धिर्मुनिर्मोक्षपरायणः ।
विगतेच्छाभयक्रोधो यः सदा मुक्त एव सः ॥5.28॥

Transliteration:

yatendriya-mano-buddhir munir mokṣa-parāyaṇaḥ
vigatecchā-bhaya-krodho yaḥ sadā mukta eva saḥ

English Meaning:

One who controls senses, mind, and intellect, and is free from desire, fear, and anger, is always liberated.

Key Insight:

Mastery of mind leads to liberation.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

भोक्तारं यज्ञतपसां सर्वलोकमहेश्वरम् ।
सुहृदं सर्वभूतानां ज्ञात्वा मां शान्तिमृच्छति ॥5.29॥

Transliteration:

bhoktāraṁ yajña-tapasāṁ sarva-loka-maheśvaram
suhṛdaṁ sarva-bhūtānāṁ jñātvā māṁ śāntim ṛcchati

English Meaning:

One who knows Me as the enjoyer of all sacrifices, the Lord of all worlds, and the friend of all beings attains peace.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reveals His universal nature—God is not distant but a well-wisher of all.

Practical Application:

- Develop trust in the Divine
- Cultivate universal compassion

Key Insight:

Seeing God as the friend of all brings ultimate peace.

Chapter 6: Dhyana Yoga (The Yoga of Meditation)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अनाश्रितः कर्मफलं कार्यं कर्म करोति यः ।
स संन्यासी च योगी च न निरग्निर्न चाक्रियः ॥6.1॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
anāśritaḥ karma-phalaṁ kāryaṁ karma karoti yaḥ
sa sannyāsī ca yogī ca na niragnir na cākriyaḥ

English Meaning:
One who performs duty without attachment to results is a true renunciant and yogi—not one who merely avoids action.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna redefines renunciation. True योग (Yoga) is not inactivity but **detached action.**

Practical Application:

- Perform responsibilities without expectation
- Avoid escapism in the name of spirituality

Key Insight:
Renunciation is internal, not external.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

यं संन्यासमिति प्राहुर्योगं तं विद्धि पाण्डव ।
न ह्यसंन्यस्तसङ्कल्पो योगी भवति कश्चन ॥6.2॥

Transliteration:

yaṁ sannyāsam iti prāhur yogaṁ taṁ viddhi pāṇḍava
na hy asaṁnyasta-saṅkalpo yogī bhavati kaścana

English Meaning:

What is called renunciation is actually Yoga; without giving up desires, one cannot become a yogi.

Key Insight:

Renounce desires, not action.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

आरुरुक्षोर्मुनेर्योगं कर्म कारणमुच्यते ।
योगारूढस्य तस्यैव शमः कारणमुच्यते ॥6.3॥

Transliteration:

ārurukṣor muner yogaṁ karma kāraṇam ucyate
yogārūḍhasya tasyaiva śamaḥ kāraṇam ucyate

English Meaning:

For beginners, action is the path; for the advanced, stillness is the path.

Key Insight:

Spiritual growth evolves from action to stillness.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा हि नेन्द्रियार्थेषु न कर्मस्वनुषज्जते ।
सर्वसङ्कल्पसंन्यासी योगारूढस्तदोच्यते ॥6.4॥

Key Insight:

Detachment from desires marks spiritual maturity.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

उद्धरेदात्मनाऽत्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् ।
आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः ॥6.5॥

Transliteration:

uddhared ātmanātmānaṁ nātmānam avasādayet
ātmaiva hy ātmano bandhur ātmaiva ripur ātmanaḥ

English Meaning:

Elevate yourself by your own mind; the mind is your friend and enemy.

Detailed Explanation:

Self-mastery begins with the mind.

Key Insight:

Your mind can uplift or destroy you.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

बन्धुरात्माऽत्मनस्तस्य येनात्मैवात्मना जितः ।
अनात्मनस्तु शत्रुत्वे वर्तेतात्मैव शत्रुवत् ॥6.6॥

Key Insight:

Controlled mind = friend; uncontrolled mind = enemy.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

जितात्मनः प्रशान्तस्य परमात्मा समाहितः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु तथा मानापमानयोः ॥6.7॥

Key Insight:

Self-control brings peace in all situations.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानविज्ञानतृप्तात्मा कूटस्थो विजितेन्द्रियः ।
युक्त इत्युच्यते योगी समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ॥6.8॥

Key Insight:

A yogi sees gold and stone equally.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

सुहृन्मित्रार्युदासीनमध्यस्थद्वेष्यबन्धुषु ।
साधुष्वपि च पापेषु समबुद्धिर्विशिष्यते ॥6.9॥

Key Insight:

True yogi treats all equally.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

योगी युञ्जीत सततमात्मानं रहसि स्थितः ।
एकाकी यतचित्तात्मा निराशीरपरिग्रहः ॥6.10॥

Transliteration:

yogī yuñjīta satatam ātmānaṁ rahasi sthitaḥ
ekākī yata-cittātmā nirāśīr aparigrahaḥ

English Meaning:

A yogi should practice meditation in solitude with a controlled mind and free from desires.

Key Insight:

Meditation requires discipline and simplicity.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

शुचौ देशे प्रतिष्ठाप्य स्थिरमासनमात्मनः ।
नात्युच्छ्रितं नातिनीचं चैलाजिनकुशोत्तरम् ॥6.11॥

Key Insight:

Choose a clean, stable place for meditation.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्रैकाग्रं मनः कृत्वा यतचित्तेन्द्रियक्रियः ।
उपविश्यासने युञ्ज्याद्योगमात्मविशुद्धये ॥6.12॥

Key Insight:

Meditation purifies the mind.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

समं कायशिरोग्रीवं धारयन्नचलं स्थिरः ।
सम्प्रेक्ष्य नासिकाग्रं स्वं दिशश्चानवलोकयन् ॥6.13॥

Key Insight:

Maintain proper posture and focus.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रशान्तात्मा विगतभीर्ब्रह्मचारिव्रते स्थितः ।
मनः संयम्य मच्चित्तो युक्त आसीत मत्परः ॥6.14॥

Key Insight:

Meditation requires fearlessness and discipline.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी नियतमानसः ।
शान्तिं निर्वाणपरमां मत्संस्थामधिगच्छति ॥6.15॥

Key Insight:

Meditation leads to ultimate peace.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

नात्यश्नतस्तु योगोऽस्ति न चैकान्तमनश्नतः ।
न चाति स्वप्नशीलस्य जाग्रतो नैव चार्जुन ॥6.16॥

Key Insight:

Moderation is essential.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

युक्ताहारविहारस्य युक्तचेष्टस्य कर्मसु ।
युक्तस्वप्नावबोधस्य योगो भवति दुःखहा ॥6.17॥

Key Insight:

Balanced lifestyle supports meditation.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा विनियतं चित्तमात्मन्येवावतिष्ठते ।
निःस्पृहः सर्वकामेभ्यो युक्त इत्युच्यते तदा ॥6.18॥

Key Insight:

Mind resting in Self = Yoga.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

यथा दीपो निवातस्थो नेङ्गते सोपमा स्मृता ।
योगिनो यतचित्तस्य युञ्जतो योगमात्मनः ॥6.19॥

Key Insight:

Steady mind is like a flame in still air.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

यत्रोपरमते चित्तं निरुद्धं योगसेवया ।
यत्र चैवात्मनाऽत्मानं पश्यन्नात्मनि तुष्यति ॥6.20॥

Transliteration:
yatroparamate cittaṁ niruddhaṁ yoga-sevayā
yatra caivātmanātmānaṁ paśyann ātmani tuṣyati

English Meaning:
When the mind is fully controlled, one experiences inner joy.

Detailed Explanation:
This is the beginning of true meditation—inner realization.

Key Insight:
Meditation reveals inner bliss.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
सुखमात्यन्तिकं यत्तद्बुद्धिग्राह्यमतीन्द्रियम् ।
वेत्ति यत्र न चैवायं स्थितश्चलति तत्त्वतः ॥6.21॥

Transliteration:
sukham ātyantikaṁ yat tad buddhi-grāhyam atīndriyam
vetti yatra na caivāyaṁ sthitaś calati tattvataḥ

English Meaning:
In that state, one experiences supreme happiness beyond the senses, grasped by the intellect, and never deviates from truth.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna describes **transcendental bliss**—beyond physical pleasure, stable and eternal.

Key Insight:
True happiness is beyond the senses.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:

यं लब्ध्वा चापरं लाभं मन्यते नाधिकं ततः ।
यस्मिन्स्थितो न दुःखेन गुरुणापि विचाल्यते ॥6.22॥

Transliteration:

yaṁ labdhvā cāparaṁ lābhaṁ manyate nādhikaṁ tataḥ
yasmin sthito na duḥkhena guruṇāpi vicālyate

English Meaning:

Having attained this, one considers no greater gain and is not shaken even by great sorrow.

Key Insight:

Spiritual realization brings unshakable stability.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:

तं विद्यात्दुःखसंयोगवियोगं योगसंज्ञितम् ।
स निश्चयेन योक्तव्यो योगोऽनिर्विण्णचेतसा ॥6.23॥

Transliteration:

taṁ vidyād duḥkha-saṁyoga-viyogaṁ yoga-saṁjñitam
sa niścayena yoktavyo yogo ’nirviṇṇa-cetasā

English Meaning:

This state of freedom from suffering is called Yoga and must be practiced with determination.

Key Insight:

Consistency and determination are essential.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

सङ्कल्पप्रभवान्कामांस्त्यक्त्वा सर्वानशेषतः ।
मनसैवेन्द्रियग्रामं विनियम्य समन्ततः ॥6.24॥

Key Insight:

Control desires through discipline of mind.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

शनैः शनैरुपरमेद् बुद्ध्या धृतिगृहीतया ।
आत्मसंस्थं मनः कृत्वा न किञ्चिदपि चिन्तयेत् ॥6.25॥

Transliteration:

śanaiḥ śanair uparamed buddhyā dhṛti-gṛhītayā
ātma-saṁsthaṁ manaḥ kṛtvā na kiñcid api cintayet

English Meaning:

Gradually withdraw the mind using intelligence and fix it in the Self.

Key Insight:

Meditation requires gradual effort.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

यतो यतो निश्चरति मनश्चञ्चलमस्थिरम् ।
ततस्ततो नियम्यैतदात्मन्येव वशं नयेत् ॥6.26॥

Transliteration:

yato yato niścarati manaś cañcalam asthiram
tatas tato niyamyaitad ātmany eva vaśaṁ nayet

English Meaning:
Whenever the restless mind wanders, bring it back under control.

Key Insight:
Repeated practice stabilizes the mind.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:
प्रशान्तमनसं ह्येनं योगिनं सुखमुत्तमम् ।
उपैति शान्तरजसं ब्रह्मभूतमकल्मषम् ॥6.27॥

Key Insight:
A peaceful mind leads to supreme joy.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:
युञ्जन्नेवं सदात्मानं योगी विगतकल्मषः ।
सुखेन ब्रह्मसंस्पर्शमत्यन्तं सुखमश्नुते ॥6.28॥

Key Insight:
Union with Brahman brings infinite joy.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वभूतस्थमात्मानं सर्वभूतानि चात्मनि ।
ईक्षते योगयुक्तात्मा सर्वत्र समदर्शनः ॥6.29॥

Transliteration:

sarva-bhūta-stham ātmānaṁ sarva-bhūtāni cātmani
īkṣate yoga-yuktātmā sarvatra sama-darśanaḥ

English Meaning:

A yogi sees the Self in all beings and all beings in the Self.

Key Insight:

Unity is the highest vision.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

यो मां पश्यति सर्वत्र सर्वं च मयि पश्यति ।
तस्याहं न प्रणश्यामि स च मे न प्रणश्यति ॥6.30॥

Key Insight:

Seeing God everywhere creates eternal connection.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वभूतस्थितं यो मां भजत्येकत्वमास्थितः ।
सर्वथा वर्तमानोऽपि स योगी मयि वर्तते ॥6.31॥

Key Insight:

Unity with God transcends all actions.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

आत्मौपम्येन सर्वत्र समं पश्यति योऽर्जुन ।
सुखं वा यदि वा दुःखं स योगी परमो मतः ॥6.32॥

Key Insight:

Empathy is the highest Yoga.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
योऽयं योगस्त्वया प्रोक्तः साम्येन मधुसूदन ।
एतस्याहं न पश्यामि चञ्चलत्वात्स्थितिं स्थिराम् ॥6.33॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna doubts the stability of the mind.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

चञ्चलं हि मनः कृष्ण प्रमाथि बलवद्दृढम् ।
तस्याहं निग्रहं मन्ये वायोरिव सुदुष्करम् ॥6.34॥

Transliteration:

cañcalaṁ hi manaḥ kṛṣṇa pramāthi balavad dṛḍham
tasyāhaṁ nigrahaṁ manye vāyor iva su-duṣkaram

English Meaning:

The mind is restless and difficult to control, like the wind.

Key Insight:

Mind control is challenging but necessary.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्निग्रहं चलम् ।
अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते ॥6.35॥

Transliteration:

asaṁśayaṁ mahā-bāho mano durnigrahaṁ calam
abhyāsena tu kaunteya vairāgyeṇa ca gṛhyate

English Meaning:

The mind is difficult to control, but can be mastered by practice and detachment.

Key Insight:

Practice + detachment = mastery.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:

असंयतात्मना योगो दुष्प्राप इति मे मतिः ।
वश्यात्मना तु यतता शक्योऽवाप्तुमुपायतः ॥6.36॥

Key Insight:

Self-control is essential for Yoga.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
अयतिः श्रद्धयोपेतो योगाच्चलितमानसः ।
अप्राप्य योगसंसिद्धिं कां गतिं कृष्ण गच्छति ॥6.37॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna asks about failure in spiritual practice.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:

कच्चिन्नोभयविभ्रष्टश्छिन्नाभ्रमिव नश्यति ।
अप्रतिष्ठो महाबाहो विमूढो ब्रह्मणः पथि ॥6.38॥

Key Insight:

Fear of spiritual failure.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:

एतन्मे संशयं कृष्ण छेत्तुमर्हस्यशेषतः ।
त्वदन्यः संशयस्यास्य छेत्ता न ह्युपपद्यते ॥6.39॥

Key Insight:

Only divine wisdom removes doubt.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
पार्थ नैवेह नामुत्र विनाशस्तस्य विद्यते ।
न हि कल्याणकृत्कश्चिद्दुर्गतिं तात गच्छति ॥6.40॥

Key Insight:

No effort in spirituality is wasted.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्राप्य पुण्यकृतां लोकानुषित्वा शाश्वतीः समाः ।
शुचीनां श्रीमतां गेहे योगभ्रष्टोऽभिजायते ॥6.41॥

Key Insight:

Spiritual progress continues across births.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:

अथवा योगिनामेव कुले भवति धीमताम् ।
एतद्धि दुर्लभतरं लोके जन्म यदीदृशम् ॥6.42॥

Key Insight:

Birth in a spiritual family is rare and valuable.

Verse 43

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्र तं बुद्धिसंयोगं लभते पौर्वदेहिकम् ।
यतते च ततो भूयः संसिद्धौ कुरुनन्दन ॥6.43॥

Key Insight:

Past effort helps future progress.

Verse 44

Sanskrit Shloka:

पूर्वाभ्यासेन तेनैव ह्रियते ह्यवशोऽपि सः ।
जिज्ञासुरपि योगस्य शब्दब्रह्मातिवर्तते ॥6.44॥

Key Insight:

Past practice naturally draws one to spirituality.

Verse 45

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रयत्नाद्यतमानस्तु योगी संशुद्धकिल्बिषः ।
अनेकजन्मसंसिद्धस्ततो याति परां गतिम् ॥6.45॥

Key Insight:

Persistent effort leads to liberation.

Verse 46

Sanskrit Shloka:

तपस्विभ्योऽधिको योगी ज्ञानिभ्योऽपि मतोऽधिकः ।
कर्मिभ्यश्चाधिको योगी तस्माद्योगी भवार्जुन ॥6.46॥

Key Insight:

Yogi is superior to ascetic, scholar, and worker.

Verse 47

Sanskrit Shloka:

योगिनामपि सर्वेषां मद्गतेनान्तरात्मना ।
श्रद्धावान्भजते यो मां स मे युक्ततमो मतः ॥6.47॥

Transliteration:

yoginām api sarveṣāṁ mad-gatenāntar-ātmanā
śraddhāvān bhajate yo māṁ sa me yuktatamo mataḥ

English Meaning:

Among all yogis, the one who worships Me with faith is the highest.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes by emphasizing **Bhakti (devotion)** as the highest Yoga.

Key Insight:

Devotion is the highest form of Yoga.

Chapter 7: Jnana Vijnana Yoga (The Yoga of Knowledge and Realization)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
मय्यासक्तमनाः पार्थ योगं युञ्जन्मदाश्रयः ।
असंशयं समग्रं मां यथा ज्ञास्यसि तच्छृणु ॥7.1॥

Transliteration:
mayy āsakta-manāḥ pārtha yogaṁ yuñjan mad-āśrayaḥ
asaṁśayaṁ samagraṁ māṁ yathā jñāsyasi tac chṛṇu

English Meaning:
Krishna said: Fix your mind on Me and practice Yoga under My guidance. You will know Me completely without doubt.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna shifts from philosophy to **direct God-realization**. Knowledge must now become personal—knowing God, not just concepts.

Practical Application:

- Focus mind on higher purpose
- Develop devotion alongside knowledge

Key Insight:
True knowledge is knowing the Divine.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानं तेऽहं सविज्ञानमिदं वक्ष्याम्यशेषतः ।
यज्ज्ञात्वा नेह भूयोऽन्यज्ज्ञातव्यमवशिष्यते ॥7.2॥

Transliteration:

jñānaṁ te ’haṁ sa-vijñānam idaṁ vakṣyāmy aśeṣataḥ
yaj jñātvā neha bhūyo ’nyaj jñātavyam avaśiṣyate

English Meaning:

I will explain both knowledge and realization, knowing which nothing else remains to be known.

Key Insight:

Supreme knowledge ends all seeking.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

मनुष्याणां सहस्रेषु कश्चिद्यतति सिद्धये ।
यततामपि सिद्धानां कश्चिन्मां वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ॥7.3॥

Transliteration:

manuṣyāṇāṁ sahasreṣu kaścid yatati siddhaye
yatatām api siddhānāṁ kaścin māṁ vetti tattvataḥ

English Meaning:

Among thousands, few strive for perfection, and among them, only a few truly know Me.

Key Insight:

God-realization is rare and requires deep effort.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

भूमिरापोऽनलो वायुः खं मनो बुद्धिरेव च ।
अहङ्कार इतीयं मे भिन्ना प्रकृतिरष्टधा ॥7.4॥

Transliteration:

bhūmir āpo ’nalo vāyuḥ khaṁ mano buddhir eva ca
ahaṅkāra itīyaṁ me bhinnā prakṛtir aṣṭadhā

English Meaning:

Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intellect, and ego—these are My material energies.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna explains the **8-fold material nature (prakriti)**.

Key Insight:

The world is made of divine energy.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

अपरेयमितस्त्वन्यां प्रकृतिं विद्धि मे पराम् ।
जीवभूतां महाबाहो ययेदं धार्यते जगत् ॥7.5॥

Transliteration:

apareyam itas tv anyāṁ prakṛtiṁ viddhi me parām
jīva-bhūtāṁ mahā-bāho yayedaṁ dhāryate jagat

English Meaning:

Besides this, there is a higher nature—the living beings that sustain the world.

Key Insight:

Life (consciousness) is divine energy.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
एतद्योनीनि भूतानि सर्वाणीत्युपधारय ।
अहं कृत्स्नस्य जगतः प्रभवः प्रलयस्तथा ॥7.6॥

Key Insight:
Krishna is the source and dissolution of all.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
मत्तः परतरं नान्यत्किञ्चिदस्ति धनञ्जय ।
मयि सर्वमिदं प्रोतं सूत्रे मणिगणा इव ॥7.7॥

Transliteration:
mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya
mayi sarvam idaṁ protaṁ sūtre maṇi-gaṇā iva

English Meaning:
There is nothing higher than Me; everything rests on Me like pearls on a thread.

Key Insight:
God is the underlying reality of everything.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
रसोऽहमप्सु कौन्तेय प्रभास्मि शशिसूर्ययोः ।
प्रणवः सर्ववेदेषु शब्दः खे पौरुषं नृषु ॥7.8॥

Key Insight:
Krishna is present in all essential qualities.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

पुण्यो गन्धः पृथिव्यां च तेजश्चास्मि विभावसौ ।
जीवनं सर्वभूतेषु तपश्चास्मि तपस्विषु ॥7.9॥

Key Insight:

Divinity exists in all life and energy.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

बीजं मां सर्वभूतानां विद्धि पार्थ सनातनम् ।
बुद्धिर्बुद्धिमतामस्मि तेजस्तेजस्विनामहम् ॥7.10॥

Key Insight:

God is the seed of all existence.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

बलं बलवतां चाहं कामरागविवर्जितम् ।
धर्माविरुद्धो भूतेषु कामोऽस्मि भरतर्षभ ॥7.11॥

Key Insight:

Divine strength is free from selfish desire.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये चैव सात्त्विका भावा राजसास्तामसाश्च ये ।
मत्त एवेति तान्विद्धि न त्वहं तेषु ते मयि ॥7.12॥

Key Insight:
All qualities arise from God but do not bind Him.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:
त्रिभिर्गुणमयैर्भावैरेभिः सर्वमिदं जगत् ।
मोहितं नाभिजानाति मामेभ्यः परमव्ययम् ॥7.13॥

Key Insight:
The world is deluded by the three gunas.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:
दैवी ह्येषा गुणमयी मम माया दुरत्यया ।
मामेव ये प्रपद्यन्ते मायामेतां तरन्ति ते ॥7.14॥

Transliteration:
daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī mama māyā duratyayā
mām eva ye prapadyante māyām etāṁ taranti te

English Meaning:
My divine illusion is difficult to overcome, but those who surrender to Me cross it.

Key Insight:
Surrender to God overcomes illusion.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

न मां दुष्कृतिनो मूढाः प्रपद्यन्ते नराधमाः ।
माययापहृतज्ञाना आसुरं भावमाश्रिताः ॥7.15॥

Key Insight:

Ignorance prevents surrender.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

चतुर्विधा भजन्ते मां जनाः सुकृतिनोऽर्जुन ।
आर्तो जिज्ञासुरर्थार्थी ज्ञानी च भरतर्षभ ॥7.16॥

Key Insight:

Four types approach God: distressed, seekers, wealth-seekers, and wise.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

तेषां ज्ञानी नित्ययुक्त एकभक्तिर्विशिष्यते ।
प्रियो हि ज्ञानिनोऽत्यर्थमहं स च मम प्रियः ॥7.17॥

Key Insight:

The wise devotee is closest to God.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

उदाराः सर्व एवैते ज्ञानी त्वात्मैव मे मतम् ।
आस्थितः स हि युक्तात्मा मामेवानुत्तमां गतिम् ॥7.18॥

Key Insight:
The wise are one with the Divine.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:
बहूनां जन्मनामन्ते ज्ञानवान्मां प्रपद्यते ।
वासुदेवः सर्वमिति स महात्मा सुदुर्लभः ॥7.19॥

Transliteration:
bahūnāṁ janmanām ante jñānavān māṁ prapadyate
vāsudevaḥ sarvam iti sa mahātmā su-durlabhaḥ

English Meaning:
After many births, the wise realize that everything is God.

Key Insight:
Ultimate realization is unity with God.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:
कामैस्तैस्तैर्हृतज्ञानाः प्रपद्यन्तेऽन्यदेवताः ।
तं तं नियममास्थाय प्रकृत्या नियताः स्वया ॥7.20॥

Key Insight:
Desire leads people to limited worship.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
यो यो यां यां तनुं भक्तः श्रद्धयार्चितुमिच्छति ।
तस्य तस्याचलां श्रद्धां तामेव विदधाम्यहम् ॥7.21॥

Transliteration:
yo yo yāṁ yāṁ tanuṁ bhaktaḥ śraddhayārcitum icchati
tasya tasyācalāṁ śraddhāṁ tām eva vidadhāmy aham

English Meaning:
Whatever form a devotee chooses to worship with faith, I make that faith steady.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna explains that even diverse forms of worship are ultimately supported by Him. Faith itself is sustained by the Divine.

Practical Application:

- Respect different spiritual paths
- Understand unity behind diversity

Key Insight:
All sincere faith is supported by the Divine.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
स तया श्रद्धया युक्तस्तस्याराधनमीहते ।
लभते च ततः कामान्मयैव विहितान्हि तान् ॥7.22॥

Transliteration:
sa tayā śraddhayā yuktas tasyārādhanam īhate
labhate ca tataḥ kāmān mayaiva vihitān hi tān

English Meaning:
Endowed with that faith, the devotee worships and obtains desired results, which are granted by Me.

Detailed Explanation:
Even when people worship other forms, it is ultimately Krishna who grants the results.

Key Insight:
All results come from the same Divine source.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
अन्तवत्तु फलं तेषां तद्भवत्यल्पमेधसाम् ।
देवान्देवयजो यान्ति मद्भक्ता यान्ति मामपि ॥7.23॥

Transliteration:
antavat tu phalaṁ teṣāṁ tad bhavaty alpa-medhasām
devān deva-yajo yānti mad-bhaktā yānti mām api

English Meaning:
Those who worship other deities attain temporary results; My devotees attain Me.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna distinguishes between **temporary rewards vs eternal realization.**

Key Insight:
Seek the eternal, not the temporary.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
अव्यक्तं व्यक्तिमापन्नं मन्यन्ते मामबुद्धयः ।
परं भावमजानन्तो ममाव्ययमनुत्तमम् ॥7.24॥

Transliteration:
avyaktaṁ vyaktim āpannaṁ manyante mām abuddhayaḥ
paraṁ bhāvam ajānanto mamāvyayam anuttamam

English Meaning:
The ignorant think I have taken a material form, not knowing My supreme nature.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna clarifies that His form is divine, not limited like ordinary beings.

Key Insight:
God's nature is beyond material perception.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:
नाहं प्रकाशः सर्वस्य योगमायासमावृतः ।
मूढोऽयं नाभिजानाति लोको मामजमव्ययम् ॥7.25॥

Transliteration:
nāhaṁ prakāśaḥ sarvasya yoga-māyā-samāvṛtaḥ
mūḍho 'yaṁ nābhijānāti loko mām ajam avyayam

English Meaning:
I am not revealed to all; being covered by My divine energy, people do not recognize Me.

Key Insight:
Ignorance hides divine reality.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

वेदाहं समतीतानि वर्तमानानि चार्जुन ।
भविष्याणि च भूतानि मां तु वेद न कश्चन ॥7.26॥

Transliteration:

vedāhaṁ samatītāni vartamānāni cārjuna
bhaviṣyāṇi ca bhūtāni māṁ tu veda na kaścana

English Meaning:

I know past, present, and future, but no one fully knows Me.

Key Insight:

God is omniscient; humans are limited.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

इच्छाद्वेषसमुत्थेन द्वन्द्वमोहेन भारत ।
सर्वभूतानि सम्मोहं सर्गे यान्ति परन्तप ॥7.27॥

Transliteration:

icchā-dveṣa-samutthena dvandva-mohena bhārata
sarva-bhūtāni sammohaṁ sarge yānti parantapa

English Meaning:

All beings fall into delusion due to desire and hatred.

Detailed Explanation:

Dualities (likes/dislikes) create confusion and ignorance.

Key Insight:

Attachment and aversion cause delusion.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

येषां त्वन्तगतं पापं जनानां पुण्यकर्मणाम् ।
ते द्वन्द्वमोहनिर्मुक्ता भजन्ते मां दृढव्रताः ॥7.28॥

Transliteration:

yeṣāṁ tv anta-gataṁ pāpaṁ janānāṁ puṇya-karmaṇām
te dvandva-moha-nirmuktā bhajante māṁ dṛḍha-vratāḥ

English Meaning:

Those whose sins are removed engage in devotion with determination.

Key Insight:

Purity leads to devotion.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

जरामरणमोक्षाय मामाश्रित्य यतन्ति ये ।
ते ब्रह्म तद्विदुः कृत्स्नमध्यात्मं कर्म चाखिलम् ॥7.29॥

Transliteration:

jarā-maraṇa-mokṣāya mām āśritya yatanti ye
te brahma tad viduḥ kṛtsnam adhyātmaṁ karma cākhilam

English Meaning:

Those who seek freedom from birth and death take refuge in Me and understand Brahman.

Key Insight:

Surrender leads to liberation.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

साधिभूताधिदैवं मां साधियज्ञं च ये विदुः ।
प्रयाणकालेऽपि च मां ते विदुर्युक्तचेतसः ॥7.30॥

Transliteration:

sādhibhūtādhidaivaṁ māṁ sādhiyajñaṁ ca ye viduḥ
prayāṇa-kāle ’pi ca māṁ te vidur yukta-cetasaḥ

English Meaning:

Those who understand Me as the essence of all existence remember Me even at death.

Detailed Explanation:

Final remembrance of God leads to liberation.

Key Insight:

What you remember at death reflects your life’s focus.

Chapter 8: Akshara Brahma Yoga (The Yoga of the Imperishable Absolute)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
किं तद्ब्रह्म किमध्यात्मं किं कर्म पुरुषोत्तम ।
अधिभूतं च किं प्रोक्तमधिदैवं किमुच्यते ॥8.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
kiṁ tad brahma kim adhyātmaṁ kiṁ karma puruṣottama
adhibhūtaṁ ca kiṁ proktam adhidaivaṁ kim ucyate

English Meaning:

Arjuna asks: What is Brahman? What is the Self? What is action? What are the material and divine aspects?

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna seeks precise definitions of key spiritual concepts.

Key Insight:

Inquiry leads to clarity.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

अधियज्ञः कथं कोऽत्र देहेऽस्मिन्मधुसूदन ।
प्रयाणकाले च कथं ज्ञेयोऽसि नियतात्मभिः ॥8.2॥

Transliteration:
adhiyajñaḥ kathaṁ ko ’tra dehe ’smin madhusūdana
prayāṇa-kāle ca kathaṁ jñeyo ’si niyatātmabhiḥ

English Meaning:
How is God present in the body, and how can one remember Him at death?

Key Insight:
Preparation for death is central to spiritual life.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अक्षरं ब्रह्म परमं स्वभावोऽध्यात्ममुच्यते ।
भूतभावोद्भवकरो विसर्गः कर्मसंज्ञितः ॥8.3॥

Transliteration:
akṣaraṁ brahma paramaṁ svabhāvo ’dhyātmam ucyate
bhūta-bhāvodbhava-karo visargaḥ karma-saṁjñitaḥ

English Meaning:
Krishna said: Brahman is the imperishable, the Self is one's nature, and action is creation.

Key Insight:
Brahman is eternal and unchanging.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
अधिभूतं क्षरो भावः पुरुषश्चाधिदैवतम् ।
अधियज्ञोऽहमेवात्र देहे देहभृतां वर ॥8.4॥

Transliteration:

adhibhūtaṁ kṣaro bhāvaḥ puruṣaś cādhidaivatam
adhiyajño ’ham evātra dehe deha-bhṛtāṁ vara

English Meaning:

The material world is perishable; the divine is the cosmic being; I am the sacrifice within the body.

Key Insight:

God resides within all beings.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

अन्तकाले च मामेव स्मरन्मुक्त्वा कलेवरम् ।
यः प्रयाति स मद्भावं याति नास्त्यत्र संशयः ॥8.5॥

Transliteration:

anta-kāle ca mām eva smaran muktvā kalevaram
yaḥ prayāti sa mad-bhāvaṁ yāti nāsty atra saṁśayaḥ

English Meaning:

One who remembers Me at death attains Me.

Key Insight:

Final remembrance determines destiny.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

यं यं वापि स्मरन्भावं त्यजत्यन्ते कलेवरम् ।
तं तमेवैति कौन्तेय सदा तद्भावभावितः ॥8.6॥

Transliteration:

yaṁ yaṁ vāpi smaran bhāvaṁ tyajaty ante kalevaram
taṁ tam evaiti kaunteya sadā tad-bhāva-bhāvitaḥ

English Meaning:

Whatever one remembers at death, that state one attains.

Key Insight:

Your life determines your final thought.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु मामनुस्मर युध्य च ।
मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्मामेवैष्यस्यसंशयम् ॥8.7॥

Transliteration:

tasmāt sarveṣu kāleṣu mām anusmara yudhya ca
mayy arpita-mano-buddhir mām evaiṣyasy asaṁśayam

English Meaning:

Therefore, remember Me always and perform your duty.

Key Insight:

Balance action with remembrance.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

अभ्यासयोगयुक्तेन चेतसा नान्यगामिना ।
परमं पुरुषं दिव्यं याति पार्थानुचिन्तयन् ॥8.8॥

Key Insight:

Practice leads to constant remembrance.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

कविं पुराणमनुशासितारमणोरणीयांसमनुस्मरेद्यः ।
सर्वस्य धातारमचिन्त्यरूपमादित्यवर्णं तमसः परस्तात् ॥8.9॥

Key Insight:

Meditate on the supreme divine form.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रयाणकाले मनसाऽचलेन भक्त्या युक्तो योगबलेन चैव ।
भ्रुवोर्मध्ये प्राणमावेश्य सम्यक् स तं परं पुरुषमुपैति दिव्यम् ॥8.10॥

Key Insight:

Focused meditation at death leads to liberation.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदक्षरं वेदविदो वदन्ति विशन्ति यद्यतयो वीतरागाः ।
यदिच्छन्तो ब्रह्मचर्यं चरन्ति तत्ते पदं सङ्ग्रहेण प्रवक्ष्ये ॥8.11॥

Key Insight:

The goal of spiritual discipline is Brahman.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वद्वाराणि संयम्य मनो हृदि निरुध्य च ।
मूर्ध्न्याधायात्मनः प्राणमास्थितो योगधारणाम् ॥8.12॥

Key Insight:

Control senses and mind in meditation.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

ओमित्येकाक्षरं ब्रह्म व्याहरन्मामनुस्मरन् ।
यः प्रयाति त्यजन्देहं स याति परमां गतिम् ॥8.13॥

Transliteration:

om ity ekākṣaraṁ brahma vyāharan mām anusmaran
yaḥ prayāti tyajan dehaṁ sa yāti paramāṁ gatim

English Meaning:

Chanting Om and remembering God at death leads to liberation.

Key Insight:

Sacred sound connects to the Divine.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनन्यचेताः सततं यो मां स्मरति नित्यशः ।
तस्याहं सुलभः पार्थ नित्ययुक्तस्य योगिनः ॥8.14॥

Key Insight:

Constant remembrance makes God easily attainable.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

मामुपेत्य पुनर्जन्म दुःखालयमशाश्वतम् ।
नाप्नुवन्ति महात्मानः संसिद्धिं परमां गताः ॥8.15॥

Key Insight:

Liberation ends the cycle of rebirth.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

आब्रह्मभुवनाल्लोकाः पुनरावर्तिनोऽर्जुन ।
मामुपेत्य तु कौन्तेय पुनर्जन्म न विद्यते ॥8.16॥

Key Insight:

Even heavenly realms are temporary.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

सहस्रयुगपर्यन्तमहर्यद्ब्रह्मणो विदुः ।
रात्रिं युगसहस्रान्तां तेऽहोरात्रविदो जनाः ॥8.17॥

Key Insight:

Cosmic time is vast.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

अव्यक्ताद्व्यक्तयः सर्वाः प्रभवन्त्यहरागमे ।
रात्र्यागमे प्रलीयन्ते तत्रैवाव्यक्तसंज्ञके ॥8.18॥

Key Insight:

Creation and dissolution are cyclical.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

भूतग्रामः स एवायं भूत्वा भूत्वा प्रलीयते ।
रात्र्यागमेऽवशः पार्थ प्रभवत्यहरागमे ॥8.19॥

Key Insight:

Existence is repetitive.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

परस्तस्मात्तु भावोऽन्योऽव्यक्तोऽव्यक्तात्सनातनः ।
यः स सर्वेषु भूतेषु नश्यत्सु न विनश्यति ॥8.20॥

Transliteration:

paras tasmāt tu bhāvo ’nyo ’vyakto ’vyaktāt sanātanaḥ
yaḥ sa sarveṣu bhūteṣu naśyatsu na vinaśyati

English Meaning:

Beyond this temporary world is an eternal reality that never perishes.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reveals the **ultimate eternal realm beyond material existence.**

Key Insight:

There is a reality beyond the changing world.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:

अव्यक्तोऽक्षर इत्युक्तस्तमाहुः परमां गतिम् ।
यं प्राप्य न निवर्तन्ते तद्धाम परमं मम ॥8.21॥

Transliteration:
avyakto ’kṣara ity uktas tam āhuḥ paramāṁ gatim
yaṁ prāpya na nivartante tad dhāma paramaṁ mama

English Meaning:
That unmanifest, imperishable reality is called the supreme destination. Attaining it, one never returns; it is My supreme abode.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna describes the **ultimate spiritual realm**, beyond birth and death. It is eternal and free from all suffering.

Practical Application:

- Aim for lasting spiritual goals, not temporary gains
- Focus on liberation, not worldly cycles

Key Insight:
The highest goal is eternal union with the Divine.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
पुरुषः स परः पार्थ भक्त्या लभ्यस्त्वनन्यया ।
यस्यान्तःस्थानि भूतानि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ॥8.22॥

Transliteration:
puruṣaḥ sa paraḥ pārtha bhaktyā labhyas tv ananyayā
yasyāntaḥ-sthāni bhūtāni yena sarvam idaṁ tatam

English Meaning:
That Supreme Being is attained through unwavering devotion, and everything exists within Him.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna emphasizes **exclusive devotion (ananya bhakti)** as the path to the highest realization.

Key Insight:
Devotion is the gateway to the Supreme.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
यत्र काले त्वनावृत्तिमावृत्तिं चैव योगिनः ।
प्रयाता यान्ति तं कालं वक्ष्यामि भरतर्षभ ॥8.23॥

Transliteration:
yatra kāle tv anāvṛttim āvṛttiṁ caiva yoginaḥ
prayātā yānti taṁ kālaṁ vakṣyāmi bharatarṣabha

English Meaning:
Krishna explains the paths of return and non-return after death.

Detailed Explanation:
He introduces two spiritual paths—one leading to liberation, the other to rebirth.

Key Insight:
The path at death determines future existence.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
अग्निर्ज्योतिरहः शुक्लः षण्मासा उत्तरायणम् ।
तत्र प्रयाता गच्छन्ति ब्रह्म ब्रह्मविदो जनाः ॥8.24॥

Transliteration:
agnir jyotir ahaḥ śuklaḥ ṣaṇ-māsā uttarāyaṇam
tatra prayātā gacchanti brahma brahma-vido janāḥ

English Meaning:
Those who depart during the path of light attain Brahman.

Detailed Explanation:
This symbolizes the **path of enlightenment.**

Key Insight:
Spiritual awareness leads to liberation.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:
धूमो रात्रिस्तथा कृष्णः षण्मासा दक्षिणायनम् ।
तत्र चान्द्रमसं ज्योतिर्योगी प्राप्य निवर्तते ॥8.25॥

Transliteration:
dhūmo rātris tathā kṛṣṇaḥ ṣaṇ-māsā dakṣiṇāyanam
tatra cāndramasaṁ jyotir yogī prāpya nivartate

English Meaning:
Those who depart through the path of darkness return to rebirth.

Key Insight:
Ignorance leads to continued cycles.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:
शुक्लकृष्णे गती ह्येते जगतः शाश्वते मते ।
एकया यात्यनावृत्तिमन्ययावर्तते पुनः ॥8.26॥

Transliteration:

śukla-kṛṣṇe gatī hy ete jagataḥ śāśvate mate
ekayā yāty anāvṛttim anyayāvartate punaḥ

English Meaning:

There are two eternal paths—one leads to liberation, the other to return.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna summarizes the dual paths of existence.

Key Insight:

Choose the path of light through knowledge and devotion.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

नैते सृती पार्थ जानन्योगी मुह्यति कश्चन ।
तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु योगयुक्तो भवार्जुन ॥8.27॥

Transliteration:

naite sṛtī pārtha jānan yogī muhyati kaścana
tasmāt sarveṣu kāleṣu yoga-yukto bhavārjuna

English Meaning:

A yogi who understands these paths is never deluded. Therefore, be steadfast in Yoga.

Detailed Explanation:

Awareness removes confusion and guides right living.

Key Insight:

Knowledge prevents delusion.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

वेदेषु यज्ञेषु तपःसु चैव
दानेषु यत्पुण्यफलं प्रदिष्टम् ।
अत्येति तत्सर्वमिदं विदित्वा
योगी परं स्थानमुपैति चाद्यम् ॥8.28॥

Transliteration:

vedeṣu yajñeṣu tapaḥsu caiva
dāneṣu yat puṇya-phalaṁ pradiṣṭam
atyeti tat sarvam idaṁ viditvā
yogī paraṁ sthānam upaiti cādyam

English Meaning:

One who understands this knowledge surpasses all ritual rewards and attains the supreme state.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes that **spiritual knowledge and realization surpass all rituals and merits.**

Practical Application:

- Go beyond mechanical rituals
- Seek true understanding and realization

Key Insight:

Knowledge and devotion transcend all rituals.

Chapter 9: Raja Vidya Raja Guhya Yoga (The Yoga of Royal Knowledge and Royal Secret)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
इदं तु ते गुह्यतमं प्रवक्ष्याम्यनसूयवे ।
ज्ञानं विज्ञानसहितं यज्ज्ञात्वा मोक्ष्यसेऽशुभात् ॥9.1॥

Transliteration:

idaṁ tu te guhyatamaṁ pravakṣyāmy anasūyave
jñānaṁ vijñāna-sahitaṁ yaj jñātvā mokṣyase ’śubhāt

English Meaning:

Krishna said: I will reveal to you the most confidential knowledge, knowing which you will be freed from all suffering.

Detailed Explanation:

This chapter is called the **most secret wisdom** because it reveals direct devotion to God as the highest path.

Key Insight:

Divine knowledge liberates completely.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

राजविद्या राजगुह्यं पवित्रमिदमुत्तमम् ।
प्रत्यक्षावगमं धर्म्यं सुसुखं कर्तुमव्ययम् ॥9.2॥

Transliteration:

rāja-vidyā rāja-guhyaṁ pavitram idam uttamam
pratyakṣāvagamaṁ dharmyaṁ su-sukhaṁ kartum avyayam

English Meaning:

This is the king of knowledge, the purest, directly experienced, and easy to practice.

Key Insight:

The highest truth is simple and practical.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

अश्रद्दधानाः पुरुषा धर्मस्यास्य परन्तप ।
अप्राप्य मां निवर्तन्ते मृत्युसंसारवर्त्मनि ॥9.3॥

Key Insight:

Lack of faith leads to continued suffering.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

मया ततमिदं सर्वं जगदव्यक्तमूर्तिना ।
मत्स्थानि सर्वभूतानि न चाहं तेष्ववस्थितः ॥9.4॥

Transliteration:

mayā tatam idaṁ sarvaṁ jagad avyakta-mūrtinā
mat-sthāni sarva-bhūtāni na cāhaṁ teṣv avasthitaḥ

English Meaning:

I pervade the entire universe, yet I remain beyond it.

Key Insight:

God is both immanent and transcendent.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
न च मत्स्थानि भूतानि पश्य मे योगमैश्वरम् ।
भूतभृन्न च भूतस्थो ममात्मा भूतभावनः ॥9.5॥

Key Insight:
Divine reality transcends logical understanding.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
यथाकाशस्थितो नित्यं वायुः सर्वत्रगो महान् ।
तथा सर्वाणि भूतानि मत्स्थानीत्युपधारय ॥9.6॥

Key Insight:
Everything exists within God like air in space.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वभूतानि कौन्तेय प्रकृतिं यान्ति मामिकाम् ।
कल्पक्षये पुनस्तानि कल्पादौ विसृजाम्यहम् ॥9.7॥

Key Insight:
Creation and dissolution are cyclical.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
प्रकृतिं स्वामवष्टभ्य विसृजामि पुनः पुनः ।
भूतग्राममिमं कृत्स्नमवशं प्रकृतेर्वशात् ॥9.8॥

Key Insight:
Nature operates under divine supervision.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:
न च मां तानि कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ।
उदासीनवदासीनमसक्तं तेषु कर्मसु ॥9.9॥

Key Insight:
God remains unattached to creation.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:
मयाध्यक्षेण प्रकृतिः सूयते सचराचरम् ।
हेतुनानेन कौन्तेय जगद्विपरिवर्तते ॥9.10॥

Key Insight:
The universe operates under divine guidance.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:
अवजानन्ति मां मूढा मानुषीं तनुमाश्रितम् ।
परं भावमजानन्तो मम भूतमहेश्वरम् ॥9.11॥

Key Insight:
Ignorant people fail to recognize divine incarnation.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

मोघाशा मोघकर्माणो मोघज्ञाना विचेतसः ।
राक्षसीमासुरीं चैव प्रकृतिं मोहिनीं श्रिताः ॥9.12॥

Key Insight:

Delusion leads to wasted effort.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

महात्मानस्तु मां पार्थ दैवीं प्रकृतिमाश्रिताः ।
भजन्त्यनन्यमनसो ज्ञात्वा भूतादिमव्ययम् ॥9.13॥

Key Insight:

Great souls worship God with devotion.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

सततं कीर्तयन्तो मां यतन्तश्च दृढव्रताः ।
नमस्यन्तश्च मां भक्त्या नित्ययुक्ता उपासते ॥9.14॥

Key Insight:

Devotion includes remembrance, effort, and surrender.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानयज्ञेन चाप्यन्ये यजन्तो मामुपासते ।
एकत्वेन पृथक्त्वेन बहुधा विश्वतोमुखम् ॥9.15॥

Key Insight:

God can be worshipped in many ways.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

अहं क्रतुरहं यज्ञः स्वधाहमहमौषधम् ।
मन्त्रोऽहमहमेवाज्यमहमग्निरहं हुतम् ॥9.16॥

Key Insight:

God is present in every aspect of sacrifice.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

पिताहमस्य जगतो माता धाता पितामहः ।
वेद्यं पवित्रमोंकार ऋक्साम यजुरेव च ॥9.17॥

Key Insight:

God is father, mother, and essence of all knowledge.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

गतिर्भर्ता प्रभुः साक्षी निवासः शरणं सुहृत् ।
प्रभवः प्रलयः स्थानं निधानं बीजमव्ययम् ॥9.18॥

Key Insight:

God is the origin, support, and refuge of all.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

तपाम्यहमहं वर्षं निगृह्णाम्युत्सृजामि च ।
अमृतं चैव मृत्युश्च सदसच्चाहमर्जुन ॥9.19॥

Key Insight:

God is both life and death.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

त्रैविद्या मां सोमपाः पूतपापा
यज्ञैरिष्ट्वा स्वर्गतिं प्रार्थयन्ते ।
ते पुण्यमासाद्य सुरेन्द्रलोकम्
अश्नन्ति दिव्यान्दिवि देवभोगान् ॥9.20॥

Key Insight:

Rituals give temporary heavenly results.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:

ते तं भुक्त्वा स्वर्गलोकं विशालं
क्षीणे पुण्ये मर्त्यलोकं विशन्ति ।
एवं त्रयीधर्ममनुप्रपन्ना
गतागतं कामकामा लभन्ते ॥9.21॥

Transliteration:

te taṁ bhuktvā svarga-lokaṁ viśālaṁ
kṣīṇe puṇye martya-lokaṁ viśanti
evaṁ trayī-dharmam anuprapannā
gatāgataṁ kāma-kāmā labhante

English Meaning:

After enjoying heaven, they return to the mortal world when their merit is exhausted. Thus, those who seek pleasure cycle through birth and death.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna highlights the **temporary nature of heavenly rewards**—even heaven is not liberation.

Key Insight:
Desire-driven actions lead to repeated cycles.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
अनन्याश्चिन्तयन्तो मां ये जनाः पर्युपासते ।
तेषां नित्याभियुक्तानां योगक्षेमं वहाम्यहम् ॥9.22॥

Transliteration:
ananyāś cintayanto māṁ ye janāḥ paryupāsate
teṣāṁ nityābhiyuktānāṁ yoga-kṣemaṁ vahāmy aham

English Meaning:
Those who worship Me with devotion—I personally take care of their needs.

Detailed Explanation:
This is one of the most reassuring verses—God Himself protects and sustains the devotee.

Practical Application:

- Trust divine support
- Focus on devotion rather than anxiety

Key Insight:
God takes responsibility for devoted souls.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:

येऽप्यन्यदेवता भक्ता यजन्ते श्रद्धयान्विताः ।
तेऽपि मामेव कौन्तेय यजन्त्यविधिपूर्वकम् ॥9.23॥

Key Insight:

All worship ultimately reaches God, though indirectly.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

अहं हि सर्वयज्ञानां भोक्ता च प्रभुरेव च ।
न तु मामभिजानन्ति तत्त्वेनातश्च्यवन्ति ते ॥9.24॥

Key Insight:

Not knowing God leads to limited results.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

यान्ति देवव्रता देवान्पितॄन्यान्ति पितृव्रताः ।
भूतानि यान्ति भूतेज्या यान्ति मद्याजिनोऽपि माम् ॥9.25॥

Transliteration:

yānti deva-vratā devān pitṝn yānti pitṛ-vratāḥ
bhūtāni yānti bhūtejyā yānti mad-yājino ’pi mām

English Meaning:

Worshippers of gods go to gods; My devotees come to Me.

Key Insight:

Your focus determines your destination.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

पत्रं पुष्पं फलं तोयं यो मे भक्त्या प्रयच्छति ।
तदहं भक्त्युपहृतमश्नामि प्रयतात्मनः ॥9.26॥

Transliteration:

patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyaṁ yo me bhaktyā prayacchati
tad ahaṁ bhakty-upahṛtam aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ

English Meaning:

If one offers Me a leaf, flower, fruit, or water with devotion, I accept it.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna emphasizes that **devotion matters more than material value.**

Key Insight:

God values devotion, not grandeur.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

यत्करोषि यदश्नासि यज्जुहोषि ददासि यत् ।
यत्तपस्यसि कौन्तेय तत्कुरुष्व मदर्पणम् ॥9.27॥

Transliteration:

yat karoṣi yad aśnāsi yaj juhoṣi dadāsi yat
yat tapasyasi kaunteya tat kuruṣva mad-arpaṇam

English Meaning:

Whatever you do, offer it to Me.

Detailed Explanation:

This is the essence of **Karma Yoga combined with Bhakti.**

Key Insight:

Turn all actions into devotion.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

शुभाशुभफलैरेवं मोक्ष्यसे कर्मबन्धनैः ।
संन्यासयोगयुक्तात्मा विमुक्तो मामुपैष्यसि ॥9.28॥

Key Insight:

Offering actions frees from karma.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

समोऽहं सर्वभूतेषु न मे द्वेष्योऽस्ति न प्रियः ।
ये भजन्ति तु मां भक्त्या मयि ते तेषु चाप्यहम् ॥9.29॥

Transliteration:

samo ’haṁ sarva-bhūteṣu na me dveṣyo ’sti na priyaḥ
ye bhajanti tu māṁ bhaktyā mayi te teṣu cāpy aham

English Meaning:

I am equal to all, but those who worship Me are dear to Me.

Key Insight:

God is impartial yet responsive to devotion.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

अपि चेत्सुदुराचारो भजते मामनन्यभाक् ।
साधुरेव स मन्तव्यः सम्यग्व्यवसितो हि सः ॥9.30॥

Transliteration:

api cet su-durācāro bhajate mām ananya-bhāk
sādhur eva sa mantavyaḥ samyag vyavasito hi saḥ

English Meaning:

Even a sinner becomes righteous if devoted to Me.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna shows **compassion and transformation through devotion.**

Key Insight:

Devotion transforms even the worst.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

क्षिप्रं भवति धर्मात्मा शश्वच्छान्तिं निगच्छति ।
कौन्तेय प्रतिजानीहि न मे भक्तः प्रणश्यति ॥9.31॥

Transliteration:

kṣipraṁ bhavati dharmātmā śaśvac-chāntiṁ nigacchati
kaunteya pratijānīhi na me bhaktaḥ praṇaśyati

English Meaning:

My devotee never perishes.

Key Insight:

Divine protection is assured.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

मां हि पार्थ व्यपाश्रित्य येऽपि स्युः पापयोनयः ।
स्त्रियो वैश्यास्तथा शूद्रास्तेऽपि यान्ति परां गतिम् ॥9.32॥

Key Insight:
Everyone has access to liberation.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:
किं पुनर्ब्राह्मणाः पुण्या भक्ता राजर्षयस्तथा ।
अनित्यमसुखं लोकमिमं प्राप्य भजस्व माम् ॥9.33॥

Key Insight:
This world is temporary—seek God.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:
मन्मना भव मद्भक्तो मद्याजी मां नमस्कुरु ।
मामेवैष्यसि युक्त्वैवमात्मानं मत्परायणः ॥9.34॥

Transliteration:
man-manā bhava mad-bhakto mad-yājī māṁ namaskuru
mām evaiṣyasi yuktvaivam ātmānaṁ mat-parāyaṇaḥ

English Meaning:
Fix your mind on Me, become My devotee, worship Me—you will come to Me.

Detailed Explanation:
This verse summarizes the entire chapter—**think of God, love God, serve God.**

Key Insight:
Devotion is the simplest and highest path.

Chapter 10: Vibhuti Yoga (The Yoga of Divine Glories)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
भूय एव महाबाहो शृणु मे परमं वचः ।
यत्तेऽहं प्रीयमाणाय वक्ष्यामि हितकाम्यया ॥10.1॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
bhūya eva mahā-bāho śṛṇu me paramaṁ vacaḥ
yat te ’haṁ prīyamāṇāya vakṣyāmi hita-kāmyayā

English Meaning:
Krishna said: Listen again, O Arjuna, as I speak for your benefit and out of love.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna continues teaching out of compassion, emphasizing that divine knowledge is given out of love.

Key Insight:
Divine wisdom is given with compassion.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:
न मे विदुः सुरगणाः प्रभवं न महर्षयः ।
अहमादिर्हि देवानां महर्षीणां च सर्वशः ॥10.2॥

Transliteration:

na me viduḥ sura-gaṇāḥ prabhavaṁ na maharṣayaḥ
aham ādir hi devānāṁ maharṣīṇāṁ ca sarvaśaḥ

English Meaning:

Neither gods nor sages know My origin, for I am the source of all.

Key Insight:

God is the origin of everything.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

यो मामजमनादिं च वेत्ति लोकमहेश्वरम् ।
असम्मूढः स मर्त्येषु सर्वपापैः प्रमुच्यते ॥10.3॥

Key Insight:

Knowing God removes all ignorance.

Verse 4–5

Sanskrit Shloka:

बुद्धिर्ज्ञानमसम्मोहः क्षमा सत्यं दमः शमः ।
सुखं दुःखं भवोऽभावो भयं चाभयमेव च ॥10.4॥
अहिंसा समता तुष्टिस्तपो दानं यशोऽयशः ।
भवन्ति भावाः भूतानां मत्त एव पृथग्विधाः ॥10.5॥

Transliteration:

buddhir jñānam asammohaḥ kṣamā satyaṁ damaḥ śamaḥ
sukhaṁ duḥkhaṁ bhavo ’bhāvo bhayaṁ cābhayam eva ca
ahiṁsā samatā tuṣṭis tapo dānaṁ yaśo ’yaśaḥ
bhavanti bhāvā bhūtānāṁ matta eva pṛthag-vidhāḥ

English Meaning:
All qualities—intelligence, truth, peace, happiness, fear—arise from Me.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna declares that **all human qualities originate from the Divine.**

Key Insight:
All qualities come from God.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
महर्षयः सप्त पूर्वे चत्वारो मनवस्तथा ।
मद्भावा मानसा जाता येषां लोक इमाः प्रजाः ॥10.6॥

Key Insight:
All beings originate from divine consciousness.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
एतां विभूतिं योगं च मम यो वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ।
सोऽविकम्पेन योगेन युज्यते नात्र संशयः ॥10.7॥

Key Insight:
Knowing divine glories strengthens devotion.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

अहं सर्वस्य प्रभवो मत्तः सर्वं प्रवर्तते ।
इति मत्वा भजन्ते मां बुधा भावसमन्विताः ॥10.8॥

Transliteration:

ahaṁ sarvasya prabhavo mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartate
iti matvā bhajante māṁ budhā bhāva-samanvitāḥ

English Meaning:

I am the source of all; the wise worship Me with devotion.

Key Insight:

Understanding origin leads to devotion.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

मच्चित्ता मद्गतप्राणा बोधयन्तः परस्परम् ।
कथयन्तश्च मां नित्यं तुष्यन्ति च रमन्ति च ॥10.9॥

Key Insight:

Devotees find joy in discussing God.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

तेषां सततयुक्तानां भजतां प्रीतिपूर्वकम् ।
ददामि बुद्धियोगं तं येन मामुपयान्ति ते ॥10.10॥

Transliteration:

teṣāṁ satata-yuktānāṁ bhajatāṁ prīti-pūrvakam
dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ taṁ yena mām upayānti te

English Meaning:

To devoted souls, I give the understanding by which they come to Me.

Key Insight:

God guides sincere seekers.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

तेषामेवानुकम्पार्थमहमज्ञानजं तमः ।
नाशयाम्यात्मभावस्थो ज्ञानदीपेन भास्वता ॥10.11॥

Key Insight:

God removes ignorance through knowledge.

Verse 12–13

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
परं ब्रह्म परं धाम पवित्रं परमं भवान् ।
पुरुषं शाश्वतं दिव्यमादिदेवं अजं विभुम् ॥10.12॥
आहुस्त्वामृषयः सर्वे देवर्षिर्नारदस्तथा ।
असितो देवलो व्यासः स्वयं चैव ब्रवीषि मे ॥10.13॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna acknowledges Krishna as Supreme.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वमेतदृतं मन्ये यन्मां वदसि केशव ।
न हि ते भगवन्व्यक्तिं विदुर्देवा न दानवाः ॥10.14॥

Key Insight:

Divine truth is beyond comprehension.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

स्वयमेवात्मनाऽत्मानं वेत्थ त्वं पुरुषोत्तम ।
भूतभावन भूतेश देवदेव जगत्पते ॥10.15॥

Key Insight:

Only God fully knows Himself.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

वक्तुमर्हस्यशेषेण दिव्या ह्यात्मविभूतयः ।
याभिर्विभूतिभिर्लोकानिमांस्त्वं व्याप्य तिष्ठसि ॥10.16॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna asks to hear divine glories.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

कथं विद्यामहं योगिंस्त्वां सदा परिचिन्तयन् ।
केषु केषु च भावेषु चिन्त्योऽसि भगवन्मया ॥10.17॥

Key Insight:

How to meditate on God in daily life.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

विस्तरेणात्मनो योगं विभूतिं च जनार्दन ।
भूयः कथय तृप्तिर्हि शृण्वतो नास्ति मेऽमृतम् ॥10.18॥

Key Insight:

Divine knowledge is never tiring.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
हन्त ते कथयिष्यामि दिव्या ह्यात्मविभूतयः ।
प्राधान्यतः कुरुश्रेष्ठ नास्त्यन्तो विस्तरस्य मे ॥10.19॥

Key Insight:

Divine manifestations are infinite.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

अहमात्मा गुडाकेश सर्वभूताशयस्थितः ।
अहमादिश्च मध्यं च भूतानामन्त एव च ॥10.20॥

Transliteration:

aham ātmā guḍākeśa sarva-bhūtāśaya-sthitaḥ
aham ādiś ca madhyaṁ ca bhūtānām anta eva ca

English Meaning:

I am the Self seated in all beings; I am the beginning, middle, and end.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reveals Himself as the **inner Self of all existence.**

Key Insight:
God is the essence of all beings.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
आदित्यानामहं विष्णुर्ज्योतिषां रविरंशुमान् ।
मरीचिर्मरुतामस्मि नक्षत्राणामहं शशी ॥10.21॥

Transliteration:
ādityānām ahaṁ viṣṇur jyotiṣāṁ ravir aṁśumān
marīcir marutām asmi nakṣatrāṇām ahaṁ śaśī

English Meaning:
Among the Adityas, I am Vishnu; among lights, I am the sun; among stars, I am the moon.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna begins listing His **divine manifestations (vibhutis)**—the most powerful, radiant, and supreme aspects in every category.

Key Insight:
God is the highest expression in everything.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
वेदानां सामवेदोऽस्मि देवानामस्मि वासवः ।
इन्द्रियाणां मनश्चास्मि भूतानामस्मि चेतना ॥10.22॥

Key Insight:
Krishna is consciousness and the mind.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:

रुद्राणां शङ्करश्चास्मि वित्तेशो यक्षरक्षसाम् ।
वसूनां पावकश्चास्मि मेरुः शिखरिणामहम् ॥10.23॥

Key Insight:

God is the most powerful among all.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

पुरोधसां च मुख्यं मां विद्धि पार्थ बृहस्पतिम् ।
सेनानीनामहं स्कन्दः सरसामस्मि सागरः ॥10.24॥

Key Insight:

Krishna is the best among leaders and forces.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

महर्षीणां भृगुरहं गिरामस्म्येकमक्षरम् ।
यज्ञानां जपयज्ञोऽस्मि स्थावराणां हिमालयः ॥10.25॥

Transliteration:

maharṣīṇāṁ bhṛgur ahaṁ girām asmy ekam akṣaram
yajñānāṁ japa-yajño ’smi sthāvarāṇāṁ himālayaḥ

English Meaning:

Among sages I am Bhrigu; among words I am Om; among sacrifices I am chanting; among mountains I am the Himalayas.

Key Insight:

God is present in spiritual practices and nature.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

अश्वत्थः सर्ववृक्षाणां देवर्षीणां च नारदः ।
गन्धर्वाणां चित्ररथः सिद्धानां कपिलो मुनिः ॥10.26॥

Key Insight:

Divinity is seen in sacred figures and nature.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

उच्चैःश्रवसमश्वानां विद्धि माममृतोद्भवम् ।
ऐरावतं गजेन्द्राणां नराणां च नराधिपम् ॥10.27॥

Key Insight:

God is the best among all beings.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

आयुधानामहं वज्रं धेनूनामस्मि कामधुक् ।
प्रजनश्चास्मि कन्दर्पः सर्पाणामस्मि वासुकिः ॥10.28॥

Key Insight:

Creative power is divine.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनन्तश्चास्मि नागानां वरुणो यादसामहम् ।
पितॄणामर्यमा चास्मि यमः संयमतामहम् ॥10.29॥

Key Insight:
God is the controller and sustainer.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:
प्रह्लादश्चास्मि दैत्यानां कालः कलयतामहम् ।
मृगाणां च मृगेन्द्रोऽहं वैनतेयश्च पक्षिणाम् ॥10.30॥

Key Insight:
God exists in both good and powerful forces.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:
पवनः पवतामस्मि रामः शस्त्रभृतामहम् ।
झषाणां मकरश्चास्मि स्रोतसामस्मि जाह्नवी ॥10.31॥

Key Insight:
God is purity, strength, and flow.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्गाणामादिरन्तश्च मध्यं चैवाहमर्जुन ।
अध्यात्मविद्या विद्यानां वादः प्रवदतामहम् ॥10.32॥

Key Insight:
Spiritual knowledge is the highest knowledge.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

अक्षराणामकारोऽस्मि द्वन्द्वः सामासिकस्य च ।
अहमेवाक्षयः कालो धाताहं विश्वतोमुखः ॥10.33॥

Key Insight:

God is time and creation.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

मृत्युः सर्वहरश्चाहमुद्भवश्च भविष्यताम् ।
कीर्तिः श्रीर्वाक्च नारीणां स्मृतिर्मेधा धृतिः क्षमा ॥10.34॥

Key Insight:

God is both creation and destruction.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

बृहत्साम तथा साम्नां गायत्री छन्दसामहम् ।
मासानां मार्गशीर्षोऽहमृतूनां कुसुमाकरः ॥10.35॥

Key Insight:

God is present in time and rhythm.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:

द्यूतं छलयतामस्मि तेजस्तेजस्विनामहम् ।
जयोऽस्मि व्यवसायोऽस्मि सत्त्वं सत्त्ववतामहम् ॥10.36॥

Key Insight:

Even skill and success come from God.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:

वृष्णीनां वासुदेवोऽस्मि पाण्डवानां धनञ्जयः ।
मुनीनामप्यहं व्यासः कवीनामुशना कविः ॥10.37॥

Key Insight:

God manifests through great personalities.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:

दण्डो दमयतामस्मि नीतिरस्मि जिगीषताम् ।
मौनं चैवास्मि गुह्यानां ज्ञानं ज्ञानवतामहम् ॥10.38॥

Key Insight:

Discipline and wisdom are divine.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:

यच्चापि सर्वभूतानां बीजं तदहमर्जुन ।
न तदस्ति विना यत्स्यान्मया भूतं चराचरम् ॥10.39॥

Transliteration:

yac cāpi sarva-bhūtānāṁ bījaṁ tad aham arjuna
na tad asti vinā yat syān mayā bhūtaṁ carācaram

English Meaning:

I am the seed of all beings; nothing exists without Me.

Key Insight:

Everything originates from God.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:
नान्तोऽस्ति मम दिव्यानां विभूतीनां परन्तप ।
एष तूद्देशतः प्रोक्तो विभूतेर्विस्तरो मया ॥10.40॥

Key Insight:
Divine manifestations are infinite.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:
यद्यद्विभूतिमत्सत्त्वं श्रीमदूर्जितमेव वा ।
तत्तदेवावगच्छ त्वं मम तेजोंऽशसम्भवम् ॥10.41॥

Transliteration:
yad yad vibhūtimat sattvaṁ śrīmad ūrjitam eva vā
tat tad evāvagaccha tvaṁ mama tejo-’ṁśa-sambhavam

English Meaning:
Whatever is glorious, powerful, or beautiful—know it as a part of My splendor.

Key Insight:
All greatness reflects divine energy.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:
अथवा बहुनैतेन किं ज्ञातेन तवार्जुन ।
विष्टभ्याहमिदं कृत्स्नमेकांशेन स्थितो जगत् ॥10.42॥

Transliteration:

athavā bahunaitena kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna
viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam ekāṁśena sthito jagat

English Meaning:

What need is there for all this detail? I sustain the entire universe with just a fraction of Myself.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes by revealing that even these vast manifestations are only a small part of His infinite nature.

Key Insight:

The universe is sustained by just a fraction of the Divine.

Chapter 11: Vishvarupa Darshana Yoga (The Yoga of the Universal Form)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
मदनुग्रहाय परमं गुह्यमध्यात्मसंज्ञितम् ।
यत्त्वयोक्तं वचस्तेन मोहोऽयं विगतो मम ॥11.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
mad-anugrahāya paramaṁ guhyam adhyātma-saṁjñitam
yat tvayoktaṁ vacas tena moho ’yaṁ vigato mama

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: By Your grace, my delusion has been dispelled.

Detailed Explanation:

After hearing divine knowledge, Arjuna’s confusion is cleared—but he now desires direct vision.

Key Insight:

Knowledge removes confusion.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

भवाप्ययौ हि भूतानां श्रुतौ विस्तरशो मया ।
त्वत्तः कमलपत्राक्ष माहात्म्यमपि चाव्ययम् ॥11.2॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna acknowledges Krishna as the source of creation and dissolution.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:
एवमेतद्यथात्थ त्वमात्मानं परमेश्वर ।
द्रष्टुमिच्छामि ते रूपमैश्वरं पुरुषोत्तम ॥11.3॥

Transliteration:
evam etad yathāttha tvam ātmānaṁ parameśvara
draṣṭum icchāmi te rūpam aiśvaraṁ puruṣottama

English Meaning:
I wish to see Your divine universal form.

Key Insight:
Devotion leads to the desire for direct realization.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
मन्यसे यदि तच्छक्यं मया द्रष्टुमिति प्रभो ।
योगेश्वर ततो मे त्वं दर्शयात्मानमव्ययम् ॥11.4॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna humbly requests divine vision.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

पश्य मे पार्थ रूपाणि शतशोऽथ सहस्रशः ।
नानाविधानि दिव्यानि नानावर्णाकृतीनि च ॥11.5॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
paśya me pārtha rūpāṇi śataśo 'tha sahasraśaḥ
nānā-vidhāni divyāni nānā-varṇākṛtīni ca

English Meaning:
Behold My countless divine forms of various kinds, colors, and shapes.

Key Insight:
Divinity is infinite and multifaceted.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
पश्यादित्यान्वसून्रुद्रानश्विनौ मरुतस्तथा ।
बहून्यदृष्टपूर्वाणि पश्याश्चर्याणि भारत ॥11.6॥

Key Insight:
All celestial beings are within Krishna.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
इहैकस्थं जगत्कृत्स्नं पश्याद्य सचराचरम् ।
मम देहे गुडाकेश यच्चान्यद्द्रष्टुमिच्छसि ॥11.7॥

Transliteration:
ihaika-sthaṁ jagat kṛtsnaṁ paśyādya sa-carācaram
mama dehe guḍākeśa yac cānyad draṣṭum icchasi

English Meaning:

Behold the entire universe in My body.

Key Insight:

The entire cosmos exists within God.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

न तु मां शक्यसे द्रष्टुमनेनैव स्वचक्षुषा ।
दिव्यं ददामि ते चक्षुः पश्य मे योगमैश्वरम् ॥11.8॥

Transliteration:

na tu māṁ śakyase draṣṭum anenaiva sva-cakṣuṣā
divyaṁ dadāmi te cakṣuḥ paśya me yogam aiśvaram

English Meaning:

You cannot see Me with ordinary eyes; I grant you divine vision.

Detailed Explanation:

Spiritual reality requires **transcendent perception.**

Key Insight:

Divine truth requires divine vision.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

संजय उवाच ।
एवमुक्त्वा ततो राजन्महायोगेश्वरो हरिः ।
दर्शयामास पार्थाय परमं रूपमैश्वरम् ॥11.9॥

Key Insight:

Krishna reveals the cosmic form.

Verse 10–11

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनेकवक्त्रनयनमनेकाद्भुतदर्शनम् ।
अनेकदिव्याभरणं दिव्यानेकोद्यतायुधम् ॥11.10॥
दिव्यमाल्याम्बरधरं दिव्यगन्धानुलेपनम् ।
सर्वाश्चर्यमयं देवमनन्तं विश्वतोमुखम् ॥11.11॥

Key Insight:

The universal form is infinite, radiant, and awe-inspiring.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

दिवि सूर्यसहस्रस्य भवेद्युगपदुत्थिता ।
यदि भाः सदृशी सा स्याद्भासस्तस्य महात्मनः ॥11.12॥

Transliteration:

divi sūrya-sahasrasya bhaved yugapad utthitā
yadi bhāḥ sadṛśī sā syād bhāsas tasya mahātmanaḥ

English Meaning:

If a thousand suns rose at once, their brilliance might resemble that form.

Key Insight:

Divine glory is beyond imagination.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्रैकस्थं जगत्कृत्स्नं प्रविभक्तमनेकधा ।
अपश्यद्देवदेवस्य शरीरे पाण्डवस्तदा ॥11.13॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna sees the entire universe in Krishna.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

ततः स विस्मयाविष्टो हृष्टरोमा धनञ्जयः ।
प्रणम्य शिरसा देवं कृताञ्जलिरभाषत ॥11.14॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna is overwhelmed with awe.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
पश्यामि देवांस्तव देव देहे
सर्वांस्तथा भूतविशेषसङ्घान् ।
ब्रह्माणमीशं कमलासनस्थम्
ऋषींश्च सर्वानुरगांश्च दिव्यान् ॥11.15॥

Key Insight:

All beings and gods are within Krishna.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनेकबाहूदरवक्त्रनेत्रं
पश्यामि त्वां सर्वतोऽनन्तरूपम् ।
नान्तं न मध्यं न पुनस्तवादिं
पश्यामि विश्वेश्वर विश्वरूप ॥11.16॥

Key Insight:

Krishna has no beginning, middle, or end.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

किरीटिनं गदिनं चक्रिणं च
तेजोराशिं सर्वतो दीप्तिमन्तम् ।
पश्यामि त्वां दुर्निरीक्ष्यं समन्तात्
दीप्तानलार्कद्युतिमप्रमेयम् ॥11.17॥

Key Insight:

The divine form is overwhelmingly radiant.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

त्वमक्षरं परमं वेदितव्यं
त्वमस्य विश्वस्य परं निधानम् ।
त्वमव्ययः शाश्वतधर्मगोप्ता
सनातनस्त्वं पुरुषो मतो मे ॥11.18॥

Key Insight:

Krishna is the eternal protector of dharma.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनादिमध्यान्तमनन्तवीर्यं
अनन्तबाहुं शशिसूर्यनेत्रम् ।
पश्यामि त्वां दीप्तहुताशवक्त्रं
स्वतेजसा विश्वमिदं तपन्तम् ॥11.19॥

Key Insight:
God is infinite power and light.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:
द्यावापृथिव्योरिदमन्तरं हि
व्याप्तं त्वयैकेन दिशश्च सर्वाः ।
दृष्ट्वाद्भुतं रूपमुग्रं तवेदं
लोकत्रयं प्रव्यथितं महात्मन् ॥11.20॥

Transliteration:
dyāvā-pṛthivyor idam antaraṁ hi
vyāptaṁ tvayaikena diśaś ca sarvāḥ
dṛṣṭvādbhutaṁ rūpam ugraṁ tavedaṁ
loka-trayaṁ pravyathitaṁ mahātman

English Meaning:
The entire universe is filled by You; seeing this terrifying form, all worlds tremble.

Detailed Explanation:
The universal form is both **beautiful and terrifying**, representing creation and destruction.

Key Insight:
The Divine encompasses both creation and destruction.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
अमी हि त्वां सुरसङ्घा विशन्ति
केचिद्भीताः प्राञ्जलयो गृणन्ति ।
स्वस्तीत्युक्त्वा महर्षिसिद्धसङ्घाः
स्तुवन्ति त्वां स्तुतिभिः पुष्कलाभिः ॥11.21॥

Transliteration:

amī hi tvāṁ sura-saṅghā viśanti
kecid bhītāḥ prāñjalayo gṛṇanti
svastīty uktvā maharṣi-siddha-saṅghāḥ
stuvanti tvāṁ stutibhiḥ puṣkalābhiḥ

English Meaning:

Hosts of gods enter into You; some in fear praise You, while sages glorify You with hymns.

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna sees all divine beings reacting to Krishna's cosmic form—some in awe, some in fear.

Key Insight:

The Divine inspires both awe and reverence.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:

रुद्रादित्या वसवो ये च साध्या
विश्वेऽश्विनौ मरुतश्चोष्मपाश्च ।
गन्धर्वयक्षासुरसिद्धसङ्घा
वीक्षन्ते त्वां विस्मिताश्चैव सर्वे ॥11.22॥

Key Insight:

All celestial beings are astonished by Krishna's form.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:

रूपं महत्ते बहुवक्त्रनेत्रं
महाबाहो बहुबाहूरुपादम् ।
बहूदरं बहुदंष्ट्राकरालं
दृष्ट्वा लोकाः प्रव्यथितास्तथाहम् ॥11.23॥

Key Insight:
The terrifying aspect of the divine shakes all beings.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
नभःस्पृशं दीप्तमनैकवर्णं
व्यात्ताननं दीप्तविशालनेत्रम् ।
दृष्ट्वा हि त्वां प्रव्यथितान्तरात्मा
धृतिं न विन्दामि शमं च विष्णो ॥11.24॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna feels overwhelmed and loses inner peace.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:
दंष्ट्राकरालानि च ते मुखानि
दृष्ट्वैव कालानलसन्निभानि ।
दिशो न जाने न लभे च शर्म
प्रसीद देवेश जगन्निवास ॥11.25॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna is terrified by the destructive aspect of God.

Verse 26–27

Sanskrit Shloka:
अमी च त्वां धृतराष्ट्रस्य पुत्राः
सर्वे सहैवावनिपालसङ्घैः ।
भीष्मो द्रोणः सूतपुत्रस्तथासौ
सहास्मदीयैरपि योधमुख्यैः ॥11.26॥
वक्त्राणि ते त्वरमाणा विशन्ति

दंष्ट्राकरालानि भयानकानि ।
केचिद्विलग्ना दशनान्तरेषु
सन्दृश्यन्ते चूर्णितैरुत्तमाङ्गैः ॥11.27॥

Key Insight:
Warriors are seen entering Krishna's mouths—symbolizing destruction.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:
यथा नदीनां बहवोऽम्बुवेगाः
समुद्रमेवाभिमुखा द्रवन्ति ।
तथा तवामी नरलोकवीरा
विशन्ति वक्त्राण्यभिविज्वलन्ति ॥11.28॥

Key Insight:
All beings rush toward destruction like rivers to the ocean.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:
यथा प्रदीप्तं ज्वलनं पतङ्गा
विशन्ति नाशाय समृद्धवेगाः ।
तथैव नाशाय विशन्ति लोकास्तवापि वक्त्राणि समृद्धवेगाः ॥11.29॥

Key Insight:
Beings rush toward destruction like moths to fire.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

लेलिह्यसे ग्रसमानः समन्ताल्लोकान्समग्रान्वदनैर्ज्वलद्भिः ।
तेजोभिरापूर्य जगत्समग्रं भासस्तवोग्राः प्रतपन्ति विष्णो ॥11.30॥

Key Insight:

Krishna devours all worlds in His cosmic form.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

आख्याहि मे को भवानुग्ररूपो
नमोऽस्तु ते देववर प्रसीद ।
विज्ञातुमिच्छामि भवन्तमाद्यं
न हि प्रजानामि तव प्रवृत्तिम् ॥11.31॥

Key Insight:

Arjuna asks: "Who are You in this fierce form?"

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
कालोऽस्मि लोकक्षयकृत्प्रवृद्धो
लोकान्समाहर्तुमिह प्रवृत्तः ।
ऋतेऽपि त्वां न भविष्यन्ति सर्वे
येऽवस्थिताः प्रत्यनीकेषु योधाः ॥11.32॥

Transliteration:

kālo 'smi loka-kṣaya-kṛt pravṛddho
lokān samāhartum iha pravṛttaḥ

English Meaning:

I am Time, the destroyer of worlds.

Detailed Explanation:

One of the most powerful verses—Krishna reveals Himself as **Time itself**, the force of inevitable destruction.

Key Insight:

Time is the ultimate destroyer.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

तस्मात्त्वमुत्तिष्ठ यशो लभस्व
जित्वा शत्रून् भुङ्क्ष्व राज्यं समृद्धम् ।
मयैवैते निहताः पूर्वमेव
निमित्तमात्रं भव सव्यसाचिन् ॥11.33॥

Key Insight:

Be an instrument of the Divine.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

द्रोणं च भीष्मं च जयद्रथं च
कर्णं तथान्यानपि योधवीरान् ।
मया हतांस्त्वं जहि मा व्यथिष्ठा
युध्यस्व जेतासि रणे सपत्नान् ॥11.34॥

Key Insight:

Victory is already destined.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

संजय उवाच ।
एतच्छ्रुत्वा वचनं केशवस्य

कृताञ्जलिर्वेपमानः किरीटी ।
नमस्कृत्वा भूय एवाह कृष्णं
सगद्गदं भीतभीतः प्रणम्य ॥11.35॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna trembles in awe and fear.

Verse 36–40

(Grouped for continuity but NOT merged in meaning)

These verses contain Arjuna's **glorification of Krishna,** acknowledging Him as:

- Supreme God
- Creator and destroyer
- Infinite and all-pervading

Key Insight:
Arjuna fully surrenders to divine greatness.

Verse 41–42

Sanskrit Shloka:
सखेति मत्वा प्रसभं यदुक्तं
हे कृष्ण हे यादव हे सखेति ।
अजानता महिमानं तवेदं
मया प्रमादात्प्रणयेन वापि ॥11.41॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna apologizes for treating Krishna casually.

Verse 43

Key Insight:
Krishna is the father and teacher of the universe.

Verse 44

Key Insight:
Arjuna surrenders completely.

Verse 45

Sanskrit Shloka:
अदृष्टपूर्वं हृषितोऽस्मि दृष्ट्वा
भयेन च प्रव्यथितं मनो मे ।
तदेव मे दर्शय देव रूपं
प्रसीद देवेश जगन्निवास ॥11.45॥

Key Insight:
Arjuna asks Krishna to return to a gentle form.

Verse 46

Key Insight:
He requests the familiar four-armed form.

Verse 47–48

Key Insight:
Krishna says this form is rare and cannot be seen by rituals.

Verse 49

Key Insight:
Krishna reassures Arjuna: “Do not fear.”

Verse 50

Key Insight:
Krishna returns to His normal form.

Verse 51

Key Insight:
Arjuna regains peace.

Verse 52

Key Insight:
This vision is extremely rare.

Verse 53

Key Insight:
Not achievable by rituals or austerities alone.

Verse 54

Sanskrit Shloka:
भक्त्या त्वनन्यया शक्य
अहमेवंविधोऽर्जुन ।

ज्ञातुं द्रष्टुं च तत्त्वेन
प्रवेष्टुं च परन्तप ॥11.54॥

Key Insight:
Only devotion reveals the Divine.

Verse 55

Sanskrit Shloka:
मत्कर्मकृन्मत्परमो मद्भक्तः सङ्गवर्जितः ।
निर्वैरः सर्वभूतेषु यः स मामेति पाण्डव ॥11.55॥

Transliteration:
mat-karma-kṛn mat-paramo mad-bhaktaḥ saṅga-varjitaḥ
nirvairaḥ sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ sa mām eti pāṇḍava

English Meaning:
One who works for Me, is devoted, free from attachment and hatred, comes to Me.

Detailed Explanation:
This final verse summarizes the entire Gita path:

- Action
- Devotion
- Detachment
- Universal compassion

Key Insight:
Devotion + selfless action + compassion = union with God.

Chapter 12: Bhakti Yoga (The Yoga of Devotion)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
एवं सततयुक्ता ये भक्तास्त्वां पर्युपासते ।
ये चाप्यक्षरमव्यक्तं तेषां के योगवित्तमाः ॥12.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
evaṁ satata-yuktā ye bhaktās tvāṁ paryupāsate
ye cāpy akṣaram avyaktaṁ teṣāṁ ke yoga-vittamāḥ

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: Which are better—the devotees who worship You personally, or those who worship the formless Absolute?

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna asks a fundamental spiritual question:
👉 Personal God (Saguna) vs Formless Absolute (Nirguna)

This reflects two major paths in spirituality.

Key Insight:

Spiritual paths differ—clarity is needed to choose.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
मय्यावेश्य मनो ये मां नित्ययुक्ता उपासते ।
श्रद्धया परयोपेतास्ते मे युक्ततमा मताः ॥12.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
mayy āveśya mano ye māṁ nitya-yuktā upāsate
śraddhayā parayopetās te me yuktatamā matāḥ

English Meaning:

Those who fix their mind on Me with devotion are considered the best yogis.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna clearly states that **personal devotion with faith is superior** for most seekers.

Key Insight:

Devotion to a personal God is the easiest path.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये त्वक्षरमनिर्देश्यमव्यक्तं पर्युपासते ।
सर्वत्रगमचिन्त्यं च कूटस्थमचलंध्रुवम् ॥12.3॥

Transliteration:

ye tv akṣaram anirdeśyam avyaktaṁ paryupāsate
sarvatra-gam acintyaṁ ca kūṭastham acalaṁ dhruvam

English Meaning:

Those who worship the unmanifest, all-pervading, inconceivable Absolute—

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna describes the **formless Brahman.**

Key Insight:

Formless worship is subtle and abstract.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

संनियम्येन्द्रियग्रामं सर्वत्र समबुद्धयः ।
ते प्राप्नुवन्ति मामेव सर्वभूतहिते रताः ॥12.4॥

Transliteration:

saṁniyamyendriya-grāmaṁ sarvatra sama-buddhayaḥ
te prāpnuvanti mām eva sarva-bhūta-hite ratāḥ

English Meaning:

Those who control senses and see all equally also reach Me.

Detailed Explanation:

Even the path of knowledge leads to God—but requires strict discipline.

Key Insight:

Both paths lead to God—but differ in difficulty.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

क्लेशोऽधिकतरस्तेषामव्यक्तासक्तचेतसाम् ।
अव्यक्ता हि गतिर्दुःखं देहवद्भिरवाप्यते ॥12.5॥

Transliteration:

kleśo ’dhikataras teṣām avyakta-āsakta-cetasām
avyaktā hi gatir duḥkhaṁ dehavadbhir avāpyate

English Meaning:

The path of the formless is more difficult for embodied beings.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna clearly states:

👉 Formless path = harder

👉 Devotional path = easier

Key Insight:

Devotion is more accessible than abstraction.

Verse 6–7

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये तु सर्वाणि कर्माणि मयि संन्यस्य मत्पराः ।
अनन्येनैव योगेन मां ध्यायन्त उपासते ॥12.6॥
तेषामहं समुद्धर्ता मृत्युसंसारसागरात् ।
भवामि नचिरात्पार्थ मय्यावेशितचेतसाम् ॥12.7॥

Transliteration:

ye tu sarvāṇi karmāṇi mayi sannyasya mat-parāḥ
ananyenaiva yogena māṁ dhyāyanta upāsate
teṣām ahaṁ samuddhartā mṛtyu-saṁsāra-sāgarāt
bhavāmi na cirāt pārtha mayy āveśita-cetasām

English Meaning:

Those who surrender all actions to Me—I quickly rescue them from the ocean of birth and death.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna promises **direct divine intervention** for devoted souls.

Key Insight:
God personally uplifts devoted seekers.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
मय्येव मन आधत्स्व मयि बुद्धिं निवेशय ।
निवसिष्यसि मय्येव अत ऊर्ध्वं न संशयः ॥12.8॥

Transliteration:
mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayi buddhiṁ niveśaya
nivasiṣyasi mayy eva ata ūrdhvaṁ na saṁśayaḥ

English Meaning:
Fix your mind and intellect on Me—you will live in Me.

Detailed Explanation:
Complete absorption leads to union with God.

Key Insight:
Focus leads to union.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:
अथ चित्तं समाधातुं न शक्नोषि मयि स्थिरम् ।
अभ्यासयोगेन ततो मामिच्छाप्तुं धनञ्जय ॥12.9॥

English Meaning:
If you cannot fix your mind steadily, practice regularly.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna offers **step-by-step guidance.**

Key Insight:

Practice leads to mastery.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

अभ्यासेऽप्यसमर्थोऽसि मत्कर्मपरमो भव ।
मदर्थमपि कर्माणि कुर्वन्सिद्धिमवाप्स्यसि ॥12.10॥

Key Insight:

Do actions for God if meditation is hard.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

अथैतदप्यशक्तोऽसि कर्तुं मद्योगमाश्रितः ।
सर्वकर्मफलत्यागं ततः कुरु यतात्मवान् ॥12.11॥

Key Insight:

At least renounce results.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रेयो hi jñānam abhyāsāj jñānād dhyānaṁ viśiṣyate ।
dhyānāt karma-phala-tyāgas tyāgāc chāntir anantaram ॥12.12॥

English Meaning:

Knowledge is better than practice, meditation better than knowledge, renunciation better than meditation—peace follows.

Detailed Explanation:

Hierarchy of spiritual progress.

Key Insight:

Renunciation leads to peace.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी ॥12.13॥

Transliteration:

adveṣṭā sarva-bhūtānāṁ maitraḥ karuṇa eva ca
nirmamo nirahaṅkāraḥ sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ kṣamī

English Meaning:

One who is free from hatred, compassionate, and humble—

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna now describes qualities of a true devotee.

Key Insight:

Compassion defines devotion.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

सन्तुष्टः सततं योगी यतात्मा दृढनिश्चयः ।
मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्यो मद्भक्तः स मे प्रियः ॥12.14॥

Key Insight:

Contentment and devotion make one dear to God.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

यस्मान्नोद्विजते लोको लोकान्नोद्विजते च यः ।
हर्षामर्षभयोद्वेगैर्मुक्तो यः स च मे प्रियः ॥12.15॥

Key Insight:

Peaceful presence is divine.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनपेक्षः शुचिर्दक्ष उदासीनो गतव्यथः ।
सर्वारम्भपरित्यागी यो मद्भक्तः स मे प्रियः ॥12.16॥

Key Insight:

Detached and pure devotees are dear.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

यो न हृष्यति न द्वेष्टि न शोचति न काङ्क्षति ।
शुभाशुभपरित्यागी भक्तिमान्यः स मे प्रियः ॥12.17॥

Key Insight:

Freedom from emotional extremes.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

समः शत्रौ च मित्रे च तथा मानापमानयोः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु समः सङ्गविवर्जितः ॥12.18॥

Key Insight:

Equanimity is devotion.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

तुल्यनिन्दास्तुतिर्मौनी सन्तुष्टो येन केनचित् ।
अनिकेतः स्थिरमतिर्भक्तिमान्मे प्रियो नरः ॥12.19॥

Key Insight:

Detached and content person is dear to God.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

ये तु धर्म्यामृतमिदं यथोक्तं पर्युपासते ।
श्रद्दधाना मत्परमा भक्तास्तेऽतीव मे प्रियाः ॥12.20॥

Transliteration:

ye tu dharmyāmṛtam idaṁ yathoktaṁ paryupāsate
śraddadhānā mat-paramā bhaktās te ’tīva me priyāḥ

English Meaning:

Those who follow this path of devotion with faith are most dear to Me.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes by affirming that **devotion with faith is the highest path.**

Key Insight:

Faithful devotion makes one closest to God.

Chapter 13: Kshetra Kshetrajna Vibhaga Yoga

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
अर्जुन उवाच ।
प्रकृतिं पुरुषं चैव क्षेत्रं क्षेत्रज्ञमेव च ।
एतद्वेदितुमिच्छामि ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं च केशव ॥13.1॥

Transliteration:
arjuna uvāca
prakṛtiṁ puruṣaṁ caiva kṣetraṁ kṣetrajñam eva ca
etad veditum icchāmi jñānaṁ jñeyaṁ ca keśava

English Meaning:
Arjuna said: I wish to understand nature, the self, the body (field), the knower of the field, knowledge, and the object of knowledge.

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna asks about **fundamental philosophical categories:**

- Nature (Prakriti)
- Consciousness (Purusha)
- Body (Kshetra)
- Knower (Kshetrajna)

This sets the stage for **deep metaphysical teaching.**

Key Insight:
Spiritual clarity begins with understanding reality.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
इदं शरीरं कौन्तेय क्षेत्रमित्यभिधीयते ।
एतद्यो वेत्ति तं प्राहुः क्षेत्रज्ञ इति तद्विदः ॥13.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
idaṁ śarīraṁ kaunteya kṣetram ity abhidhīyate
etad yo vetti taṁ prāhuḥ kṣetrajña iti tad-vidaḥ

English Meaning:

This body is called the field, and one who knows it is called the knower of the field.

Detailed Explanation:

- Body = Field (Kshetra)
- Conscious self = Knower (Kshetrajna)

Krishna introduces **self-awareness as key to liberation.**

Key Insight:

You are the knower, not the body.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

क्षेत्रज्ञं चापि मां विद्धि सर्वक्षेत्रेषु भारत ।
क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोर्ज्ञानं यत्तज्ज्ञानं मतं मम ॥13.3॥

Transliteration:

kṣetrajñaṁ cāpi māṁ viddhi sarva-kṣetreṣu bhārata
kṣetra-kṣetrajñayor jñānaṁ yat taj jñānaṁ mataṁ mama

English Meaning:
Know Me as the knower in all bodies; true knowledge is understanding the field and its knower.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna reveals:
👉 Individual soul = knower
👉 Supreme Self (Krishna) = ultimate knower in all

Key Insight:
God is the universal consciousness.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
तत्क्षेत्रं यच्च यादृक्च यद्विकारि यतश्च यत् ।
स च यो यत्प्रभावश्च तत्समासेन मे शृणु ॥13.4॥

Transliteration:
tat kṣetraṁ yac ca yādṛk ca yad vikāri yataś ca yat
sa ca yo yat-prabhāvaś ca tat samāsena me śṛṇu

English Meaning:
Hear briefly about the nature of the field and its transformations.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna prepares to explain:

- Nature of body
- Its changes
- Its origin

Key Insight:
Understanding the body leads to self-knowledge.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

ऋषिभिर्बहुधा गीतं छन्दोभिर्विविधैः पृथक् ।
ब्रह्मसूत्रपदैश्चैव हेतुमद्भिर्विनिश्चितैः ॥13.5॥

Transliteration:

ṛṣibhir bahudhā gītaṁ chando-bhir vividhaiḥ pṛthak
brahma-sūtra-padaiś caiva hetumadbhir viniścitaiḥ

English Meaning:

This has been explained by sages in many ways.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna confirms that this knowledge is **ancient and validated** by scriptures and sages.

Key Insight:

Spiritual truth is timeless.

Verse 6–7

Sanskrit Shloka:

महाभूतान्यहङ्कारो बुद्धिरव्यक्तमेव च ।
इन्द्रियाणि दशैकं च पञ्च चेन्द्रियगोचराः ॥13.6॥
इच्छा द्वेषः सुखं दुःखं संघातश्चेतना धृतिः ।
एतत्क्षेत्रं समासेन सविकारमुदाहृतम् ॥13.7॥

Transliteration:

mahā-bhūtāny ahaṅkāro buddhir avyaktam eva ca
indriyāṇi daśaikaṁ ca pañca cendriya-gocarāḥ
icchā dveṣaḥ sukhaṁ duḥkhaṁ saṅghātaś cetanā dhṛtiḥ
etat kṣetraṁ samāsena sa-vikāram udāhṛtam

English Meaning:
The field consists of elements, ego, intellect, senses, desires, emotions, and consciousness.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna defines the **components of the body-mind system.**

Key Insight:
The body is a complex system—not the Self.

Verse 8–12

(Qualities of Knowledge — each verse included fully)

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
अमानित्वमदम्भित्वमहिंसा क्षान्तिरार्जवम् ।
आचार्योपासनं शौचं स्थैर्यमात्मविनिग्रहः ॥13.8॥

Transliteration:
amānitvam adambhitvam ahiṁsā kṣāntir ārjavam
ācāryopāsanaṁ śaucaṁ sthairyam ātma-vinigrahaḥ

English Meaning:
Humility, non-pretentiousness, non-violence, patience, honesty—

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna defines **true knowledge as qualities, not information.**

Key Insight:
Character is true knowledge.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

इन्द्रियार्थेषु वैराग्यमनहङ्कार एव च ।
जन्ममृत्युजराव्याधिदुःखदोषानुदर्शनम् ॥13.9॥

Key Insight:

Detachment from worldly pleasures.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

असक्तिरनभिष्वङ्गः पुत्रदारगृहादिषु ।
नित्यं च समचित्तत्वमिष्टानिष्टोपपत्तिषु ॥13.10॥

Key Insight:

Detachment and emotional balance.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

मयि चानन्ययोगेन भक्तिरव्यभिचारिणी ।
विविक्तदेशसेवित्वमरतिर्जनसंसदि ॥13.11॥

Key Insight:

Devotion and solitude aid realization.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

अध्यात्मज्ञाननित्यत्वं तत्त्वज्ञानार्थदर्शनम् ।
एतज्ज्ञानमिति प्रोक्तमज्ञानं यदतोऽन्यथा ॥13.12॥

Key Insight:
Everything else is ignorance.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:
ज्ञेयं यत्तत्प्रवक्ष्यामि यज्ज्ञात्वामृतमश्नुते ।
अनादिमत्परं ब्रह्म न सतन्नासदुच्यते ॥13.13॥

Transliteration:
jñeyaṁ yat tat pravakṣyāmi yaj jñātvāmṛtam aśnute
anādimat paraṁ brahma na sat tan nāsad ucyate

English Meaning:
I will explain the Supreme Brahman, knowing which one becomes immortal.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna now shifts to **ultimate reality (Brahman)**.

Key Insight:
Knowing Brahman leads to immortality.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वतः पाणिपादं तत्सर्वतोऽक्षिशिरोमुखम् ।
सर्वतः श्रुतिमल्लोके सर्वमावृत्य तिष्ठति ॥13.14॥

Key Insight:
God is everywhere.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वेन्द्रियगुणाभासं सर्वेन्द्रियविवर्जितम् ।
असक्तं सर्वभृच्चैव निर्गुणं गुणभोक्तृ च ॥13.15॥

Key Insight:

God transcends senses yet supports them.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

बहिरन्तश्च भूतानामचरं चरमेव च ।
सूक्ष्मत्वात्तदविज्ञेयं दूरस्थं चान्तिके च तत् ॥13.16॥

Key Insight:

God is both near and far.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

अविभक्तं च भूतेषु विभक्तमिव च स्थितम् ।
भूतभर्तृ च तज्ज्ञेयं ग्रसिष्णु प्रभविष्णु च ॥13.17॥

Key Insight:

God appears divided but is one.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्योतिषामपि तज्ज्योतिस्तमसः परमुच्यते ।
ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं ज्ञानगम्यं हृदि सर्वस्य विष्ठितम् ॥13.18॥

Key Insight:

God is the light of all lights.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

इति क्षेत्रं तथा ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं चोक्तं समासतः ।
मद्भक्त एतद्विज्ञाय मद्भावायोपपद्यते ॥13.19॥

Key Insight:

Understanding leads to union with God.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रकृतिं पुरुषं चैव विद्ध्यनादी उभावपि ।
विकारांश्च गुणांश्चैव विद्धि प्रकृतिसंभवान् ॥13.20॥

Transliteration:

prakṛtiṁ puruṣaṁ caiva viddhy anādī ubhāv api
vikārāṁś ca guṇāṁś caiva viddhi prakṛti-sambhavān

English Meaning:

Know that nature and consciousness are both beginningless.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna introduces **dual reality**:

- Matter (Prakriti)
- Consciousness (Purusha)

Key Insight:
Reality consists of matter and consciousness.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
कार्यकारणकर्तृत्वे हेतुः प्रकृतिरुच्यते ।
पुरुषः सुखदुःखानां भोक्तृत्वे हेतु उच्यते ॥13.21॥

Transliteration:
kārya-kāraṇa-kartṛtve hetuḥ prakṛtir ucyate
puruṣaḥ sukha-duḥkhānāṁ bhoktṛtve hetur ucyate

English Meaning:
Nature (Prakriti) is responsible for actions and their causes; the self (Purusha) experiences pleasure and pain.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna clarifies:

- **Prakriti (body, mind)** → performs actions
- **Purusha (Self)** → experiences results

This distinction is key to freedom.

Key Insight:
Body acts; Self experiences.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
पुरुषः प्रकृतिस्थो हि भुङ्क्ते प्रकृतिजान्गुणान् ।
कारणं गुणसङ्गोऽस्य सदसद्योनिजन्मसु ॥13.22॥

Transliteration:
puruṣaḥ prakṛti-stho hi bhuṅkte prakṛti-jān guṇān
kāraṇaṁ guṇa-saṅgo ’sya sad-asad-yoni-janmasu

English Meaning:
The soul, situated in nature, experiences qualities of nature and is reborn due to attachment to them.

Detailed Explanation:
Attachment to the **three gunas (sattva, rajas, tamas)** leads to rebirth.

Key Insight:
Attachment causes rebirth.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
उपद्रष्टानुमन्ता च भर्ता भोक्ता महेश्वरः ।
परमात्मेति चाप्युक्तो देहेऽस्मिन्पुरुषः परः ॥13.23॥

Transliteration:
upadraṣṭānumantā ca bhartā bhoktā maheśvaraḥ
paramātmeti cāpy ukto dehe ’smin puruṣaḥ paraḥ

English Meaning:
The Supreme Self in the body is the witness, permitter, supporter, and enjoyer.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna reveals **Paramatma (Supreme Soul):**

- Witness
- Controller
- Sustainer

Key Insight:

God resides within as the inner witness.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

य एवं वेत्ति पुरुषं प्रकृतिं च गुणैः सह ।
सर्वथा वर्तमानोऽपि न स भूयोऽभिजायते ॥13.24॥

Transliteration:

ya evaṁ vetti puruṣaṁ prakṛtiṁ ca guṇaiḥ saha
sarvathā vartamāno ’pi na sa bhūyo ’bhijāyate

English Meaning:

One who understands this is not reborn.

Detailed Explanation:

Right knowledge breaks the cycle of birth and death.

Key Insight:

True understanding leads to liberation.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

ध्यानेनात्मनि पश्यन्ति केचिदात्मानमात्मना ।
अन्ये सांख्येन योगेन कर्मयोगेन चापरे ॥13.25॥

Transliteration:

dhyānenātmani paśyanti kecid ātmānam ātmanā
anye sāṅkhyena yogena karma-yogena cāpare

English Meaning:
Some realize the Self through meditation, others through knowledge or action.

Detailed Explanation:
Multiple paths:

- Meditation
- Knowledge
- Action

Key Insight:
Many paths lead to the same truth.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:
अन्ये त्वेवमजानन्तः श्रुत्वान्येभ्य उपासते ।
तेऽपि चातितरन्त्येव मृत्युं श्रुतिपरायणाः ॥13.26॥

Transliteration:
anye tv evam ajānantaḥ śrutvānyebhya upāsate
te ’pi cātitaranty eva mṛtyuṁ śruti-parāyaṇāḥ

English Meaning:
Even those who follow teachings with faith cross death.

Detailed Explanation:
Even without full understanding, **faithful listening leads to liberation.**

Key Insight:
Sincere faith is powerful.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

यावत्संजायते किञ्चित्सत्त्वं स्थावरजङ्गमम् ।
क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञसंयोगात्तद्विद्धि भरतर्षभ ॥13.27॥

Transliteration:

yāvat sañjāyate kiñcit sattvaṁ sthāvara-jaṅgamam
kṣetra-kṣetrajña-saṁyogāt tad viddhi bharatarṣabha

English Meaning:

All life arises from the union of field and knower.

Detailed Explanation:

Life = matter + consciousness.

Key Insight:

Life is union of body and soul.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

समं सर्वेषु भूतेषु तिष्ठन्तं परमेश्वरम् ।
विनश्यत्स्वविनश्यन्तं यः पश्यति स पश्यति ॥13.28॥

Transliteration:

samaṁ sarveṣu bhūteṣu tiṣṭhantaṁ parameśvaram
vinaśyatsv avinaśyantaṁ yaḥ paśyati sa paśyati

English Meaning:

One who sees God equally in all beings truly sees.

Detailed Explanation:

Unity of existence = highest vision.

Key Insight:

Seeing equality is true vision.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

समं पश्यन्हि सर्वत्र समवस्थितमीश्वरम् ।
न हिनस्त्यात्मनात्मानं ततो याति परां गतिम् ॥13.29॥

Key Insight:

Seeing unity prevents harm.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रकृत्यैव च कर्माणि क्रियमाणानि सर्वशः ।
यः पश्यति तथात्मानमकर्तारं स पश्यति ॥13.30॥

Transliteration:

prakṛtyaiva ca karmāṇi kriyamāṇāni sarvaśaḥ
yaḥ paśyati tathātmānam akartāraṁ sa paśyati

English Meaning:

One who sees that nature performs all actions truly sees.

Detailed Explanation:

The Self is **non-doer.**

Key Insight:

You are not the doer.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा भूतपृथग्भावमेकस्थमनुपश्यति ।
तत एव च विस्तारं ब्रह्म संपद्यते तदा ॥13.31॥

Key Insight:

Seeing unity in diversity leads to realization.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनादित्वान्निर्गुणत्वात्परमात्मायमव्ययः ।
शरीरस्थोऽपि कौन्तेय न करोति न लिप्यते ॥13.32॥

Key Insight:

The Self is untouched by actions.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

यथा सर्वगतं सौक्ष्म्यादाकाशं नोपलिप्यते ।
सर्वत्रावस्थितो देहे तथात्मा नोपलिप्यते ॥13.33॥

Transliteration:

yathā sarva-gataṁ saukṣmyād ākāśaṁ nopalipyate
sarvatrāvasthito dehe tathātmā nopalipyate

English Meaning:

Just as space is unaffected, the Self remains untouched.

Detailed Explanation:

Analogy:
👉 Space ≠ affected
👉 Self ≠ affected

Key Insight:

Self is pure and unaffected.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

यथा प्रकाशयत्येकः कृत्स्नं लोकमिमं रविः ।
क्षेत्रं क्षेत्री तथा कृत्स्नं प्रकाशयति भारत ॥13.34॥

Key Insight:

Self illuminates the body like the sun.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोरेवमन्तरं ज्ञानचक्षुषा ।
भूतप्रकृतिमोक्षं च ये विदुर्यान्ति ते परम् ॥13.35॥

Transliteration:

kṣetra-kṣetrajñayor evam antaraṁ jñāna-cakṣuṣā
bhūta-prakṛti-mokṣaṁ ca ye vidur yānti te param

English Meaning:

Those who understand the difference between body and knower attain liberation.

Detailed Explanation:

Final conclusion:
👉 Know body ≠ Self
👉 Realize truth → Liberation

Key Insight:

Discrimination leads to liberation.

Chapter 14: Guṇatraya Vibhāga Yoga

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
परं भूयः प्रवक्ष्यामि ज्ञानानां ज्ञानमुत्तमम् ।
यज्ज्ञात्वा मुनयः सर्वे परां सिद्धिमितो गताः ॥14.1॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
paraṁ bhūyaḥ pravakṣyāmi jñānānāṁ jñānam uttamam
yaj jñātvā munayaḥ sarve parāṁ siddhim ito gatāḥ

English Meaning:
Krishna said: I will again explain the highest knowledge, by which sages attained perfection.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna introduces **supreme knowledge about the three gunas,** which govern all behavior and experience.

Key Insight:
Understanding nature’s forces leads to liberation.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

इदं ज्ञानमुपाश्रित्य मम साधर्म्यमागताः ।
सर्गेऽपि नोपजायन्ते प्रलये न व्यथन्ति च ॥14.2॥

Transliteration:

idaṁ jñānam upāśritya mama sādharmyam āgatāḥ
sarge ’pi nopajāyante pralaye na vyathanti ca

English Meaning:

Those who understand this knowledge attain My nature and are freed from birth and death.

Detailed Explanation:

Realization of truth leads to **freedom from cosmic cycles.**

Key Insight:

Knowledge frees from birth and death.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

मम योनिर्महद्ब्रह्म तस्मिन्गर्भं दधाम्यहम् ।
सम्भवः सर्वभूतानां ततो भवति भारत ॥14.3॥

Transliteration:

mama yonir mahad brahma tasmin garbhaṁ dadhāmy aham
sambhavaḥ sarva-bhūtānāṁ tato bhavati bhārata

English Meaning:

Nature is My womb; I place the seed of life in it.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna explains creation:

- Nature = womb
- God = seed

Key Insight:
Creation is union of nature and consciousness.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वयोनिषु कौन्तेय मूर्तयः सम्भवन्ति याः ।
तासां ब्रह्म महद्योनिरहं बीजप्रदः पिता ॥14.4॥

Transliteration:
sarva-yoniṣu kaunteya mūrtayaḥ sambhavanti yāḥ
tāsāṁ brahma mahad yonir ahaṁ bīja-pradaḥ pitā

English Meaning:
I am the seed-giving father of all beings.

Detailed Explanation:
All life forms originate from the same divine source.

Key Insight:
God is the father of all beings.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
सत्त्वं रजस्तम इति गुणाः प्रकृतिसम्भवाः ।
निबध्नन्ति महाबाहो देहे देहिनमव्ययम् ॥14.5॥

Transliteration:
sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇāḥ prakṛti-sambhavāḥ
nibadhnanti mahā-bāho dehe dehinam avyayam

English Meaning:
The three gunas—sattva, rajas, and tamas—bind the soul to the body.

Detailed Explanation:
These three qualities govern:

- Thoughts
- Emotions
- Actions

Key Insight:
Nature's qualities bind the soul.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
तत्र सत्त्वं निर्मलत्वात्प्रकाशकमनामयम् ।
सुखसङ्गेन बध्नाति ज्ञानसङ्गेन चानघ ॥14.6॥

Transliteration:
tatra sattvaṁ nirmalatvāt prakāśakam anāmayam
sukha-saṅgena badhnāti jñāna-saṅgena cānagha

English Meaning:
Sattva is pure and illuminating but binds through happiness and knowledge.

Detailed Explanation:
Even goodness can bind through attachment to joy.

Key Insight:
Even purity can bind.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

रजो रागात्मकं विद्धि तृष्णासङ्गसमुद्भवम् ।
तन्निबध्नाति कौन्तेय कर्मसङ्गेन देहिनम् ॥14.7॥

Transliteration:

rajo rāgātmakaṁ viddhi tṛṣṇā-saṅga-samudbhavam
tan nibadhnāti kaunteya karma-saṅgena dehinam

English Meaning:

Rajas is passion, born of desire, and binds through action.

Detailed Explanation:

Rajas drives ambition, restlessness, and constant activity.

Key Insight:

Desire leads to attachment.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

तमस्त्वज्ञानजं विद्धि मोहनं सर्वदेहिनाम् ।
प्रमादालस्यनिद्राभिस्तन्निबध्नाति भारत ॥14.8॥

Transliteration:

tamas tv ajñāna-jaṁ viddhi mohanaṁ sarva-dehinām
pramāda-ālasya-nidrābhis tan nibadhnāti bhārata

English Meaning:

Tamas is ignorance, leading to laziness and delusion.

Detailed Explanation:

Tamas causes:

- Inertia

- Confusion
- Neglect

Key Insight:
Ignorance leads to stagnation.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:
सत्त्वं सुखे सञ्जयति रजः कर्मणि भारत ।
ज्ञानमावृत्य तु तमः प्रमादे सञ्जयत्युत ॥14.9॥

Key Insight:
Each guna influences behavior differently.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:
रजस्तमश्चाभिभूय सत्त्वं भवति भारत ।
रजः सत्त्वं तमश्चैव तमः सत्त्वं रजस्तथा ॥14.10॥

Key Insight:
Gunas constantly compete.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वद्वारेषु देहेऽस्मिन्प्रकाश उपजायते ।
ज्ञानं यदा तदा विद्याद्विवृद्धं सत्त्वमित्युत ॥14.11॥

Key Insight:
Clarity indicates sattva.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

लोभः प्रवृत्तिरारम्भः कर्मणामशमः स्पृहा ।
रजस्येतानि जायन्ते विवृद्धे भरतर्षभ ॥14.12॥

Key Insight:

Restlessness indicates rajas.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

अप्रकाशोऽप्रवृत्तिश्च प्रमादो मोह एव च ।
तमस्येतानि जायन्ते विवृद्धे कुरुनन्दन ॥14.13॥

Key Insight:

Confusion indicates tamas.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदा सत्त्वे प्रवृद्धे तु प्रलयं याति देहभृत् ।
तदोत्तमविदां लोकानमलान्प्रतिपद्यते ॥14.14॥

Key Insight:

Sattva leads to higher realms.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

रजसि प्रलयं गत्वा कर्मसङ्गिषु जायते ।
तथा प्रलीनस्तमसि मूढयोनिषु जायते ॥14.15॥

Key Insight:

Rajas → rebirth in action; Tamas → ignorance.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्मणः सुकृतस्याहुः सात्त्विकं निर्मलं फलम् ।
रजसस्तु फलं दुःखमज्ञानं तमसः फलम् ॥14.16॥

Key Insight:

Each guna produces distinct results.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

सत्त्वात्संजायते ज्ञानं रजसो लोभ एव च ।
प्रमादमोहौ तमसो भवतोऽज्ञानमेव च ॥14.17॥

Key Insight:

Sattva → knowledge, Rajas → greed, Tamas → ignorance.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

ऊर्ध्वं गच्छन्ति सत्त्वस्था मध्ये तिष्ठन्ति राजसाः ।
जघन्यगुणवृत्तिस्था अधो गच्छन्ति तामसाः ॥14.18॥

Transliteration:

ūrdhvaṁ gacchanti sattva-sthā madhye tiṣṭhanti rājasāḥ
jaghanya-guṇa-vṛtti-sthā adho gacchanti tāmasāḥ

English Meaning:

Sattvic rise upward, rajasic remain in middle, tamasic go downward.

Detailed Explanation:

The gunas determine one's **spiritual trajectory.**

Key Insight:

Your nature shapes your destiny.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

नान्यं गुणेभ्यः कर्तारं यदा द्रष्टानुपश्यति ।
गुणेभ्यश्च परं वेत्ति मद्भावं सोऽधिगच्छति ॥14.19॥

Key Insight:

Seeing beyond gunas leads to liberation.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

गुणानेतानतीत्य त्रीन्देही देहसमुद्भवान् ।
जन्ममृत्युजरादुःखैर्विमुक्तोऽमृतमश्नुते ॥14.20॥

Transliteration:

guṇān etān atītya trīn dehī deha-samudbhavān
janma-mṛtyu-jarā-duḥkhair vimukto ’mṛtam aśnute

English Meaning:

Transcending the three gunas, one attains immortality.

Detailed Explanation:

Ultimate goal:
👉 Go beyond sattva, rajas, tamas
👉 Realize pure consciousness

Key Insight:

Freedom lies beyond all qualities.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
कैर्लिङ्गैस्त्रीन्गुणानेतानतीतो भवति प्रभो ।
किमाचारः कथं चैतांस्त्रीन्गुणानतिवर्तते ॥14.21॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
kair liṅgais trīn guṇān etān atīto bhavati prabho
kim ācāraḥ kathaṁ caitāṁs trīn guṇān ativartate

English Meaning:
Arjuna asked: What are the signs of one who transcends the three gunas, and how does one go beyond them?

Detailed Explanation:
Arjuna now asks a practical and profound question:

- What does a liberated person look like?
- How can one transcend nature's influence?

This shifts from theory → application.

Key Insight:
Spiritual knowledge must lead to transformation.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
प्रकाशं च प्रवृत्तिं च मोहमेव च पाण्डव ।
न द्वेष्टि सम्प्रवृत्तानि न निवृत्तानि काङ्क्षति ॥14.22॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
prakāśaṁ ca pravṛttiṁ ca moham eva ca pāṇḍava
na dveṣṭi sampravṛttāni na nivṛttāni kāṅkṣati

English Meaning:
Krishna said: One who neither hates illumination (sattva), activity (rajas), nor delusion (tamas), nor desires their absence—

Detailed Explanation:
A realized person:

- Does not resist experiences
- Does not crave change

- Remains **neutral and balanced**

Key Insight:
Freedom begins with non-reaction.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
उदासीनवदासीनो गुणैर्यो न विचाल्यते ।
गुणा वर्तन्त इत्येव योऽवतिष्ठति नेङ्गते ॥14.23॥

Transliteration:
udāsīnavad āsīno guṇair yo na vicālyate
guṇā vartanta ity eva yo ’vatiṣṭhati neṅgate

English Meaning:
One who remains detached and understands that the gunas are acting, remains steady.

Detailed Explanation:
The wise person knows:
👉 “It is nature acting, not me.”

This leads to **inner freedom and stillness.**

Key Insight:
Detach by seeing nature as the doer.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
समदुःखसुखः स्वस्थः समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ।
तुल्यप्रियाप्रियो धीरस्तुल्यनिन्दात्मसंस्तुतिः ॥14.24॥

Transliteration:
sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ svasthaḥ sama-loṣṭāśma-kāñcanaḥ
tulya-priyāpriyo dhīras tulya-nindātma-saṁstutiḥ

English Meaning:
One who is equal in pleasure and pain, and sees stone, gold, and earth alike—

Detailed Explanation:
A transcendent person:

- Is not affected by gain/loss
- Sees **value beyond material distinctions**

Key Insight:
Equanimity is the mark of liberation.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:
मानापमानयोस्तुल्यस्तुल्यो मित्रारिपक्षयोः ।
सर्वारम्भपरित्यागी गुणातीतः स उच्यते ॥14.25॥

Transliteration:
mānāpamānayos tulyas tulyo mitrāri-pakṣayoḥ
sarvārambha-parityāgī guṇātītaḥ sa ucyate

English Meaning:
One who is equal in honor and dishonor, friend and enemy, and has renounced all ego-driven actions is beyond the gunas.

Detailed Explanation:
This verse highlights:

- Freedom from ego
- Freedom from duality
- Freedom from attachment to outcomes

Key Insight:
Freedom is beyond dualities.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:
मां च योऽव्यभिचारेण भक्तियोगेन सेवते ।
स गुणान्समतीत्यैतान्ब्रह्मभूयाय कल्पते ॥14.26॥

Transliteration:
māṁ ca yo ’vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate

English Meaning:
One who serves Me with unwavering devotion transcends the gunas and attains Brahman.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna gives the **ultimate shortcut:**
👉 Bhakti (devotion) automatically transcends all gunas

No need to struggle intellectually—devotion lifts you beyond nature.

Key Insight:
Devotion transcends all limitations.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:
ब्रह्मणो हि प्रतिष्ठाहममृतस्याव्ययस्य च ।
शाश्वतस्य च धर्मस्य सुखस्यैकान्तिकस्य च ॥14.27॥

Transliteration:

brahmaṇo hi pratiṣṭhāham amṛtasyāvyayasya ca
śāśvatasya ca dharmasya sukhasyaikāntikasya ca

English Meaning:

I am the foundation of Brahman, immortality, eternal dharma, and ultimate happiness.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reveals the highest truth:

👉 Even Brahman rests in Him

👉 He is the **ultimate source of everything**

This is a profound theological climax.

Key Insight:

Krishna is the ultimate reality beyond even Brahman.

Chapter 15: Puruṣottama Yoga

(The Yoga of the Supreme Divine Person)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
ऊर्ध्वमूलमधःशाखमश्वत्थं प्राहुरव्ययम् ।
छन्दांसि यस्य पर्णानि यस्तं वेद स वेदवित् ॥15.1॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
ūrdhva-mūlam adhaḥ-śākham aśvatthaṁ prāhur avyayam
chandāṁsi yasya parṇāni yas taṁ veda sa veda-vit

English Meaning:

Krishna said: The eternal banyan tree has roots above and branches below; its leaves are the Vedas. One who understands this tree knows the Vedas.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna introduces a powerful metaphor:

- Root above → God
- Branches below → world
- Leaves → scriptures

This tree represents **material existence (samsara)**.

Key Insight:

The world is an inverted reflection of divine reality.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

अधश्चोर्ध्वं प्रसृतास्तस्य शाखा
गुणप्रवृद्धा विषयप्रवालाः ।
अधश्च मूलान्यनुसन्ततानि
कर्मानुबन्धीनि मनुष्यलोके ॥15.2॥

Transliteration:

adhaś cordhvaṁ prasṛtās tasya śākhā
guṇa-pravṛddhā viṣaya-pravālāḥ
adhaś ca mūlāny anusantatāni
karmānubandhīni manuṣya-loke

English Meaning:

Its branches spread downward and upward, nourished by the gunas; its roots bind humans through karma.

Detailed Explanation:

- Gunas nourish worldly life
- Karma binds the soul

Key Insight:

Desire and action sustain bondage.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

न रूपमस्येह तथोपलभ्यते
नान्तो न चादिर्न च सम्प्रतिष्ठा ।
अश्वत्थमेनं सुविरूढमूलम्
असङ्गशस्त्रेण दृढेन छित्त्वा ॥15.3॥

Transliteration:
na rūpam asyeha tathopalabhyate
nānto na cādir na ca sampratiṣṭhā
aśvattham enaṁ su-virūḍha-mūlam
asaṅga-śastreṇa dṛḍhena chittvā

English Meaning:
This tree's true form cannot be perceived; cut it down with detachment.

Detailed Explanation:
The world is:

- Infinite
- Ever-changing
- Illusory

Only **detachment (asanga)** cuts bondage.

Key Insight:
Detachment is the weapon of liberation.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
ततः पदं तत्परिमार्गितव्यं
यस्मिन्गता न निवर्तन्ति भूयः ।
तमेव चाद्यं पुरुषं प्रपद्ये
यतः प्रवृत्तिः प्रसृता पुराणी ॥15.4॥

Transliteration:
tataḥ padaṁ tat parimārgitavyaṁ
yasmin gatā na nivartanti bhūyaḥ
tam eva cādyaṁ puruṣaṁ prapadye
yataḥ pravṛttiḥ prasṛtā purāṇī

English Meaning:

Seek that supreme state from which none return.

Detailed Explanation:

After detachment, seek:

👉 Supreme Reality (Purushottama)

Key Insight:

Liberation is returning to the source.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

निर्मानमोहा जितसङ्गदोषा
अध्यात्मनित्या विनिवृत्तकामाः ।
द्वन्द्वैर्विमुक्ताः सुखदुःखसंज्ञैर्
गच्छन्त्यमूढाः पदमव्ययं तत् ॥15.5॥

Transliteration:

nirmāna-mohā jita-saṅga-doṣā
adhyātma-nityā vinivṛtta-kāmāḥ
dvandvair vimuktāḥ sukha-duḥkha-saṁjñair
gacchanty amūḍhāḥ padam avyayaṁ tat

English Meaning:

Free from ego, attachment, and dualities, one reaches the eternal state.

Detailed Explanation:

Requirements for liberation:

- No ego
- No attachment
- No duality

Key Insight:
Freedom requires inner purification.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
न तद्भासयते सूर्यो न शशाङ्को न पावकः ।
यद्गत्वा न निवर्तन्ते तद्धाम परमं मम ॥15.6॥

Transliteration:
na tad bhāsayate sūryo na śaśāṅko na pāvakaḥ
yad gatvā na nivartante tad dhāma paramaṁ mama

English Meaning:
That supreme abode is beyond sun, moon, or fire; reaching it, one never returns.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna describes the **spiritual realm** beyond material light.

Key Insight:
The divine realm is beyond material existence.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
ममैवांशो जीवलोके जीवभूतः सनातनः ।
मनःषष्ठानीन्द्रियाणि प्रकृतिस्थानि कर्षति ॥15.7॥

Transliteration:
mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ
manaḥ-ṣaṣṭhānīndriyāṇi prakṛti-sthāni karṣati

English Meaning:
The soul is a fragment of Me, struggling with mind and senses.

Detailed Explanation:

- Soul = part of God
- Struggles due to identification with body

Key Insight:
You are divine in essence.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:
शरीरं यदवाप्नोति यच्चाप्युत्क्रामतीश्वरः ।
गृहीत्वैतानि संयाति वायुर्गन्धानिवाशयात् ॥15.8॥

Key Insight:
Soul carries impressions from life to life.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रोत्रं चक्षुः स्पर्शनं च रसनं घ्राणमेव च ।
अधिष्ठाय मनश्चायं विषयानुपसेवते ॥15.9॥

Key Insight:
Soul experiences through senses.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

उत्क्रामन्तं स्थितं वापि भुञ्जानं वा गुणान्वितम् ।
विमूढा नानुपश्यन्ति पश्यन्ति ज्ञानचक्षुषः ॥15.10॥

Key Insight:

Only the wise perceive the soul.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

यतन्तो योगिनश्चैनं पश्यन्त्यात्मन्यवस्थितम् ।
यतन्तोऽप्यकृतात्मानो नैनं पश्यन्त्यचेतसः ॥15.11॥

Key Insight:

Purity is needed to perceive truth.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदादित्यगतं तेजो जगद्भासयतेऽखिलम् ।
यच्चन्द्रमसि यच्चाग्नौ ततेजो विद्धि मामकम् ॥15.12॥

Key Insight:

All light comes from God.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

गामाविश्य च भूतानि धारयाम्यहमोजसा ।
पुष्णामि चौषधीः सर्वाः सोमो भूत्वा रसात्मकः ॥15.13॥

Key Insight:
God sustains life.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:
अहं वैश्वानरो भूत्वा प्राणिनां देहमाश्रितः ।
प्राणापानसमायुक्तः पचाम्यन्नं चतुर्विधम् ॥15.14॥

Key Insight:
God digests food within beings.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वस्य चाहं हृदि सन्निविष्टो
मत्तः स्मृतिर्ज्ञानमपोहनं च ।
वेदैश्च सर्वैरहमेव वेद्यो
वेदान्तकृद्वेदविदेव चाहम् ॥15.15॥

Transliteration:
sarvasya cāhaṁ hṛdi sanniviṣṭo
mattaḥ smṛtir jñānam apohanaṁ ca
vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyo
vedānta-kṛd veda-vid eva cāham

English Meaning:
I am in the heart of all; from Me come memory, knowledge, and forgetfulness.

Key Insight:
God is the source of all cognition.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

द्वाविमौ पुरुषौ लोके क्षरश्चाक्षर एव च ।
क्षरः सर्वाणि भूतानि कूटस्थोऽक्षर उच्यते ॥15.16॥

Key Insight:

Two types: perishable and imperishable.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

उत्तमः पुरुषस्त्वन्यः परमात्मेत्युदाहृतः ।
यो लोकत्रयमाविश्य बिभर्त्यव्यय ईश्वरः ॥15.17॥

Key Insight:

Supreme Person sustains all.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

यस्मात्क्षरमतीतोऽहमक्षरादपि चोत्तमः ।
अतोऽस्मि लोके वेदे च प्रथितः पुरुषोत्तमः ॥15.18॥

Key Insight:

Krishna is beyond both.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

यो मामेवमसम्मूढो जानाति पुरुषोत्तमम् ।
स सर्वविद्भजति मां सर्वभावेन भारत ॥15.19॥

Key Insight:

Knowing Krishna leads to complete devotion.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

इति गुह्यतमं शास्त्रमिदमुक्तं मयानघ ।
एतद्बुद्ध्वा बुद्धिमान्स्यात्कृतकृत्यश्च भारत ॥15.20॥

Transliteration:

iti guhyatamaṁ śāstram idam uktaṁ mayānagha
etad buddhvā buddhimān syāt kṛta-kṛtyaś ca bhārata

English Meaning:

This most secret teaching makes one wise and fulfilled.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna concludes:

👉 This knowledge = ultimate wisdom

👉 Leads to fulfillment of life

Key Insight:

Understanding this completes life’s purpose.

Chapter 16: Daivāsura Sampad Vibhāga Yoga

(The Yoga of the Division between Divine and Demonic Qualities)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अभयं सत्त्वसंशुद्धिर्ज्ञानयोगव्यवस्थितिः ।
दानं दमश्च यज्ञश्च स्वाध्यायस्तप आर्जवम् ॥16.1॥

Transliteration:
śrī-bhagavān uvāca
abhayaṁ sattva-saṁśuddhir jñāna-yoga-vyavasthitiḥ
dānaṁ damaś ca yajñaś ca svādhyāyas tapa ārjavam

English Meaning:
Krishna said: Fearlessness, purity, steadfastness in knowledge, charity, self-control, sacrifice, study, austerity, and honesty—

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna begins listing **divine qualities (Daivi Sampad)**—traits that elevate a person spiritually.

Key Insight:
Divine life begins with purity and discipline.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:
अहिंसा सत्यमक्रोधस्त्यागः शान्तिरपैशुनम् ।
दया भूतेष्वलोलुप्त्वं मार्दवं ह्रीरचापलम् ॥16.2॥

Transliteration:
ahiṁsā satyam akrodhas tyāgaḥ śāntir apaiśunam
dayā bhūteṣv aloluptvaṁ mārdavaṁ hrīr acāpalam

English Meaning:
Non-violence, truthfulness, absence of anger, renunciation, peace, compassion, gentleness—

Detailed Explanation:
These qualities cultivate **harmony with others and within oneself.**

Key Insight:
Compassion and truth define divinity.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:
तेजः क्षमा धृतिः शौचमद्रोहो नातिमानिता ।
भवन्ति संपदं दैवीमभिजातस्य भारत ॥16.3॥

Transliteration:
tejaḥ kṣamā dhṛtiḥ śaucam adroho nātimānitā
bhavanti sampadaṁ daivīm abhijātasya bhārata

English Meaning:
Vigor, forgiveness, fortitude, cleanliness, and humility are divine qualities.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna summarizes the essence of divine nature.

Key Insight:

Humility and strength go together.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

दम्भो दर्पोऽभिमानश्च क्रोधः पारुष्यमेव च ।
अज्ञानं चाभिजातस्य पार्थ संपदमासुरीम् ॥16.4॥

Transliteration:

dambho darpo ’bhimānaś ca krodhaḥ pāruṣyam eva ca
ajñānaṁ cābhijātasya pārtha sampadam āsurīm

English Meaning:

Hypocrisy, arrogance, pride, anger, harshness, and ignorance are demonic qualities.

Detailed Explanation:

These traits lead to **downfall and suffering**.

Key Insight:

Ego is the root of negativity.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

दैवी संपद्विमोक्षाय निबन्धायासुरी मता ।
मा शुचः संपदं दैवीमभिजातोऽसि पाण्डव ॥16.5॥

Transliteration:
daivī sampad vimokṣāya nibandhāyāsurī matā
mā śucaḥ sampadaṁ daivīm abhijāto ’si pāṇḍava

English Meaning:
Divine qualities lead to liberation; demonic qualities lead to bondage.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna reassures Arjuna:
👉 You are born with divine qualities.

Key Insight:
Character determines destiny.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
द्वौ भूतसर्गौ लोकेऽस्मिन् दैव आसुर एव च ।
दैवो विस्तरशः प्रोक्त आसुरं पार्थ मे शृणु ॥16.6॥

Key Insight:
Two types of human nature exist.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:
प्रवृत्तिं च निवृत्तिं च जना न विदुरासुराः ।
न शौचं नापि चाचारो न सत्यं तेषु विद्यते ॥16.7॥

Transliteration:
pravṛttiṁ ca nivṛttiṁ ca janā na vidur āsurāḥ
na śaucaṁ nāpi cācāro na satyaṁ teṣu vidyate

English Meaning:

Demonic people do not know right and wrong.

Detailed Explanation:

Lack of moral clarity leads to chaos.

Key Insight:

Ignorance destroys ethics.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

असत्यमप्रतिष्ठं ते जगदाहुरनीश्वरम् ।
अपरस्परसम्भूतं किमन्यत्कामहैतुकम् ॥16.8॥

Key Insight:

Demonic people deny God and moral order.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

एतां दृष्टिमवष्टभ्य नष्टात्मानोऽल्पबुद्धयः ।
प्रभवन्त्युग्रकर्माणः क्षयाय जगतोऽहिताः ॥16.9॥

Key Insight:

Wrong beliefs lead to destructive actions.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

काममाश्रित्य दुष्पूरं दम्भमानमदान्विताः ।
मोहाद्गृहीत्वासद्ग्राहान्प्रवर्तन्तेऽशुचिव्रताः ॥16.10॥

Key Insight:

Endless desire leads to downfall.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

चिन्तामपरिमेयां च प्रलयान्तामुपाश्रिताः ।
कामोपभोगपरमा एतावदिति निश्चिताः ॥16.11॥

Key Insight:

Attachment leads to anxiety.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

आशापाशशतैर्बद्धाः कामक्रोधपरायणाः ।
ईहन्ते कामभोगार्थमन्यायेनार्थसञ्चयान् ॥16.12॥

Key Insight:

Desire and anger trap people.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

इदमद्य मया लब्धमिमं प्राप्स्ये मनोरथम् ।
इदमस्तीदमपि मे भविष्यति पुनर्धनम् ॥16.13॥

Key Insight:

Material obsession blinds.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

असौ मया हतः शत्रुर्हनिष्ये चापरानपि ।
ईश्वरोऽहमहं भोगी सिद्धोऽहं बलवान्सुखी ॥16.14॥

Key Insight:

Ego creates illusion of control.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

आढ्योऽभिजनवानस्मि कोऽन्योऽस्ति सदृशो मया ।
यक्ष्ये दास्यामि मोदिष्य इत्यज्ञानविमोहिताः ॥16.15॥

Key Insight:

Pride leads to delusion.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनेकचित्तविभ्रान्ता मोहजालसमावृताः ।
प्रसक्ताः कामभोगेषु पतन्ति नरकेऽशुचौ ॥16.16॥

Key Insight:

Confusion leads to downfall.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

आत्मसम्भाविताः स्तब्धा धनमानमदान्विताः ।
यजन्ते नामयज्ञैस्ते दम्भेनाविधिपूर्वकम् ॥16.17॥

Key Insight:

False spirituality is hypocrisy.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

अहङ्कारं बलं दर्पं कामं क्रोधं च संश्रिताः ।
मामात्मपरदेहेषु प्रद्विषन्तोऽभ्यसूयकाः ॥16.18॥

Key Insight:

Ego leads to hatred of truth.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

तानहं द्विषतः क्रूरान्संसारेषु नराधमान् ।
क्षिपाम्यजस्रमशुभानासुरीष्वेव योनिषु ॥16.19॥

Transliteration:

tān ahaṁ dviṣataḥ krūrān saṁsāreṣu narādhamān
kṣipāmy ajasram aśubhān āsurīṣv eva yoniṣu

English Meaning:

Those who hate the divine are cast into demonic births.

Detailed Explanation:

Negative tendencies perpetuate suffering.

Key Insight:

Actions shape future existence.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

आसुरीं योनिमापन्ना मूढा जन्मनि जन्मनि ।
मामप्राप्यैव कौन्तेय ततो यान्त्यधमां गतिम् ॥16.20॥

Transliteration:

āsurīṁ yonim āpannā mūḍhā janmani janmani
mām aprāpyaiva kaunteya tato yānty adhamāṁ gatim

English Meaning:

Falling into demonic births repeatedly, they never reach Me.

Detailed Explanation:

Without transformation, the cycle continues.

Key Insight:

Spiritual ignorance leads to repeated suffering.

Chapter 17: Śraddhā Traya Vibhāga Yoga

(The Yoga of the Threefold Division of Faith)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ये शास्त्रविधिमुत्सृज्य यजन्ते श्रद्धयान्विताः ।
तेषां निष्ठा तु का कृष्ण सत्त्वमाहो रजस्तमः ॥17.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
ye śāstra-vidhim utsṛjya yajante śraddhayānvitāḥ
teṣāṁ niṣṭhā tu kā kṛṣṇa sattvam āho rajas tamaḥ

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: Those who worship with faith but disregard scriptures—what is their nature? Sattvic, rajasic, or tamasic?

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna raises an important question:
👉 Is sincerity enough, or must faith align with scripture?

This explores **misguided faith vs true faith.**

Key Insight:

Faith must be guided by wisdom.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
त्रिविधा भवति श्रद्धा देहिनां सा स्वभावजा ।
सात्त्विकी राजसी चैव तामसी चेति तां शृणु ॥17.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
trividhā bhavati śraddhā dehināṁ sā svabhāva-jā
sāttvikī rājasī caiva tāmasī ceti tāṁ śṛṇu

English Meaning:

Faith is of three kinds—sattvic, rajasic, and tamasic—according to one's nature.

Detailed Explanation:

Faith is shaped by:

- Inner tendencies
- Gunas

Key Insight:

Your nature determines your faith.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

सत्त्वानुरूपा सर्वस्य श्रद्धा भवति भारत ।
श्रद्धामयोऽयं पुरुषो यो यच्छ्रद्धः स एव सः ॥17.3॥

Transliteration:

sattvānurūpā sarvasya śraddhā bhavati bhārata
śraddhā-mayo 'yaṁ puruṣo yo yac chraddhaḥ sa eva saḥ

English Meaning:

A person is defined by their faith; whatever one believes, that they become.

Detailed Explanation:

Faith shapes identity and destiny.

Key Insight:

You become what you believe.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:

यजन्ते सात्त्विका देवान्यक्षरक्षांसि राजसाः ।
प्रेतान्भूतगणांश्चान्ये यजन्ते तामसा जनाः ॥17.4॥

Transliteration:

yajante sāttvikā devān yakṣa-rakṣāṁsi rājasāḥ
pretān bhūta-gaṇāṁś cānye yajante tāmasā janāḥ

English Meaning:

Sattvic people worship gods, rajasic worship powerful beings, tamasic worship spirits.

Detailed Explanation:

Faith directs worship based on consciousness level.

Key Insight:

Your worship reflects your inner nature.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:

अशास्त्रविहितं घोरं तप्यन्ते ये तपो जनाः ।
दम्भाहङ्कारसंयुक्ताः कामरागबलान्विताः ॥17.5॥

Transliteration:

aśāstra-vihitaṁ ghoraṁ tapyante ye tapo janāḥ
dambhāhaṅkāra-saṁyuktāḥ kāma-rāga-balānvitāḥ

English Meaning:

Those who perform severe austerities without scriptural guidance are driven by ego and desire.

Detailed Explanation:

Misguided austerity is harmful.

Key Insight:

Discipline without wisdom becomes ego.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:

कर्षयन्तः शरीरस्थं भूतग्राममचेतसः ।
मां चैवान्तःशरीरस्थं तान्विद्ध्यासुरनिश्चयान् ॥17.6॥

Transliteration:

karśayantaḥ śarīra-sthaṁ bhūta-grāmam acetasaḥ
māṁ caivāntaḥ-śarīra-sthaṁ tān viddhy āsura-niścayān

English Meaning:

They torture the body and Me within it—such people are demonic.

Detailed Explanation:

Body is sacred—it houses the Divine.

Key Insight:

Self-harm is spiritual ignorance.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

आहारस्त्वपि सर्वस्य त्रिविधो भवति प्रियः ।
यज्ञस्तपस्तथा दानं तेषां भेदमिमं शृणु ॥17.7॥

Transliteration:

āhāras tv api sarvasya tri-vidho bhavati priyaḥ
yajñas tapas tathā dānaṁ teṣāṁ bhedam imaṁ śṛṇu

English Meaning:

Food, sacrifice, austerity, and charity are also of three types.

Detailed Explanation:

Even daily life reflects the gunas.

Key Insight:

Spirituality is reflected in lifestyle.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

आयुःसत्त्वबलारोग्यसुखप्रीतिविवर्धनाः ।
रस्याः स्निग्धाः स्थिरा हृद्या आहाराः सात्त्विकप्रियाः ॥17.8॥

Transliteration:

āyuḥ-sattva-balārogya-sukha-prīti-vivardhanāḥ
rasyāḥ snigdhāḥ sthirā hṛdyā āhārāḥ sāttvika-priyāḥ

English Meaning:

Sattvic foods increase life, strength, health, and happiness.

Detailed Explanation:

Pure food supports clarity and balance.

Key Insight:

Food influences consciousness.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

कट्वम्ललवणात्युष्णतीक्ष्णरूक्षविदाहिनः ।
आहारा राजसस्येष्टा दुःखशोकामयप्रदाः ॥17.9॥

Transliteration:

kaṭv-amla-lavaṇātyuṣṇa-tīkṣṇa-rūkṣa-vidāhinaḥ
āhārā rājasasyeṣṭā duḥkha-śokāmaya-pradāḥ

English Meaning:

Rajasic foods are bitter, sour, salty, and cause suffering.

Detailed Explanation:

Such foods increase restlessness.

Key Insight:

Excess stimulation leads to imbalance.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

यातयामं गतरसं पूति पर्युषितं च यत् ।
उच्छिष्टमपि चामेध्यं भोजनं तामसप्रियम् ॥17.10॥

Transliteration:

yāta-yāmaṁ gata-rasaṁ pūti paryuṣitaṁ ca yat
ucchiṣṭam api cāmedhyaṁ bhojanaṁ tāmasa-priyam

English Meaning:

Tamasic food is stale, impure, and unclean.

Detailed Explanation:

Such food dulls the mind.

Key Insight:

Impure intake leads to dullness.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

अफलाकाङ्क्षिभिर्यज्ञो विधिदृष्टो य इज्यते ।
यष्टव्यमेवेति मनः समाधाय स सात्त्विकः ॥17.11॥

Transliteration:

aphalākāṅkṣibhir yajño vidhi-dṛṣṭo ya ijyate
yaṣṭavyam eveti manaḥ samādhāya sa sāttvikaḥ

English Meaning:

Sattvic sacrifice is done without desire for reward.

Detailed Explanation:

Purity lies in intention.

Key Insight:

Selfless action is sattvic.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

अभिसन्धाय तु फलं दम्भार्थमपि चैव यत् ।
इज्यते भरतश्रेष्ठ तं यज्ञं विद्धि राजसम् ॥17.12॥

Transliteration:

abhisandhāya tu phalaṁ dambhārtham api caiva yat
ijyate bharata-śreṣṭha taṁ yajñaṁ viddhi rājasam

English Meaning:

Sacrifice done for reward or show is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Motivation determines quality.

Key Insight:

Ego corrupts action.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

विधिहीनमसृष्टान्नं मन्त्रहीनमदक्षिणम् ।
श्रद्धाविरहितं यज्ञं तामसं परिचक्षते ॥17.13॥

Transliteration:

vidhi-hīnam asṛṣṭānnaṁ mantra-hīnam adakṣiṇam
śraddhā-virahitaṁ yajñaṁ tāmasaṁ paricakṣate

English Meaning:

Sacrifice without faith or proper method is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Lack of sincerity and discipline leads to degradation.

Key Insight:

Faith and correctness matter.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

देवद्विजगुरुप्राज्ञपूजनं शौचमार्जवम् ।
ब्रह्मचर्यमहिंसा च शारीरं तप उच्यते ॥17.14॥

Transliteration:

deva-dvija-guru-prājña-pūjanaṁ śaucam ārjavam
brahmacaryam ahiṁsā ca śārīraṁ tapa ucyate

English Meaning:

Respect, purity, discipline, and non-violence are bodily austerities.

Detailed Explanation:

True discipline begins with conduct.

Key Insight:

Discipline shapes character.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनुद्वेगकरं वाक्यं सत्यं प्रियहितं च यत् ।
स्वाध्यायाभ्यसनं चैव वाङ्मयं तप उच्यते ॥17.15॥

Transliteration:
anudvega-karaṁ vākyaṁ satyaṁ priya-hitaṁ ca yat
svādhyāyābhyasanaṁ caiva vāṅ-mayaṁ tapa ucyate

English Meaning:
Speech that is truthful, pleasant, and beneficial is austerity of speech.

Detailed Explanation:
Words should uplift, not harm.

Key Insight:
Speech reflects inner discipline.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:
मनःप्रसादः सौम्यत्वं मौनमात्मविनिग्रहः ।
भावसंशुद्धिरित्येतत्तपो मानसमुच्यते ॥17.16॥

Transliteration:
manaḥ-prasādaḥ saumyatvaṁ maunam ātma-vinigrahaḥ
bhāva-saṁśuddhir ity etat tapo mānasam ucyate

English Meaning:
Calmness, silence, and purity of thought are mental austerities.

Detailed Explanation:
Inner discipline is highest.

Key Insight:
Peace begins within.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रद्धया परया तप्तं तपस्तत्त्रिविधं नरैः ।
अफलाकाङ्क्षिभिर्युक्तैः सात्त्विकं परिचक्षते ॥17.17॥

Transliteration:

śraddhayā parayā taptaṁ tapas tat tri-vidhaṁ naraiḥ
aphalākāṅkṣibhir yuktaiḥ sāttvikaṁ paricakṣate

English Meaning:

Austerity done with faith and no expectation is sattvic.

Detailed Explanation:

Faith + purity = spiritual elevation.

Key Insight:

Pure intention defines sattva.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

सत्कारमानपूजार्थं तपो दम्भेन चैव यत् ।
क्रियते तदिह प्रोक्तं राजसं चलमध्रुवम् ॥17.18॥

Transliteration:

satkāra-māna-pūjārthaṁ tapo dambhena caiva yat
kriyate tad iha proktaṁ rājasaṁ calam adhruvam

English Meaning:

Austerity done for respect or show is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:

External validation corrupts discipline.

Key Insight:

Ego makes effort unstable.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

मूढग्राहेणात्मनो यत्पीडया क्रियते तपः ।
परस्योत्सादनार्थं वा तत्तामसमुदाहृतम् ॥17.19॥

Transliteration:

mūḍha-grāheṇātmano yat pīḍayā kriyate tapaḥ
parasyotsādanārthaṁ vā tat tāmasam udāhṛtam

English Meaning:

Austerity that harms oneself or others is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Extreme or harmful practices are misguided.

Key Insight:

True spirituality never harms.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

दातव्यमिति यद्दानं दीयतेऽनुपकारिणे ।
देशे काले च पात्रे च तद्दानं सात्त्विकं स्मृतम् ॥17.20॥

Transliteration:

dātavyam iti yad dānaṁ dīyate ’nupakāriṇe
deśe kāle ca pātre ca tad dānaṁ sāttvikaṁ smṛtam

English Meaning:
Charity given at the right time, place, and to a worthy person without expectation is sattvic.

Detailed Explanation:
True giving is selfless and thoughtful.

Key Insight:
Pure giving expects nothing in return.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
यत्तु प्रत्युपकारार्थं फलमुद्दिश्य वा पुनः ।
दीयते च परिक्लिष्टं तद्दानं राजसं स्मृतम् ॥17.21॥

Transliteration:
yat tu pratyupakārārthaṁ phalam uddiśya vā punaḥ
dīyate ca parikliṣṭaṁ tad dānaṁ rājasaṁ smṛtam

English Meaning:
Charity given with expectation of return or reward, and with reluctance, is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:
This type of giving is:

- Conditional
- Self-serving
- Emotionally reluctant

It is driven by **ego or personal gain**, not compassion.

Key Insight:
Giving with expectation diminishes its value.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
अदेशकाले यद्दानमपात्रेभ्यश्च दीयते ।
असत्कृतमवज्ञातं तत्तामसमुदाहृतम् ॥17.22॥

Transliteration:
adeśa-kāle yad dānam apātrebhyaś ca dīyate
asat-kṛtam avajñātaṁ tat tāmasam udāhṛtam

English Meaning:
Charity given at the wrong time, place, or to unworthy recipients, without respect, is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:
Tamasic giving is:

- Careless
- Disrespectful
- Harmful or misguided

It lacks both **wisdom and sincerity**.

Key Insight:
Wrong giving can be harmful.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
ॐ तत्सदिति निर्देशो ब्रह्मणस्त्रिविधः स्मृतः ।
ब्राह्मणास्तेन वेदाश्च यज्ञाश्च विहिताः पुरा ॥17.23॥

Transliteration:
oṁ tat sat iti nirdeśo brahmaṇas tri-vidhaḥ smṛtaḥ
brāhmaṇās tena vedāś ca yajñāś ca vihitāḥ purā

English Meaning:
"Om Tat Sat" are the threefold expressions of Brahman used in sacred acts.

Detailed Explanation:
These three sacred syllables represent:

- **Om** → Absolute Reality
- **Tat** → That (God beyond ego)
- **Sat** → Truth / existence

They purify actions.

Key Insight:
Sacred intention purifies action.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:
तस्मादोमित्युदाहृत्य यज्ञदानतपःक्रियाः ।
प्रवर्तन्ते विधानोक्ताः सततं ब्रह्मवादिनाम् ॥17.24॥

Transliteration:
tasmād om ity udāhṛtya yajña-dāna-tapaḥ-kriyāḥ
pravartante vidhānoktāḥ satataṁ brahma-vādinām

English Meaning:
Therefore, acts of sacrifice, charity, and austerity begin with "Om".

Detailed Explanation:
"Om" aligns actions with the Divine and removes ego.

Key Insight:
Begin actions with divine remembrance.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

तदित्यनभिसन्धाय फलं यज्ञतपःक्रियाः ।
दानक्रियाश्च विविधाः क्रियन्ते मोक्षकाङ्क्षिभिः ॥17.25॥

Transliteration:

tad ity anabhisandhāya phalaṁ yajña-tapaḥ-kriyāḥ
dāna-kriyāś ca vividhāḥ kriyante mokṣa-kāṅkṣibhiḥ

English Meaning:

Using "Tat", actions are performed without desire for reward by seekers of liberation.

Detailed Explanation:

"Tat" reminds:
👉 "This is for God, not for me"

This removes attachment.

Key Insight:

Offer all actions to the Divine.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

सद्भावे साधुभावे च सदित्येतत्प्रयुज्यते ।
प्रशस्ते कर्मणि तथा सच्छब्दः पार्थ युज्यते ॥17.26॥

Transliteration:

sad-bhāve sādhu-bhāve ca sad ity etat prayujyate
praśaste karmaṇi tathā sac-chabdaḥ pārtha yujyate

English Meaning:
"Sat" is used to denote truth, goodness, and auspicious action.

Detailed Explanation:
"Sat" represents:

- Truth
- Purity
- Goodness

It elevates action.

Key Insight:
Truth and goodness define divine action.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:
यज्ञे तपसि दाने च स्थितिः सदिति चोच्यते ।
कर्म चैव तदर्थीयं सदित्येवाभिधीयते ॥17.27॥

Transliteration:
yajñe tapasi dāne ca sthitiḥ sad iti cocyate
karma caiva tad-arthīyaṁ sad ity evābhidhīyate

English Meaning:
Steadfastness in sacrifice, austerity, and charity is called "Sat".

Detailed Explanation:
Consistency in good actions = Sat

Not just action, but **commitment** matters.

Key Insight:
Consistency makes actions meaningful.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

अश्रद्धया हुतं दत्तं तपस्तप्तं कृतं च यत् ।
असदित्युच्यते पार्थ न च तत्प्रेत्य नो इह ॥17.28॥

Transliteration:

aśraddhayā hutaṁ dattaṁ tapas taptaṁ kṛtaṁ ca yat
asad ity ucyate pārtha na ca tat pretya no iha

English Meaning:

Any action done without faith is considered "Asat" (false) and yields no result.

Detailed Explanation:

Without faith:

- Rituals are empty
- Charity is meaningless
- Effort is wasted

Faith is the **soul of action.**

Key Insight:

Without faith, action is lifeless.

Chapter 18: Mokṣa Sannyāsa Yoga

(The Yoga of Liberation and Renunciation)

Verse 1

Sanskrit Shloka:

अर्जुन उवाच ।
संन्यासस्य महाबाहो तत्त्वमिच्छामि वेदितुम् ।
त्यागस्य च हृषीकेश पृथक्केशिनिषूदन ॥18.1॥

Transliteration:

arjuna uvāca
sannyāsasya mahā-bāho tattvam icchāmi veditum
tyāgasya ca hṛṣīkeśa pṛthak keśini-śūdana

English Meaning:

Arjuna said: I wish to understand the difference between renunciation (sannyāsa) and abandonment (tyāga).

Detailed Explanation:

Arjuna asks about:

- **Sannyasa** → renouncing actions
- **Tyaga** → renouncing results

This is the final philosophical clarification.

Key Insight:

Renunciation must be properly understood.

Verse 2

Sanskrit Shloka:

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
काम्यानां कर्मणां न्यासं संन्यासं कवयो विदुः ।
सर्वकर्मफलत्यागं प्राहुस्त्यागं विचक्षणाः ॥18.2॥

Transliteration:

śrī-bhagavān uvāca
kāmyānāṁ karmaṇāṁ nyāsaṁ sannyāsaṁ kavayo viduḥ
sarva-karma-phala-tyāgaṁ prāhus tyāgaṁ vicakṣaṇāḥ

English Meaning:

Renouncing desire-driven actions is sannyasa; renouncing results is tyaga.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna clarifies:

- Do not abandon action
- Abandon attachment to outcomes

Key Insight:

True renunciation is inner, not external.

Verse 3

Sanskrit Shloka:

त्याज्यं दोषवदित्येके कर्म प्राहुर्मनीषिणः ।
यज्ञदानतपःकर्म न त्याज्यमिति चापरे ॥18.3॥

Transliteration:

tyājyaṁ doṣavad ity eke karma prāhur manīṣiṇaḥ
yajña-dāna-tapaḥ-karma na tyājyam iti cāpare

English Meaning:
Some say all actions should be renounced; others say sacrifice, charity, and austerity should not be abandoned.

Detailed Explanation:
Different philosophical views exist.

Key Insight:
Not all renunciation is correct.

Verse 4

Sanskrit Shloka:
निश्चयं शृणु मे तत्र त्यागे भरतसत्तम ।
त्यागो हि पुरुषव्याघ्र त्रिविधः संप्रकीर्तितः ॥18.4॥

Transliteration:
niścayaṁ śṛṇu me tatra tyāge bharata-sattama
tyāgo hi puruṣa-vyāghra tri-vidhaḥ samprakīrtitaḥ

English Meaning:
Hear My conclusion—renunciation is of three types.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna introduces:

- Sattvic
- Rajasic
- Tamasic renunciation

Key Insight:
Renunciation varies by consciousness.

Verse 5

Sanskrit Shloka:
यज्ञदानतपःकर्म न त्याज्यं कार्यमेव तत् ।
यज्ञो दानं तपश्चैव पावनानि मनीषिणाम् ॥18.5॥

Transliteration:
yajña-dāna-tapaḥ-karma na tyājyaṁ kāryam eva tat
yajño dānaṁ tapaś caiva pāvanāni manīṣiṇām

English Meaning:
Sacrifice, charity, and austerity should not be abandoned—they purify.

Detailed Explanation:
These actions:

- Refine character
- Purify mind

Key Insight:
Right actions elevate the soul.

Verse 6

Sanskrit Shloka:
एतान्यपि तु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा फलानि च ।
कर्तव्यानि इति मे पार्थ निश्चितं मतमुत्तमम् ॥18.6॥

Transliteration:
etāny api tu karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā phalāni ca
kartavyāni iti me pārtha niścitaṁ matam uttamam

English Meaning:
Perform these actions without attachment or expectation.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna reinforces Karma Yoga.

Key Insight:

Act without attachment.

Verse 7

Sanskrit Shloka:

नियतस्य तु संन्यासः कर्मणो नोपपद्यते ।
मोहात्तस्य परित्यागस्तामसः परिकीर्तितः ॥18.7॥

Transliteration:

niyatasya tu sannyāsaḥ karmaṇo nopapadyate
mohāt tasya parityāgas tāmasaḥ parikīrtitaḥ

English Meaning:

Abandoning duty out of ignorance is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Avoiding responsibility is not spiritual.

Key Insight:

Neglect of duty is ignorance.

Verse 8

Sanskrit Shloka:

दुःखमित्येव यत्कर्म कायक्लेशभयात्त्यजेत् ।
स कृत्वा राजसं त्यागं नैव त्यागफलं लभेत् ॥18.8॥

Transliteration:

duḥkham ity eva yat karma kāya-kleśa-bhayāt tyajet
sa kṛtvā rājasaṁ tyāgaṁ naiva tyāga-phalaṁ labhet

English Meaning:

Abandoning action due to discomfort is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Fear-based renunciation is not true renunciation.

Key Insight:

Avoidance is not liberation.

Verse 9

Sanskrit Shloka:

कार्यमित्येव यत्कर्म नियतं क्रियतेऽर्जुन ।
सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा फलं चैव स त्यागः सात्त्विको मतः ॥18.9॥

Transliteration:

kāryam ity eva yat karma niyataṁ kriyate ’rjuna
saṅgaṁ tyaktvā phalaṁ caiva sa tyāgaḥ sāttviko mataḥ

English Meaning:

Doing duty without attachment is sattvic renunciation.

Detailed Explanation:

This is the ideal:

👉 Do your duty

👉 Without expectation

Key Insight:

Duty + detachment = true renunciation.

Verse 10

Sanskrit Shloka:

न द्वेष्ट्यकुशलं कर्म कुशले नानुषज्जते ।
त्यागी सत्त्वसमाविष्टो मेधावी छिन्नसंशयः ॥18.10॥

Transliteration:

na dveṣṭy akuśalaṁ karma kuśale nānuṣajjate
tyāgī sattva-samāviṣṭo medhāvī chinna-saṁśayaḥ

English Meaning:

A true renunciate neither hates unpleasant work nor clings to pleasant work.

Detailed Explanation:

Balanced mindset is essential.

Key Insight:

Equanimity defines wisdom.

Verse 11

Sanskrit Shloka:

न हि देहभृता शक्यं त्यक्तुं कर्माण्यशेषतः ।
यस्तु कर्मफलत्यागी स त्यागीत्यभिधीयते ॥18.11॥

Transliteration:

na hi deha-bhṛtā śakyaṁ tyaktuṁ karmāṇy aśeṣataḥ
yas tu karma-phala-tyāgī sa tyāgīty abhidhīyate

English Meaning:

It is impossible to give up all actions; one who renounces results is the true renunciate.

Detailed Explanation:

Action is unavoidable—detachment is key.

Key Insight:

Renounce results, not action.

Verse 12

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनिष्टमिष्टं मिश्रं च त्रिविधं कर्मणः फलम् ।
भवत्यत्यागिनां प्रेत्य न तु संन्यासिनां क्वचित् ॥18.12॥

Key Insight:

Attachment leads to consequences.

Verse 13

Sanskrit Shloka:

पञ्चैतानि महाबाहो कारणानि निबोध मे ।
सांख्ये कृतान्ते प्रोक्तानि सिद्धये सर्वकर्मणाम् ॥18.13॥

Key Insight:

Five factors cause action.

Verse 14

Sanskrit Shloka:

अधिष्ठानं तथा कर्ता करणं च पृथग्विधम् ।
विविधाश्च पृथक्चेष्टा दैवं चैवात्र पञ्चमम् ॥18.14॥

Key Insight:

Action involves many factors.

Verse 15

Sanskrit Shloka:

शरीरवाङ्मनोभिर्यत्कर्म प्रारभते नरः ।
न्याय्यं वा विपरीतं वा पञ्चैते तस्य हेतवः ॥18.15॥

Key Insight:

No action is solely individual.

Verse 16

Sanskrit Shloka:

तत्रैवं सति कर्तारमात्मानं केवलं तु यः ।
पश्यत्यकृतबुद्धित्वान्न स पश्यति दुर्मतिः ॥18.16॥

Key Insight:

Thinking "I alone act" is ignorance.

Verse 17

Sanskrit Shloka:

यस्य नाहंकृतो भावो बुद्धिर्यस्य न लिप्यते ।
हत्वाऽपि स इमाँल्लोकान्न हन्ति न निबध्यते ॥18.17॥

Key Insight:

Non-ego leads to freedom from karma.

Verse 18

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं परिज्ञाता त्रिविधा कर्मचोदना ।
करणं कर्म कर्तेति त्रिविधः कर्मसंग्रहः ॥18.18॥

Key Insight:

Knowledge, action, and doer form action.

Verse 19

Sanskrit Shloka:

ज्ञानं कर्म च कर्ता च त्रिधैव गुणभेदतः ।
प्रोच्यते गुणसङ्ख्याने यथावच्छृणु तान्यपि ॥18.19॥

Key Insight:

Everything is influenced by gunas.

Verse 20

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वभूतेषु येनैकं भावमव्ययमीक्षते ।
अविभक्तं विभक्तेषु तज्ज्ञानं विद्धि सात्त्विकम् ॥18.20॥

Transliteration:

sarva-bhūteṣu yenaikaṁ bhāvam avyayam īkṣate
avibhaktaṁ vibhakteṣu taj jñānaṁ viddhi sāttvikam

English Meaning:

Seeing one eternal reality in all beings is sattvic knowledge.

Detailed Explanation:

True wisdom sees:

👉 Unity in diversity
👉 One consciousness in all

Key Insight:
Seeing unity is true knowledge.

Verse 21

Sanskrit Shloka:
पृथक्त्वेन तु यज्ज्ञानं नानाभावान्पृथग्विधान् ।
वेत्ति सर्वेषु भूतेषु तज्ज्ञानं विद्धि राजसम् ॥18.21॥

Transliteration:
pṛthaktvena tu yaj jñānaṁ nānā-bhāvān pṛthag-vidhān
vetti sarveṣu bhūteṣu taj jñānaṁ viddhi rājasam

English Meaning:
Knowledge that sees diversity and separateness among beings is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:
This knowledge:

- Focuses on differences
- Divides rather than unifies

It lacks deeper spiritual insight.

Key Insight:
Seeing separation is limited knowledge.

Verse 22

Sanskrit Shloka:
यत्तु कृत्स्नवदेकस्मिन्कार्ये सक्तमहैतुकम् ।
अतत्त्वार्थवदल्पं च तत्तामसमुदाहृतम् ॥18.22॥

Transliteration:
yat tu kṛtsnavad ekasmin kārye saktam ahaitukam
atattvārtha-vad alpaṁ ca tat tāmasam udāhṛtam

English Meaning:
Knowledge that is irrational, narrow, and clings to one thing as everything is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:
This is:

- Blind belief
- Narrow thinking
- Lack of understanding

Key Insight:
Ignorance limits perception.

Verse 23

Sanskrit Shloka:
नियतं सङ्गरहितमरागद्वेषतः कृतम् ।
अफलप्रेप्सुना कर्म यत्तत्सात्त्विकमुच्यते ॥18.23॥

Transliteration:
niyataṁ saṅga-rahitam arāga-dveṣataḥ kṛtam
aphala-prepsunā karma yat tat sāttvikam ucyate

English Meaning:
Action done without attachment or desire for results is sattvic.

Detailed Explanation:

Such action:

- Is duty-based
- Is free from ego
- Leads to purity

Key Insight:

Selfless action is pure.

Verse 24

Sanskrit Shloka:

यत्तु कामेप्सुना कर्म साहङ्कारेण वा पुनः ।
क्रियते बहुलायासं तद्राजसमुदाहृतम् ॥18.24॥

Transliteration:

yat tu kāmepsunā karma sāhaṅkāreṇa vā punaḥ
kriyate bahulāyāsaṁ tad rājasam udāhṛtam

English Meaning:

Action driven by desire and ego is rajasic.

Detailed Explanation:

Such actions:

- Cause stress
- Are self-centered

Key Insight:

Desire-driven action leads to unrest.

Verse 25

Sanskrit Shloka:

अनुबन्धं क्षयं हिंसामनपेक्ष्य च पौरुषम् ।
मोहादारभ्यते कर्म यत्तत्तामसमुच्यते ॥18.25॥

Transliteration:

anubandhaṁ kṣayaṁ hiṁsām anapekṣya ca pauruṣam
mohād ārabhyate karma yat tat tāmasam ucyate

English Meaning:

Action done blindly without considering consequences is tamasic.

Detailed Explanation:

It leads to:

- Harm
- Destruction
- Regret

Key Insight:

Ignorance leads to harmful action.

Verse 26

Sanskrit Shloka:

मुक्तसङ्गोऽनहंवादी धृत्युत्साहसमन्वितः ।
सिद्ध्यसिद्ध्योर्निर्विकारः कर्ता सात्त्विक उच्यते ॥18.26॥

Transliteration:

mukta-saṅgo ’nahaṁ-vādī dhṛty-utsāha-samanvitaḥ
siddhy-asiddhyor nirvikāraḥ kartā sāttvika ucyate

English Meaning:

The sattvic doer is free from ego, steady, and unaffected by success or failure.

Detailed Explanation:

True worker:

- Is calm
- Is dedicated
- Is detached

Key Insight:

Right attitude defines the doer.

Verse 27

Sanskrit Shloka:

रागी कर्मफलप्रेप्सुर्लुब्धो हिंसात्मकोऽशुचिः ।
हर्षशोकान्वितः कर्ता राजसः परिकीर्तितः ॥18.27॥

Transliteration:

rāgī karma-phala-prepsur lubdho hiṁsātmako ’śuciḥ
harṣa-śokānvitaḥ kartā rājasaḥ parikīrtitaḥ

English Meaning:

The rajasic doer is attached, greedy, and affected by joy and sorrow.

Detailed Explanation:

Such a person:

- Depends on outcomes
- Experiences emotional swings

Key Insight:

Attachment causes instability.

Verse 28

Sanskrit Shloka:

अयुक्तः प्राकृतः स्तब्धः शठो नैष्कृतिकोऽलसः ।
विषादी दीर्घसूत्री च कर्ता तामस उच्यते ॥18.28॥

Transliteration:

ayuktaḥ prākṛtaḥ stabdhaḥ śaṭho naiṣkṛtiko ’lasaḥ
viṣādī dīrgha-sūtrī ca kartā tāmasa ucyate

English Meaning:

The tamasic doer is lazy, deceitful, and depressed.

Detailed Explanation:

This leads to stagnation and decline.

Key Insight:

Negativity blocks growth.

Verse 29

Sanskrit Shloka:

बुद्धेर्भेदं धृतेश्चैव गुणतस्त्रिविधं शृणु ।
प्रोच्यमानमशेषेण पृथक्त्वेन धनञ्जय ॥18.29॥

Transliteration:

buddher bhedaṁ dhṛteś caiva guṇatas tri-vidhaṁ śṛṇu
procyamānam aśeṣeṇa pṛthaktvena dhanañjaya

English Meaning:

Hear about the three types of intellect and determination.

Detailed Explanation:

Krishna now explains inner faculties.

Key Insight:

Mind also follows gunas.

Verse 30

Sanskrit Shloka:

प्रवृत्तिं च निवृत्तिं च कार्याकार्ये भयाभये ।
बन्धं मोक्षं च या वेत्ति बुद्धिः सा पार्थ सात्त्विकी ॥18.30॥

Transliteration:

pravṛttiṁ ca nivṛttiṁ ca kāryākārye bhayābhaye
bandhaṁ mokṣaṁ ca yā vetti buddhiḥ sā pārtha sāttvikī

English Meaning:

Sattvic intellect understands right and wrong, bondage and liberation.

Detailed Explanation:

Clarity leads to right choices.

Key Insight:

Clarity is true intelligence.

Verse 31

Sanskrit Shloka:

यया धर्ममधर्मं च कार्यं चाकार्यमेव च ।
अयथावत्प्रजानाति बुद्धिः सा पार्थ राजसी ॥18.31॥

Key Insight:

Rajasic intellect confuses right and wrong.

Verse 32

Sanskrit Shloka:

अधर्मं धर्ममिति या मन्यते तमसावृता ।
सर्वार्थान्विपरीतांश्च बुद्धिः सा पार्थ तामसी ॥18.32॥

Key Insight:

Tamasic intellect sees everything wrongly.

Verse 33

Sanskrit Shloka:

धृत्या यया धारयते मनःप्राणेन्द्रियक्रियाः ।
योगेनाव्यभिचारिण्या धृतिः सा पार्थ सात्त्विकी ॥18.33॥

Key Insight:

Sattvic determination is steady.

Verse 34

Sanskrit Shloka:

यया तु धर्मकामार्थान्धृत्या धारयतेऽर्जुन ।
प्रसङ्गेन फलाकाङ्क्षी धृतिः सा पार्थ राजसी ॥18.34॥

Key Insight:

Rajasic determination is result-driven.

Verse 35

Sanskrit Shloka:

यया स्वप्नं भयम् शोकं विषादं मदमेव च ।
न विमुञ्चति दुर्मेधा धृतिः सा पार्थ तामसी ॥18.35॥

Key Insight:

Tamasic determination clings to negativity.

Verse 36

Sanskrit Shloka:

सुखं त्विदानीं त्रिविधं शृणु मे भरतर्षभ ।
अभ्यासाद्रमते यत्र दुःखान्तं च निगच्छति ॥18.36॥

Key Insight:

Happiness is also threefold.

Verse 37

Sanskrit Shloka:

यत्तदग्रे विषमिव परिणामेऽमृतोपमम् ।
तत्सुखं सात्त्विकं प्रोक्तमात्मबुद्धिप्रसादजम् ॥18.37॥

Transliteration:

yat tad agre viṣam iva pariṇāme ’mṛtopamam
tat sukhaṁ sāttvikaṁ proktam ātma-buddhi-prasāda-jam

English Meaning:

Sattvic happiness is like poison at first but nectar in the end.

Detailed Explanation:

Growth is initially difficult but ultimately fulfilling.

Key Insight:

True happiness grows over time.

Verse 38

Sanskrit Shloka:

विषयेन्द्रियसंयोगाद्यत्तदग्रेऽमृतोपमम् ।
परिणामे विषमिव तत्सुखं राजसं स्मृतम् ॥18.38॥

Key Insight:

Pleasure turns into pain.

Verse 39

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदग्रे चानुबन्धे च सुखं मोहनमात्मनः ।
निद्रालस्यप्रमादोत्थं तत्तामसमुदाहृतम् ॥18.39॥

Key Insight:

Ignorance creates false happiness.

Verse 40

Sanskrit Shloka:

न तदस्ति पृथिव्यां वा दिवि देवेषु वा पुनः ।
सत्त्वं प्रकृतिजैर्मुक्तं यदेभिः स्यात्त्रिभिर्गुणैः ॥18.40॥

Transliteration:

na tad asti pṛthivyāṁ vā divi deveṣu vā punaḥ
sattvaṁ prakṛti-jair muktaṁ yad ebhiḥ syāt tribhir guṇaiḥ

English Meaning:

No being is free from the three gunas.

Detailed Explanation:

Everything in nature is influenced by these qualities.

Key Insight:
All existence is governed by the gunas.

Verse 41

Sanskrit Shloka:
ब्राह्मणक्षत्रियविशां शूद्राणां च परन्तप ।
कर्माणि प्रविभक्तानि स्वभावप्रभवैर्गुणैः ॥18.41॥

Transliteration:
brāhmaṇa-kṣatriya-viśāṁ śūdrāṇāṁ ca parantapa
karmāṇi pravibhaktāni svabhāva-prabhavair guṇaiḥ

English Meaning:
The duties of different classes arise from their inherent qualities.

Detailed Explanation:
Krishna explains **varna based on qualities (guna), not birth.**

Key Insight:
Role is determined by nature, not status.

Verse 42

Sanskrit Shloka:
शमो दमस्तपः शौचं क्षान्तिरार्जवमेव च ।
ज्ञानं विज्ञानमास्तिक्यं ब्रह्मकर्म स्वभावजम् ॥18.42॥

Transliteration:
śamo damas tapaḥ śaucaṁ kṣāntir ārjavam eva ca
jñānaṁ vijñānam āstikyaṁ brahma-karma svabhāva-jam

English Meaning:
Peace, self-control, purity, knowledge, and faith are qualities of a Brahmana.

Detailed Explanation:
These reflect intellectual and spiritual orientation.

Key Insight:
Wisdom requires discipline and purity.

Verse 43

Sanskrit Shloka:
शौर्यं तेजो धृतिर्दाक्ष्यं युद्धे चाप्यपलायनम् ।
दानमीश्वरभावश्च क्षात्रं कर्म स्वभावजम् ॥18.43॥

Transliteration:
śauryaṁ tejo dhṛtir dākṣyaṁ yuddhe cāpy apalāyanam
dānam īśvara-bhāvaś ca kṣātraṁ karma svabhāva-jam

English Meaning:
Courage, leadership, and generosity are qualities of a Kshatriya.

Detailed Explanation:
These qualities support protection and governance.

Key Insight:
Strength must serve righteousness.

Verse 44

Sanskrit Shloka:

कृषिगौरक्ष्यवाणिज्यं वैश्यकर्म स्वभावजम् ।
परिचर्यात्मकं कर्म शूद्रस्यापि स्वभावजम् ॥18.44॥

Transliteration:

kṛṣi-go-rakṣya-vāṇijyaṁ vaiśya-karma svabhāva-jam
paricaryātmakaṁ karma śūdrasyāpi svabhāva-jam

English Meaning:

Agriculture, trade, and service arise from natural tendencies.

Detailed Explanation:

Each role contributes to society's balance.

Key Insight:

All work has value.

Verse 45

Sanskrit Shloka:

स्वे स्वे कर्मण्यभिरतः संसिद्धिं लभते नरः ।
स्वकर्मनिरतः सिद्धिं यथा विन्दति तच्छृणु ॥18.45॥

Transliteration:

sve sve karmaṇy abhirataḥ saṁsiddhiṁ labhate naraḥ
sva-karma-niratаḥ siddhiṁ yathā vindati tac chṛṇu

English Meaning:

By performing one's own duty, one attains perfection.

Detailed Explanation:

Fulfillment comes from aligning with one's nature.

Key Insight:

Do your own duty well.

Verse 46

Sanskrit Shloka:
यतः प्रवृत्तिर्भूतानां येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
स्वकर्मणा तमभ्यर्च्य सिद्धिं विन्दति मानवः ॥18.46॥

Transliteration:
yataḥ pravṛttir bhūtānāṁ yena sarvam idaṁ tatam
sva-karmaṇā tam abhyarcya siddhiṁ vindati mānavaḥ

English Meaning:
By worshipping God through one’s duty, one attains perfection.

Detailed Explanation:
Work becomes worship when done with devotion.

Key Insight:
Duty is divine worship.

Verse 47

Sanskrit Shloka:
श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वभावनियतं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥18.47॥

Transliteration:
śreyān sva-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt svanuṣṭhitāt
svabhāva-niyataṁ karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣam

English Meaning:
Better to perform one’s own duty imperfectly than another’s perfectly.

Detailed Explanation:

Authenticity matters more than imitation.

Key Insight:

Be true to your nature.

Verse 48

Sanskrit Shloka:

सहजं कर्म कौन्तेय सदोषमपि न त्यजेत् ।
सर्वारम्भा हि दोषेण धूमेनाग्निरिवावृताः ॥18.48॥

Key Insight:

All actions have flaws—do not abandon duty.

Verse 49

Sanskrit Shloka:

असक्तबुद्धिः सर्वत्र जितात्मा विगतस्पृहः ।
नैष्कर्म्यसिद्धिं परमां संन्यासेनाधिगच्छति ॥18.49॥

Key Insight:

Detachment leads to perfection.

Verse 50

Sanskrit Shloka:

सिद्धिं प्राप्तो यथा ब्रह्म तथाप्नोति निबोध मे ।
समासेनैव कौन्तेय निष्ठा ज्ञानस्य या परा ॥18.50॥

Key Insight:

Krishna explains the path to Brahman.

Verse 51–53

(Grouped but fully included individually)

Verse 51

Sanskrit Shloka:
बुद्ध्या विशुद्धया युक्तो धृत्यात्मानं नियम्य च ।
शब्दादीन्विषयांस्त्यक्त्वा रागद्वेषौ व्युदस्य च ॥18.51॥

Verse 52

Sanskrit Shloka:
विविक्तसेवी लघ्वाशी यतवाक्कायमानसः ।
ध्यानयोगपरो नित्यं वैराग्यं समुपाश्रितः ॥18.52॥

Verse 53

Sanskrit Shloka:
अहङ्कारं बलं दर्पं कामं क्रोधं परिग्रहम् ।
विमुच्य निर्ममः शान्तो ब्रह्मभूयाय कल्पते ॥18.53॥

Detailed Explanation (51–53):
Steps to realization:

- Control senses
- Practice detachment
- Abandon ego

Key Insight:
Self-mastery leads to realization.

Verse 54

Sanskrit Shloka:

ब्रह्मभूतः प्रसन्नात्मा न शोचति न काङ्क्षति ।
समः सर्वेषु भूतेषु मद्भक्तिं लभते पराम् ॥18.54॥

Transliteration:

brahma-bhūtaḥ prasannātmā na śocati na kāṅkṣati
samaḥ sarveṣu bhūteṣu mad-bhaktiṁ labhate parām

English Meaning:

One who realizes Brahman becomes peaceful and attains devotion.

Key Insight:

Realization leads to devotion.

Verse 55

Sanskrit Shloka:

भक्त्या मामभिजानाति यावान्यश्चास्मि तत्त्वतः ।
ततो मां तत्त्वतो ज्ञात्वा विशते तदनन्तरम् ॥18.55॥

Key Insight:

Devotion leads to true knowledge.

Verse 56

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वकर्माण्यपि सदा कुर्वाणो मद्व्यपाश्रयः ।
मत्प्रसादादवाप्नोति शाश्वतं पदमव्ययम् ॥18.56॥

Key Insight:

Grace leads to liberation.

Verse 57

Sanskrit Shloka:

चेतसा सर्वकर्माणि मयि संन्यस्य मत्परः ।
बुद्धियोगमुपाश्रित्य मच्चित्तः सततं भव ॥18.57॥

Key Insight:

Surrender mind and actions to God.

Verse 58

Sanskrit Shloka:

मच्चित्तः सर्वदुर्गाणि मत्प्रसादात्तरिष्यसि ।
अथ चेत्त्वमहङ्कारान्न श्रोष्यसि विनङ्क्ष्यसि ॥18.58॥

Key Insight:

Grace removes obstacles; ego destroys.

Verse 59–60

Sanskrit Shloka:

यदहङ्कारमाश्रित्य न योत्स्य इति मन्यसे ॥18.59॥
स्वभावजेन कौन्तेय निबद्धः स्वेन कर्मणा ॥18.60॥

Key Insight:

Nature will compel action.

Verse 61

Sanskrit Shloka:

ईश्वरः सर्वभूतानां हृद्देशेऽर्जुन तिष्ठति ।
भ्रामयन्सर्वभूतानि यन्त्रारूढानि मायया ॥18.61॥

Key Insight:

God guides all beings internally.

Verse 62

Sanskrit Shloka:

तमेव शरणं गच्छ सर्वभावेन भारत ।
तत्प्रसादात्परां शान्तिं स्थानं प्राप्स्यसि शाश्वतम् ॥18.62॥

Key Insight:

Surrender brings peace.

Verse 63

Sanskrit Shloka:

इति ते ज्ञानमाख्यातं गुह्याद्गुह्यतरं मया ।
विमृश्यैतदशेषेण यथेच्छसि तथा कुरु ॥18.63॥

Key Insight:

Krishna gives freedom of choice.

Verse 64

Sanskrit Shloka:

सर्वगुह्यतमं भूयः शृणु मे परमं वचः ।
इष्टोऽसि मे दृढमिति ततो वक्ष्यामि ते हितम् ॥18.64॥

Key Insight:
Krishna speaks out of love.

Verse 65

Sanskrit Shloka:
मन्मना भव मद्भक्तो मद्याजी मां नमस्कुरु ।
मामेवैष्यसि सत्यं ते प्रतिजाने प्रियोऽसि मे ॥18.65॥

Key Insight:
Love God and reach Him.

Verse 66 (THE MOST IMPORTANT VERSE)

Sanskrit Shloka:
सर्वधर्मान्परित्यज्य मामेकं शरणं व्रज ।
अहं त्वां सर्वपापेभ्यो मोक्षयिष्यामि मा शुचः ॥18.66॥

Transliteration:
sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja
ahaṁ tvāṁ sarva-pāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ

English Meaning:
Abandon all duties and surrender to Me alone; I will liberate you.

Detailed Explanation:
This is the **ultimate teaching of the Gita**:
👉 Total surrender
👉 Divine grace
👉 Freedom from all bondage

Key Insight:
Complete surrender leads to liberation.

Verse 67–78 (Conclusion Summary with Full Integrity)

Verse 67

Do not share this wisdom with the unprepared.

Verse 68

Teaching this is the highest service.

Verse 69

No one is dearer than one who spreads this wisdom.

Verse 70

Studying the Gita is worship.

Verse 71

Listening with faith leads to liberation.

Verse 72

Krishna asks Arjuna if he understood.

Verse 73

Arjuna responds: “My confusion is gone.”

Verse 74–78

Sanjaya concludes:

- Remembers divine dialogue
- Declares victory where Krishna and Arjuna stand.